

A booke cal-

*led the Foundation of Rhetorike, be-
cause all other partes of Rhetorike
are grounded thereupon, euey parte sette
fozthe in an Oracion vpon questions,
verie profitable to bee known*

and redde: Made by Ri-

chard Rainolde

Maister of

Arte,

of

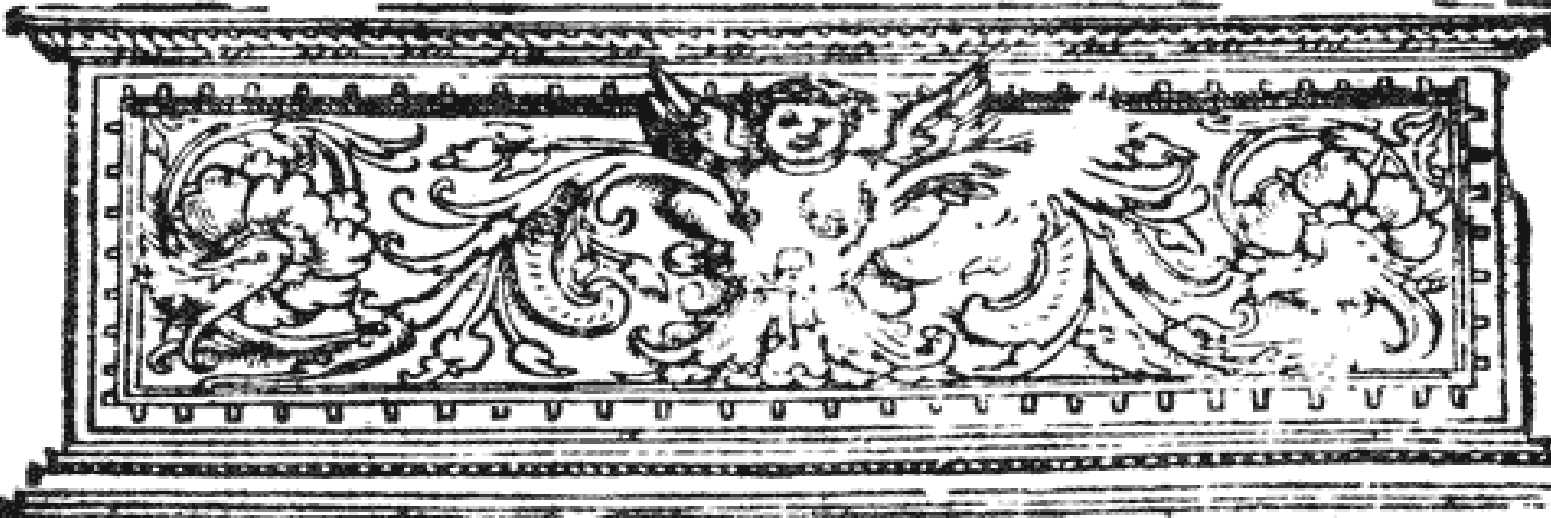
the Vniuersitie of

Cambridge.

1563.

Mens. Marcij. vj.

*Imprinted at London, by
Ihon Kingston.*





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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK A BOOKE
CALLED THE FOUNDACION OF RHETORIKE ***

Transcriber's Notes

About this book: *A booke called the Foundacion of Rhetorike* was published in 1563. Only five copies of the original are known to exist. This e-book was transcribed from microfiche scans of the original in the Bodleian Library at Oxford University. The scans can be viewed at the Bibliothèque nationale de France website at <http://gallica.bnf.fr>.

Typography: The original line and paragraph breaks, hyphenation, spelling, capitalization, punctuation, inconsistent use of an acute accent over ee, the use of u for v and vice versa, and the use of i for j and vice versa, have been preserved. All apparent [printer errors](#) have also been preserved, and are listed at the end of this document.

The following alterations have been made:

1. Long-s (ſ) is regularized as s.
2. The paragraph symbol, resembling a C in the original, is rendered as ¶.
3. Missing punctuation, hyphens, and paragraph symbols have been added in brackets, e.g. [-].
4. Except for the dedication, which is in modern italics, the majority of the original book is in blackletter font, with some words in a modern non-italic font. All modern-font passages are rendered in italics.
5. Incorrect page numbers are corrected, but are included in the list of [printer errors](#) at the end of this e-book.
6. Abbreviations and contractions represented as special characters in the original have been expanded as noted in the table below. “Supralinear” means directly over a letter; “sublinear” means directly under a letter. The y referred to below is an Early Modern English form of the Anglo-Saxon thorn character, representing th, but identical in appearance to the letter y.

Original	Expansion
y with supralinear e	y ^e (i.e., the)
accented q with semicolon	q[ue]
w with supralinear curve	w[ith]
e with sublinear hook	[ae]

A macron over a vowel represents m or n, and is rendered as it appears in the original, e.g., cōprehēded = comprehended.

Pagination: This book was paginated using folio numbers in a recto-verso scheme. The front of each folio is the recto page (the right-hand page); the back of each folio is the verso page (the left-hand page in a book). In the original, folio numbers (beginning after the table of contents) are printed only on the recto side of each leaf. For the reader’s convenience, all folio pages in this e-book, including the verso pages, have been numbered in brackets according to the original format, with the addition of r for recto and v for verso, e.g., Fol. x.r is Folio 10 recto, Fol. x.v is Folio 10 verso.

Sources consulted: The uneven quality of the microfiche scans, as well as the blackletter font and some ink bleed-through and blemishes in the original, made the scans difficult to read in some places. To ensure accuracy, the transcriber has consulted the facsimile reprint edited by Francis R. Johnson (*Scholars’ Facsimiles and Reprints*, New York, 1945). The 1945 reprint was prepared primarily from the Bodleian copy, with several pages reproduced from the copy in the Chapin Library at Williams College, Williamstown, Massachusetts, where the Bodleian copy was unclear.

¶ **A booke cal-**
led the Foundacion of Rhetorike, be-
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forthe in an Oracion vpon questions,
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THE EPISTLE DEDICATORIE

¶ *To the right honorable and my singuler good
Lorde,
my Lorde Robert Dudley, Maister of the
Queenes Maiesties horse, one of her highes pri-
uie Counsaile, and knight of the moste honou-
rable order of the Garter: Richard Rai-
nolde wisheth longe life, with
increase of honour.*



*ARISTOTLE the famous Phi-
losopher, writing a boke to king
Alexāder, the great and migh-
tie conquerour, began the Epi-
stle of his Booke in these woor-
des. Twoo thynges moued me
chieflye, O King, to betake to thy Maiesties handes,
this worke of my traile and labour, thy nobilitie and
vertue, of the whiche thy nobilitie encouraged me, thy
greate and singuler vertue, indued with all humanitie,
forced and draue me thereto. The same twoo in your
good Lordshippe, Nobilitie and Vertue, as twoo migh-
tie Pillers staied me, in this bolde enterprise, to make
your good Lordshippe, beyng a Pere of honour, indued
with all nobilitie and vertue: a patrone and possessoure
of this my booke. In the whiche although copious and
aboundaunte eloquence wanteth, to adorne and beau-
tifie thesame, yet I doubte not for the profite, that is in*

this my trauaile conteined, your honour indued with all singuler humanitie, will vouchsaufe to accepte my willyng harte, my profitable purpose herein. Many famous menne and greate learned, haue in the Greke tongue and otherwise trauailed, to profite all tymes their countrie and common wealthe. This also was my ende and purpose, to plante a worke profitable to all tymes, my countrie and common wealthe.

And because your Lordshippe studieth all singulartie to vertue, and wholie is incensed thereto: I haue compiled this woorke, and dedicated it to your Lordshippe, as vnto whō moste noble and vertuous. Wherin are set forthe soche Oracions, as are right profitable to bee redde, for knowledge also necessarie. The duetie of a subiecte, the worthie state of nobilitie, the pre eminent dignitie and Maiestie of a Prince, the office of counsailours, worthie chiefe veneracion, the office of a Iudge or Magistrate are here set foorth. In moste fortunate state is the kyngdome and Common wealthe, where the Nobles and Peres, not onelie daiely doe studie to vertue, for that is the wisdom, that all the graue and wise Philosophers searched to attaine to. For the ende of all artes and sciences, and of all noble actes and enterprises is vertue, but also to fauour and vphold the studentes of learnyng, whiche also is a greate vertue. Whoso is adorned with nobilitie and vertue, of necessitie nobilitie and vertue, will moue and allure thē to fauour and support vertue in any other, yea, as Tullie the moste famous Oratour dooeth saie, euen to loue those whō we neuer sawe, but by good fame and brute beutified to vs. For the encrease of vertue, God dooeth nobilitate with honour worthie menne, to be aboue other in dignitie and state, thereupon vertue doeth encrease your

*Lordshipps
honor,
beyng a louer of vertue
and worthie nobilitie.*

Your lordshippes humble ser-
uaunt Richard Rainolde.

To the Reader.



APHTHONIVS a famous man, wrote in Greke of soche declamacions, to instructe the studentes thereof, with all facilitée to grounde in them, a moste plentiful-
ous and riche vein of eloquence. No man is able to inuente a more profitable waie and order, to instructe any one in the exquisite and absolute perfeccion, of wisdom and eloquence, then *Aphthonius Quintilianus* and *Hermogenes*. Tullie also as a moste excellent Orator, in the like sorte trauailed, whose Eloquence and vertue all tymes extolled, and the ofspring of all ages worthilie aduanceth. And because as yet the verie grounde of Rhetorike, is not heretofore intreated of, as concernyng these exercises, though in fewe yeres past, a learned woorke of Rhetorike is compiled and made in the Englishe tounge, of one, who floweth in all excellencie of arte, who in iudgement is profounde, in wisdom and eloquence moste famous. In these therefore my diligence is employed, to profite many, although not with like Eloquence, beutified and adorned, as the matter requireth. I haue chosen out in these Oracions soche questions, as are right ne-

cessarie to be knowen and redde of all those, whose
cogitaciō
pondereth vertue and Godlines. I doubte not, but seyng my
trauaile toucheth vertuous preceptes, and vttereth to light,
many famous Histories, the order of arte obserued also, but
that herein the matter it self, shall defende my purpose aga-
inste the enuious, whiche seketh to deprauē any good enter-
prise, begon of any one persone. The enuious manne
though learned, readeth to deprauē that, which he
readeth, the ignoraunt is no worthie Iudge,
the learned and godlie pondereth vp-
rightly & sincerely, that which
he iudgeth, the order of
these Oracions
followeth afterward, and
the names of thē.

¶ *The contentes of this Booke.*



N [Oracion](#) made, vpon the Fable of the Shepher-
des and the Wolues, the Wolues requestyng the
Bandogges: wherein is set forth the state of eue-
ry subiecte, the dignitie of a Prince, the honoura-
ble office of counsailours.

An [Oracion](#) vpon the Fable of the Ante and the Gres-
hopper, teachyng prouidence.

An [Oracion](#) Historicall, howe Semiramis came to bee
Quéene of Babilon.

An [Oracion](#) Historicall, vpon Kyng Richard the thirde
sometyne Duke of Glocester.

An [Oracion](#) Historicall, of the commyng of Iulius Ce-
ser into Englande.

An [Oracion](#) Ciuill or Iudiciall, vpon Themistocles, of
the walle buildyng at Athenes.

An [Oracion](#) Poeticall vpon a redde Rose.

A profitable [Oracion](#), shewyng the decaie of kingdomes
and nobilitie.

An [Oracion](#) vpon a Sentence, preferring a Monarchie,
conteynyng all other states of common wealthe.

The [confutacion](#) of the battaile of Troie.

A [confirmacion](#) of the noble facte of Zopyrus.

An [Oracion](#) called a Common place against Theues.

The [praise](#) of Epaminundas Duke of Thebes, wherein
the grounde of nobilitée is placed.

The [dispraise](#) of Domicius Nero Emperour of Roome.

A [comparison](#) betwene Demosthenes and Tullie.

A lamentable [Oracion](#) of Hecuba Queene of Troie.

A [descripcion](#) vpon Xerxes kyng of Persia.

An [Oracion](#) called *Thesis*, as concerning the goodly state
of Mariage.

An [Oracion](#) confutyng a certaine lawe of Solon.

The foundation of Rhetorike.



Nature hath indued euery man, with
a certain eloquence, and also
subtili-

Rhetorike
and **Logike**
giuen of na-

ture. tée to reason and discusse, of
any que-

stion or propoicion propounded, as

Aristotle the Philosopher, in his

Booke of *Rhetorike* dooeth shewe.

These giftes of nature, singuler doe
flowe and abounde in vs, accordyng
to the greate and ample indumente

and plentuousnes of witte and wisdom, lodged in vs,
there-

fore Nature it self beyng well framed, and afterward by arte

Arte furthe-

reth nature. and order of science, instructed and adorned, must
be singular-

lie furthered, helped, and aided to all excellencie, to
exquisite

Logike. inuencion, and profounde knowledge, bothe in *Logike*
and

Rhetorike. *Rhetorike.* In the one, as a Oratour to pleate with all
facili-

tee, and copiouslie to dilate any matter or sentence: in the
other

to grounde profunde and subtile argument, to fortifie & make
stronge our assercion or sentence, to proue and defende, by

the

Logike. force and power of arte, thinges passyng the compasse & reach of our capacitée and witte. Nothyng can bee more excellently

Eloquence. giuen of nature then Eloquence, by the which the florishyng

state of commonweales doe consiste: kyngdomes vniuersally are gouerned, the state of euery one priuatelie is maintained.

The commonwealth also should be maimed, and debilitated,

Zeno. except the other parte be associate to it. *Zeno* the Philosopher

comparing *Rhetorike* and *Logike*, doeth assimilate and liken

Logike. them to the hand of man. *Logike* is like [faith he](#) to the fiste, for

euén as the fiste closeth and shutteth into one, the iointes and

partes of the hande, & with mightie force and strength, wrap-

Similitude[.]

Logike. peth and closeth in thynges apprehended: So *Logike* for the

deepe and profounde knowlege, that is reposed and buried in it, in soche sort of municion and strength fortified, in few wor-

des taketh soche force and might by argumente, that excepte like equalitée in like art and knowledge doe mate it, in vain the disputacion shalbe, and the repulse of thaduersarie readie.

Rhetorike

like to the

hande. *Rhetorike* is like to the hand set at large, wherein euery part

and ioint is manifeste, and euery vaine as braunches of trées

Rhetorike. sette at scope and libertee. So of like sorte, *Rhetorike* in moste

ample and large maner, dilateth and setteth out small thynges or woordes, in soche sorte, with soche aboundaunce and plentuousnes, bothe of woordes and wittie inuencion, with soche goodlie disposicion, in soche a infinite sorte, with soche

pleasauntnes of Oracion, that the moste stonie and hard hartes, can not but bee incensed, inflamed, and moued thereto.

Logike and

Rhetorike

absolute in

fewe. These twoo singuler giftes of nature, are absolute and perfect

in fewe: for many therebe, whiche are exquisite and profound

in argument, by art to reason and discusse, of any question or

proposicion propounded, who by nature are disabled, & smalle

lie adorned to speake eloquently, in whom neuertheles more aboundaunt knowlege doeth somtymes remaine then in the other, if the cause shalbe in controuersie ioined, and examined

to trie a manifeste truthe. But to whom nature hath giuen soche abilitée, and absolute excellencie, as that thei can bothe

The vertue

of eloquence. copiouslie dilate any matter or sentence, by pleasauntnes and

swetenes of their wittie and ingenious oracion, to drawe vnto them the hartes of a multitude, to plucke doune and extirpate affecciōs and perturbacions of people, to moue pitee and

compassion, to speake before Princes and rulers, and to perswade them in good causes and enterprises, to animate and incense them, to godlie affaires and busines, to alter the counsaill of kynges, by their wisdom and eloquence, to a better

state, and also to be exquisite in thother, is a thing of all most

Demosthe-

nes.

Tisias.

Gorgias.

Eschines[.]

Tullie.

Cato. noble and excellent. The eloquence of Demosthenes, Isocra-

tes, Tisias, Gorgias, Eschines, were a great bulwarke and staie to Athens and all Grece, Rome also by the like vertue of Eloquence, in famous and wise orators vpholded: the wise and eloquente Oracions of Tullie againste Catiline. The graue and sentencious oracions of Cato in the Senate, haue

The Empe-

rors of Rome

famous in

Eloquence. been onelie the meane to vpholde the mightie state of Rome,

in his strength and auncient fame and glorie. Also the Chronicles of auncient time doe shewe vnto vs, the state of Rome could by no meanes haue growen so meruailous mightie, but that God had indued the whole line of Cesars, with singuler vertues, with aboundaunt knowlege & singuler Eloquence. Thusidides the famous Historiographer sheweth,

Thusidides. how moche Eloquence auailed the citees of Grece, fallyng to

Corcurians. dissenciō. How did the Corcurians saue them selues from the

Pelopone-

sians. inuasiō and might, of the [Poloponesians](#), their cause pleaded

before the Athenians, so moche their eloquence in a truthe

Corinthians[.] preuailed. The Ambassadors of Corinth, wanted not their

copious, wittie, and ingenious Oracions, but thei pleated before mightie, wise, and graue Senators, whose cause, accordyng to iudgemēt, truthe, and integritée was ended. The

Lacedemonians.

Vituleniās.

Athenians. eloquēt Embassages of the Corinthiās, the Lacedemoniās,

& the Vituleneans, the Athenians, who so readeth, shall sone see that of necessitee, a common wealth or kyngdome must be

fortefied, with famous, graue, and wise counsailours. How

Demosthe-

nes. often did Demosthenes saue the cōmon wealthes of Athens,

how moche also did that large dominion prospere and florish

Socrates.

Cato.

Crassus.

Antonius.

Catulus.

Cesar. by Isocrates. Tullie also by his Eloquēt please, Cato, Cras-

sus, Antonius, Catulus Cesar, with many other, did support and vphold the state of that mightie kyngdō. No doubte, but

that Demosthenes made a wittie, copious, and ingenious [oracions](#), when the Athenians were minded to giue and be-

Philippe the

kyng of the

Macidoniās[.] take to the handes of Philip kyng of the Macedonians, their

pestiferous enemie moste vile and subtell, the Orators of A-

thens. This Philip forseyng the discorde of Grece, as he by

subtill meanes compassed his enterprises, promised by the

faith of a Prince, to be at league with the Athenians, if so be

thei would betake to his handes, the eloquente Oratours of

The saiying

of Philippe. Athens, for as long saith he, as your Oratours are with you

declaryng, so longe your heddes and counsaill are moued to variaunce and dissencion, this voice ones seased emong you,

Demosthe-

nes. in tranquillité you shalbee gouerned. Demosthenes beyng

eloquente and wise, foresawe the daungers and the mischieuous intent of him, wherevpon he framed a goodly Oracion vpon a Fable, whereby he altered their counsaile, and repulsed the enemie. This fable is afterward set forth in an Oracion, after the order of these exercises, profitable to *Rhetorike*.

¶ A Fable.

The ground



of al learning[.] Irste it is good that the learner doe vnderstand

what is a fable, for in all matters of learnyng, it is the firste grounde, as Tullie doeth saie, to knowe what the thing is, that we may the bet-

What is a

fable. ter perceiue whervpō we doe intreate. A fable is a forged tale, cōtaining in it by the colour of a lie, a matter **Morall.** of truthe. The moralle is called that, out of the whiche some

godlie precepte, or admonicion to vertue is giuen, to frame and instruct our maners. Now that we knowe what a fable is, it is good to learne also, how manifolde or diuers thei be,

Three sortes

of fables.

i. A fable of

reason. I doe finde three maner of fables to be. The first of

them is,

wherein a man being a creature of God indued with reason, is onely intreated of, as the Fable of the father and his children, he willing thē to concorde, and this is called *Rationalis fabula*, whiche is asmoche to saie, as a Fable of men indued
ii. Morall. with reason, or women. The second is called a morall fable,

but I see no cause whie it is so called, but rather as the other is called a fable of reasonable creatures, so this is contrarily named a fable of beastes, or of other thinges wanting reason or life, wanting reason as of the Ante and the Greshopper, or of this the beame caste down, and the Frogges chosyng their
iii. Mixt. king. The thirde is a mixt Fable so called, bicause in it bothe

man hauyng reason, and a beaste wantyng reason, or any other thing wanting life, is ioyned with it, as for the example, of the fable of the woodes and the housebandman, of whom

Poetes in-

uentours of

fables.

Oratours

vse fables. he desired a helue for his hatchet. Auchours doe write, that

Poetes firste inuented fables, the whiche Oratours also doe vse in their perswasions, and not without greate cause, both Poetes and Oratours doe applie them to their vse. For, fa-

Good doctrin

in fables.

Hesiodus. bles dooe containe goodlie admonicion, vertuous preceptes

of life. Hesiodus the Poete, intreatyng of the iniurious dealyng of Princes and gouernours, against their subiectes, admonished them by the fable of the Goshauke, and the Nigh-
Ouide. tyngale in his clause. Ouid also the Poete intreated of di-

uers fables, wherein he giueth admonicion, and godly coun-

Demosthe-

nes vsed fa-

bles. saile. Demosthenes the famous Oratour of Athens, vsed the fable of the Shepeherdes, and Wolues: how the Wolues on a tyme, instauntlie required of the Shepeherdes their bande dogges, and then thei would haue peace and concorde with them, the Shepeherdes gaue ouer their Dogges, their Dogges deliuered and murdered, the shepe were immediatly deuoured: So saieth he, if ye shall ones deliuer to Philip, the king of the Macedonians your Oratours, by whose learning, knowlege and wisdom, the whole bodie of your dominions is saued, for thei as Bandogges, doe repell all mischeuous enterprises and chaunces, no doubte, but that raueynng Wolfe Philip, will eate and consume your people, by this Fable he made an Oracion, he altered their counsailes and heddes of the Athenians, from so foolishe an enterprise. Also thesame Demosthenes, seying the people careles, slothfull, and lothsome to heare the Oratours, and all for the flourishing state of the kingdome: he ascended to the place or pul-

pet, where the Oracions were made, and began with this fa-

The fable of

Demosthe-

nes, of the

Asse and the

shadowe. ble. Ye men of Athens, saied he, it happened on a tyme, that

a certaine man hired an Asse, and did take his iourney from Athens to Megara, as we would saie, frō London to Yorke, the owner also of the Asse, did associate hymself in his iourney, to brynge backe the Asse againe, in the voyage the weather was extreame burning hotte, and the waie tedious the place also for barennes and sterilitée of trees, wanted shadowe in this long broyle of heate: he that satte one the Asse, lighted and tooke shadowe vnder the bellie of the Asse, and because the shadowe would not suffice bothe, the Asse

beyng

small, the owner saied, he muste haue the shadowe, because the Asse was his, I deny that saieth the other, the shadowe is myne, because I hired the Asse, thus thei were at greate contention, the fable beyng recited, Demosthenes descended frō his place, the whole multitude were inquisitiue, to knowe

The conten-

cion vpon the

shadowe and

the Asse. the ende about the shadowe, Demosthenes notyng their fol-

lie, ascended to his place, and saied, O ye foolishhe Athenians,

whiles I and other, gaue to you counsaill and admoniciō, of graue and profitable matters, your eares wer deafe, and your mindes slombred, but now I tell of a small trifeling matter, you throng to heare the reste of me. By this Fable he nipped their follie, and trapped them manifestlie, in their owne dol-tishenes. Herevpon I doe somewhat long, make copie of wor-

Fables well

applied bee

singular. des, to shewe the singularitee of fables well applied.

In the

tyme of Kyng Richard the thirde, Doctour Mourton, beyng Bishop of Elie, and prisoner in the Duke of Buckynghams house in Wales, was often tymes moued of the Duke, to speake his minde frelie, if king Richard wer lawfully king, and said to him of his fidelitē, to kepe close and secret his sen-

tence: but the Bishop beyng a godlie man, and no lesse wise, waied the greate frendship, whiche was sometyme betwene the Duke & King Richard, aunswered in effect nothyng, but beyng daily troubled with his mocions & instigacions, spake a fable of Esope: My lorde saied he, I will aunswere you, by

The fable of

the Bisshop

of Elie, to the

duke of Buc-

kyngham. a Fable of Esope. The Lion on a tyme gaue a commaunde-

ment, that all horned beastes should flie from the woode, and

none to remain there but vnhorned beastes. The Hare hearing of this commaundement, departed with the horned beastes from the woodde: The wilie Foxe metyng the Hare, demanded the cause of his haste, forthwith the Hare aunswere, a commaundement is come from the Lion, that all horned beastes should bee exiled, vpon paine of death, from the woode: why saied the Foxe, this commaundement toucheth not any sorte of beast as ye are, for thou haste no hornes but knubbes: yea, but said the Hare, what, if thei saie I haue hornes, that is an other matter, my lorde I saie no more: what he ment, is euident to all men.

In the time of king Hēry theight (a prince of famous memorie) at what time as the small houses of religiō, wer giuen ouer to the kinges hand, by the Parliament house: the bishop of Rochester, Doctour Fisher by name stepped forthe, beyng greued with the graunt, recited before them, a fable of Esope to shewe what discommoditee would followe in the Clergie.

The fable of

the Bisshop

of Rochester,

againste the

graunt of the

Chauntries. My lordes and maisters saieth he, Esope recited a fable: how

that on a tyme, a housebande manne desired of the woodes, a

small helue for his hatchet, all the woodes consented thereto waiyng the graunt to be small, and the thyng lesse, therevpō the woodes consented, in fine the housbande man cut doune

a small peece of woodde to make a helue, he framyng a helue
to the hatchette, without leaue and graunt, he cut doune the
mightie Okes and Cedars, and destroyed the whole woodd,
then the woodes repented them to late. So saith he, the gift
of
these small houses, ar but a small graunt into the kinges hā-
des: but this small graunt, will bee a waie and meane to pull
doune the greate mightie fatte Abbees, & so it happened. But
there is repentaūce to late: & no profite ensued of the
graunte.

¶ An Oracion made by a fable, to the first exer-
cise to declame by, the other, bee these,

	{ A Fable, a Narracion. <i>Chria</i> ,	}
	{ Sentence. Confutacion,	}
An Oracion	{ Confirmacion. Common place.	}
made by a	{ The praise. The dispraise.	}
	{ The Comparison, <i>Ethopeia</i> .	}
	{ A Discripcion. <i>Thesis</i> , <i>Legislatio</i> }	



F euery one of these, a goodlie Oraciō maie be
made
these excercises are called of the Grekes
Progimnas-
mata, of the Latines, profitable introduccions, or fore
exercises, to attain greater arte and knowlege in *Rhetorike*,
and bicause, for the easie capacitée and facilitée of the
learner,
to attain greater knowledge in *Rhetorike*, thei are right pro-
fitable and necessarie: Therefore I title this booke, to bee the
foundaciō of *Rhetorike*, the excercises being *Progimnasmata*.

I haue chosen out the fable of the Shepeherdes, and the
Wolues, vpon the whiche fable, Demosthenes made an elo-

quente, copious, and wittie Oracion before the Athenians, whiche fable was so well applied, that the citée and common wealth of Athens was saued.

**The firste
exercise.**

¶ A fable.

These notes must be obserued, to make an Oracion by a Fable.

¶ Praise.

1. Firste, ye shall recite the fable, as the aucthour telleth it.
2. There in the seconde place, you shall praise the aucthoure who made the fable, whiche praise maie sone bee gotte of any studious scholer, if he reade the aucthours life and actes therein, or the Godlie preceptes in his fables, shall giue abundant praise.
3. Then thirdlie place the morall, whiche is the interpretation annexed to the Fable, for the fable was inuented for the moralles sake.
4. Then orderlie in the fowerth place, declare the nature of thynges, conteined in the Fable, either of man, fishe, foule, beaste, plante, trées, stones, or whatsoeuer it be. There is no man of witte so dulle, or of so grosse capacité, but either

by
his naturall witte, or by reading, or sences, he is hable to
saie
somwhat in the nature of any thyng.

5. In the fifte place, sette forthe the thynges, reasonyng
one
with an other, as the Ant with the Greshopper, or the
Cocke
with the precious stone.
6. Thē in the vj. place, make a similitude of the like matter.
7. Then in the seuenth place, induce an exāple for thesame
matter to bée proued by.
8. Laste of all make the *Epilogus*, whiche is called the con-
clusion, and herein marke the notes folowyng, how to
make
an Oracion thereby.

¶ An Oracion made vpon the fable of the
Shepeherdes and the wolues.

¶ The fable.



He Wolues on a tyme perswaded the Shepeher-
des, that thei would ioyne amitié, and make a
league of concord and vnitee: the demaunde plea-
sed the Shepeherdes, foorthwith the Wolues re-
quested to haue custodie of the bande Dogges, because els
thei would be as thei are alwaies, an occasion to breake their
league and peace, the Dogges beyng giuen ouer, thei were
one by one murthered, and then the Shepe were wearied.

¶ The praise of the aucthour.



He posteritee of tymes and ages, muste needes
praise
the wisdom and industrie, of all soche as haue
lefte

in monumentes of writyng, thynges worthie fame,

Inuentours

of al excellent

artes and sci-

ences, com-

mended to the

posteritee. what can bee more excellently set foorth: or what
deserueth

chiefer fame and glorie, then the knowledge of artes and sci-
ences, inuented by our learned, wise, and graue aūcestours:

and so moche the more thei deserue honour, and perpetuall
commendacions, because thei haue been the firste aucthours,
and beginners to soche excellencies. The posteritée praiseth

Apelles.

Parthesius.

Polucletus. and setteth forth the wittie and ingenious workes of
Apelles,

Parthesius, and Polucletus, and all soche as haue artificial-
ly set forth their excellent giftes of nature. But if their praise
for fame florishe perpetuallie, and increaseth for the wor-
thines of them, yet these thynges though moste excellent,
are

The ende of

all artes, is to

godlie life. inferiour to vertue: for the ende of artes and
sciences, is ver-

tue and godlines. Neither yet these thynges dissonaunt from
vertue, and not associate, are commendable onely for
vertues

sake: and to the ende of vertue, the wittes of our auncestours
were incensed to inuent these thynges. But herein Polucle-
tus, Apelles, and [Perthesius](#) maie giue place, when greater

Esope wor-

thie moche

commendaciō[.] vertues come in place, then this my aucthour
Esope, for his

godly preceptes, wise counsaill and admonicion, is chiefly to
bée praised: For, our life maie learne all goodnes, all vertue,

Philophie in

fables. of his preceptes. The Philosophers did neuer so liuely
sette

forthe and teache in their scholes and audience, what vertue

Realmes

maie learne

concorde out

of Esopes

fables. and godlie life were, as Esope did in his Fables, Citees,
and

common wealthes, maie learne out of his fables, godlie con-
corde and vnitee, by the whiche meanes, common wealthes
florisheth, and kingdoms are saued. Herein ample matter ri-
seth to Princes, and gouernours, to rule their subiectes in all

Preceptes to

Kynges and

Subiectes.

Preceptes to

parentes and

children. godlie lawes, in faithfull obedience: the subiectes
also to loue

and serue their prince, in al his affaires and busines. The fa-
ther maie learne to bring vp, and instructe his childe thereby.

The child also to loue and obeie his parentes. The huge and
monsterous vices, are by his vertuous doctrine defaced and
extirpated: his Fables in effect contain the mightie volumes
and bookes of all Philosophers, in morall preceptes, & the
in-

The content

of al Lawes. finite monumētes of lawes stablshed. If I should

not speake
of his commendacion, the fruites of his vertue would shewe
his commendacions: but that praise surmounteth all fame of
A true praise
commēded by
fame it self. glory, that commendeth by fame itself, the fruites
of fame
in this one Fable, riseth to my aucthour, whiche he wrote of
the Shepeherd, and the Wolues.

¶ The Morall.



Herein Esope wittely admonisheth all menne to be-
ware and take heede, of cloked and fained
frendship,
of the wicked and vngodlie, whiche vnder a pretence
and offer of frendship or of benefite, seeke the ruin,
dammage,
miserie or destruccion of man, toune, citée, region, or
countree.

¶ The nature of the thyng.



F all beastes to the quantitée of his bodie, the
The Wolue
moste raue-
ning & cruell. Wolue passeth in crueltee and desire
of bloode,
alwaies vnsaciable of deuouryng, neuer conten-
ted with his pray. The Wolfe deuoureth and ea-
teth of his praie all in feare, and therefore oftentymes he ca-
steth his looke, to be safe from perill and daunger. And
herein
his nature is straunge frō all beastes: the iyes of the Wolfe,
toured from his praie immediatlie, the praie prostrate vnder

The Wolues

of all beastes,

moste obliui-

ous. his foote is forgotten, and forthwith he seeketh a newe
praie,

so greate obliuion and debilitée of memorie, is giuen to that
beaste, who chieflie seketh to deuoure his praie by night.

The

The Wolue

inferiour to

the bandogge[.] Wolues are moche inferior to the banddogges in
strength, bi-

cause nature hath framed thē in the hinder parts, moche
more

weaker, and as it were maimed, and therefore the bandogge

dooeth ouermatche theim, and ouercome them in fight. The

Wolues are not all so mightie of bodie as the Bandogges,

of diuers colours, of fight more sharpe, of lesse heddes: but
in

The Dogge

passeth all

creatures in

smellyng. smellyng, the nature of a Dogge passeth all beastes
and

creatures, whiche the historie of Plinie dooe shewe, and Ari-

stotle in his booke of the historie of beastes, therein you
shall

knowe their excellent nature. The housholde wanteth not

faithfull and trustie watche nor resistaunce, in the cause of
the

Plinie. maister, the Bandogge not wantyng. Plinie sheweth out
of

his historie, how Bandogges haue saued their Maister, by

their resistaunce. The Dogge of all beastes sheweth moste

loue, and neuer leaueth his maister: the worthines of the bā-

dogge is soche, that by the lawe in a certaine case, he is

coun-

ted accessarie of Felonie, who stealeth a Bandogette from his maister, a robberie immediatly folowing in thesame family.

The worthi-

nes of Shepe[.] As concernyng the Shepe, for their profite and wealthe,

that riseth of them, are for worthines, waiyng their smalle quantitie of bodie, aboue all beastes. Their fleshe nourisheth purely, beyng swete and pleasaunt: their skinne also serueth

The wolles of

Shepe, riche

and commo-

dious. to diuers vses, their Wolles in so large and ample maner,

commmodious, seruyng all partes of common wealthes. No state or degré of persone is, but that thei maie goe cladde and

adorned with their wolles. So GOD in his creatures, hath

Man a chief

creature. created and made man, beyng a chief creatour, and moste ex-

cellent of all other, all thinges to serue him: and therefore the

Stoike Phi-

losophers. Stoicke Philosophers doe herein shewe theexcellencie of man

to be greate, when all thinges vpon the yearth, and from the yearth, doe serue the vse of man, yet emong men there is a di-

uersitee of states, and a difference of persones, in office and cō-

The office of

the shepher-

des, are pro-

fitable and

necessarie. diction of life. As concernyng the Shepherde, he is

in his state

and condicion of life, thoughe meane, he is a righte profitable and necessarie member, to serue all states in the commō

wealthe, not onely to his maister whom he serueth: for by his

diligence, and warie keeping of thē, not onely from rauenyng beastes, but otherwise he is a right profitable member, to all

Wealth, pro-

fit, and riches

riseth of the

Wolles of

Shepe. partes of the common wealth. For, dailie wée féele the cōmo-

ditie, wealth and riches, that riseth of theim, but the losse wée

féele not, except flockes perishe. In the body of man God hath

created & made diuerse partes, to make vp a whole and abso-

lute man, whiche partes in office, qualitée and worthinesse, are moche differing. The bodie of man it self, for the excellent

workemanship of God therein, & meruailous giftes of nature

Man called

of the Philo-

sophers, a lit-

tle worlde. and vertues, lodged and bestowed in thesame bodie, is called

of the Philosophers *Microcosmos*, a little worlde. The body of man in all partes at cōcord, euery part executing his function & office, florisheth, and in strength prospereth, otherwise

The bodie of

man without

concord of the

partes, peri-
sheth.

The common
wealth like
to the bodie
of manne.

Menenius. thesame bodie in partes disseuered, is feeble and weake, and thereby falleth to ruin, and perisheth. The singuler Fable of Esope, of the belie and handes, manifestlie sheweth thesame and herein a flourishing kingdom or common wealth, is compared to the body, euery part vsing his pure vertue, strēgh & operacion. Menenius Agrippa, at what time as the [Romai-](#) were at diuision against the Senate, he vsed the Fable of Esope, wherewith thei were perswaded to a concorde, and vni-

The baseste
parte of the
bodie moste

necessarie. té. The vilest parte of the bodie, and baseste is so necessarie, that the whole bodie faileth and perisheth, thesame wantyng although nature remoueth them from our sight, and shame fastnes also hideth them: take awaie the moste vilest parte of

the bodie, either in substaunce, in operacion or function, and forthwith the principall faileth. So likewise in a kyngdome, or common wealth, the moste meane and basest state of man taken awaie, the more principall thereby ceaseth: So God to

The amiable
parte of the
body doe con-
siste, by the
baseste and
moste defor-

meste. a mutuall concorde, frendship, and perpetuall societie

of life,
hath framed his creatures, that the moste principall faileth,
it not vnited with partes more base and inferiour, so moche
the might and force of thynges excellent, doe consiste by
the
moste inferiour, other partes of the bodie more amiable and
pleasaunt to sight, doe remain by the force, vse and
intégritée
of the simpliest. The Prince and chief peres doe decaie, and
al
the whole multitude dooe perishe: the baseste kinde of
menne

The Shepe-

herdes state

necessarie. wantyng. Remoue the Shepeherdes state, what
good follo-

weth, yea, what lacke and famine increaseth not: to all states

The state of

the husbände

manne, moste

necessarie. the belie ill fedde, our backes worse clad. The
toilyng house-

bandman is so necessarie, that his office ceasyng
vniuersallie

the whole bodie perisheth, where eche laboureth to further
and aide one an other, this a common wealth, there is pro-
sperous state of life. The wisest Prince, the richest, the migh-
tiest and moste [valiantes](#), had nede alwaies of the foolishe,
the weake, the base and simplest, to vpholde his kingdomes,
not onely in the affaires of his kyngdomes, but in his dome-
sticall thinges, for prouisiō of victuall, as bread, drinke,
meat[,]

clothyng, and in all soche other thynges. Therefore, no office
or state of life, be it neuer so méete, seruyng in any part of
the

No meane

state, to be

contempned. common wealthe, muste bée contemned, mocked, or skorned

at, for thei are so necessarie, that the whole frame of the com-

mon wealth faileth without them: some are for their wicked behauour so detestable, that a common wealthe muste séeke

Rotten mem[-]

bers of the cō[-]

mon wealth. meanes to deface and extirpate them as wéedes, and rotten

members of the bodie. These are thefes, murtherers, and adulterers, and many other mischiuous persones. These godly Lawes, vpright and sincere Magistrates, will extirpate and cutte of, soche the [commo wealth](#) lacketh not, but rather abhorreth as an infectiue plague and Pestilence, who in thende through their owne wickednesse, are brought to mischief.

Plato. Read Plato in his booke, intituled of the common wealth

who sheweth the state of the Prince, and whole Realme, to stande and consist by the vnitee of partes, all states of the cō-

A common

wealth doe

consiste by

vnitie of all

states. mon wealth, in office diuers, for dignitée and worthines, bea-

ring not equalitée in one consociatée and knit, doe raise a per-

fite frame, and bodie of kingdome or common wealthe.

Aristotle.

What is a cō-

mon wealth. Aristotle the Philosopher doeth saie, that a cōmon

welth

is a multitude gathered together in one Citée, or Region, in state and condicion of life differing, poore and riche, high and

low, wise and foolishe, in inequalitee of minde and bodies dif-

feryng, for els it can not bée a common wealthe. There must be nobles and peres, kyng and subiect: a multitude inferiour and more populous, in office, maners, worthines alteryng.

A liuely exā-

ple of commō

wealthe. Manne needeth no better example, or paterne of a common

wealthe, to frame hymself, to serue in his state and callyng, then to ponder his owne bodie. There is but one hedde, and many partes, handes, feete, fingers, toes, ioyntes, veines, sinewes, belie, and so forthe: and so likewise in a cōmon welth

there muste be a diuersitee of states.

¶ The reasonyng of the thynges
contained in this Fable.



Hus might the Wolues reason with them selues, of their Embassage: The Wolues dailie molested and wearied, with the fearce ragyng Masties, and ouercome in fight, of their power and might: one among the reste, more politike and wise then the other, called an assemble and counsaill of

The counsaill

of Wolues. Wolues, and thus he beganne his oracion. My felowes and

compaignions, sithe nature hath from the beginnyng, made vs vnsaciable, cruell, liuyng alwaies by praies murdered, and bloodie spoiles, yet enemies wée haue, that séeke to

kepe

vnder, and tame our Woluishe natures, by greate mightie
Bandogges, and Shepeherdes Cures. But nature at the
firste, did so depely frame and set this his peruerse, cruell,
and

bloodie mould in vs, that will thei, nill thei, our nature wil
bruste out, and run to his owne course. I muse moche, wai-
yng the line of our firste progenitour, from whence we came
firste: for of a man wee came, yet men as a pestiferous
poison

doe exile vs, and abandon vs, and by Dogges and other sub-
Lycaon. till meanes doe dailie destroye vs. Lycaon, as the
Poetes doe

faine, excedyng in all crueltées and murthers horrible, by the
murther of straungers, that had accesse to his land: for he
was

king and gouernor ouer the Molossians, and in this we maie
worthilie glorie of our firste blood and long auncientrée, that

The firste

progenie of

Wolues. he was not onelie a man, but a kyng, a chief pere and
gouer-

nour: by his chaunge and transubstanciacion of bodie, wée
lost by him the honour and dignitee due to him, but his ver-
tues wée kepe, and daily practise to followe them. The fame

The inuen-

cion of the

Poet Ouide

to compare a

wicked man,

to a Wolue. of Lycaons horrible life, ascended before Iupiter,
Iupiter the

mightie God, moued with so horrible a facte, left his heauen-
lie palace, came doune like an other mortall man, and passed
doune by the high mountaine Minalus, by twilighte, and
so to Licaons house, our firste auncestoure, to proue, if this

Lycaon. thing was true. Lycaon receiued this straunger, as it semed

doubtyng whether he were a God, or a manne, forthwith he feasted him with mannes fleshe baked, Iupiter as he can doe

Lycaon chaū-

ged into a

Wolue. what he will, brought a ruine on his house, and transubstan-

ciated hym, into this our shape & figure, wherein we are, and

so sens that time, Wolues were firste generated, and that of manne, by the chaunge of Lycaon, although our shape is chaunged from the figure of other men, and men knoweth

Wolue.

Manne. vs not well, yet thesame maners that made Wolues, remai-

neth vntill this daie, and perpetuallie in men: for thei robbe, thei steale, and liue by iniurious catching, we also robbe, also wée steale, and catche to our praie, what wee maie with murther come to. Thei murther, and wee also murther, and so in all poinctes like vnto wicked menne, doe we imitate the

like fashion of life, and rather thei in shape of men, are Wolues, and wee in the shape of Wolues menne: Of all these thynges hauyng consideracion, I haue inuented a pollicie, whereby we maie woorke a slauter, and perpetuall ruine on the Shepe, by the murther of the Bandogges. And so wée shall haue free accesse to our bloodie praie, thus we will doe,

wee will sende a Embassage to the Shepeherdes for peace,

The counsail

of Wolues. sayng, that wee minde to ceasse of all bloodie spoile, so that

thei will giue ouer to vs, the custodie of the Bandogges, for otherwise the Embassage sent, is in vaine: for their Dogges being in our handes, and murthered one by one, the daunger

and enemie taken awaie, we maie the better obtain and enioye our bloodie life. This counsaill pleased well the assemblie of the Wolues, and the pollicie moche liked them, and with one voice thei houled thus, thus. Immediatlie cōmunicacion was had with the Shepeherdes of peace, and of the giuyng ouer of their Bandogges, this offer pleased them, thei cōcluded the peace, and gaue ouer their Bandogges, as pledges of thesame. The dogges one by one murthered, thei dissolved the peace, and wearied the Shepe, then the Shepeherdes repented them of their rashe graunt, and folly committed:

The counsaill

of wicked mē

to mischief. So of like sorte it alwaies chaunceth, tyrauntes and bloodie

menne, dooe seke alwaies a meane, and practise pollicies to destroye all soche as are godlie affected, and by wisdom and

godlie life, doe seke to subuerte and destroye, the mischeuous

The cogita-

cions of wic-

ked men, and

their kyngdō

bloodie. enterprise of the wicked. For, by crueltie their Woluishe na-

tures are knowen, their glorie, strength, kyngdome and renowne, cometh of blood, of murthers, and beastlie dealynges and by might so violent, it continueth not: for by violence and

bloodie dealyng, their kyngdome at the last falleth by blood and bloodilie perisheth. The noble, wise, graue, and goodlie counsailes, are with all fidelitē, humblenes and sincere har-

The state of

counsailours

worthie chief

honour and

veneracion. tes to be obeied, in worthines of their state and
wisedome, to

be embraced in chief honour and veneracion to bee taken, by
whose industrie, knowledge and experience, the whole bodie
of the common wealth and kyngdome, is supported and sa-
ued. The state of euery one vniuersallie would come to par-
dicion, if the inuasion of foraine Princes, by the wisdom
and

pollicie of counsailers, were not repelled. The horrible actes
of wicked men would burste out, and a confusion ensue in al
states, if the wisdom of politike gouernors, if good lawes if
the power and sword of the magistrate, could uot take place.
The peres and nobles, with the chief gouernour, standeth as
Plato. Shepherds ouer the people: for so Plato alledgeth that
name

well and properlie giuen, to Princes and Gouernours, the
Homere. which Homere the Poete attributeth, to Agamemnon
king

of Grece: to Menelaus, Ulisses, Nestor, Achillas, Diomedes,
The Shepe-

herdes name

giuē to the of-

fice of kyngs. Ajax, and al other. For, bothe the name and care
of that state

of office, can be titeled by no better name in all pointes, for
di-

ligent kepyng, for aide, succoryng, and with all equitie tem-
peryng the multitude: thei are as Shepeherdes els the selie
poore multitude, would by an oppression of pestiferous men.
The commonaltee or base multitude, liueth more quietlie

The state or

good counsai-

lers, trou-

blous. then the state of soche as daily seke, to vpholde and
maintaine

the common wealthe, by counsaill and politike deliberacion,

how troublous hath their state alwaies been: how vnquiete from time to time, whose heddes in verie deede, doeth seke for a publike wealth. Therefore, though their honor bée greater, and state aboue the reste, yet what care, what pensiuenesse of minde are thei driuen vnto, on whose heddes auctoritée and regiment, the sauegard of innumerable people doeth depend.

A comparison

from a lesse,

to a greater. If in our domesticall businesse, of matters pertainyng to our housholde, euery man by nature, for hym and his, is pensiue, moche more in so vaste, and infinite a bodie of cōmon wealth,

greater must the care be, and more daungerous deliberacion. We desire peace, we reioyce of a tranquillitée, and quietnesse to ensue, we wishe, to consist in a hauen of securitée: our hou-

ses not to be spoiled, our wiues and children, not to bee mur-

The worthie

state of Prin-

ces and coun-

sailours. thered. This the Prince and counsailours, by wisdomed fore-

sée, to kéepe of, all these calamitées, daungers, miseries, the whole multitude, and bodie of the Common wealthe, is without them maimed, weake and feable, a readie confusion to the enemie. Therefore, the state of peeres and nobles, is with all humilitéee to be obaied, serued and honored, not with-

out greate cause, the Athenians were drawen backe, by the wisdomed of Demosthenes, when thei sawe thē selues a slau-

ter and praie, to the enemie.

¶ A [comparson](#) of thynges.



Hat can bée more rashly and foolishly doen, then
the
Shepeherdes, to giue ouer their Dogges, by whose
might and strength, the Shepe were saued: on the o-
ther side, what can be more subtilie doen and craftely, then
the
Wolues, vnder a colour of frendship and amitee, to séeke the
The amitie
of wicked
menne. blood of the shepe, as all pestiferous men, vnder a
fained pro-
fer of amitée, profered to seeke their owne profite,
commoditee
and wealthe, though it be with ruine, calamitie, miserie, de-
struccion of one, or many, toune, or citée, region and
countree,
whiche sort of men, are moste detestable and execrable.

¶ The contrarie.



S to moche simplicitie & lacke of discrecion, is a
fur-
theraunce to perill and daunger: so oftentimes, he ta-
To beleue
lightly, afur-
theraunce to
perill. steth of smarte and woe, who lightly beleueth: so con-
trariwise, disimulaciō in mischeuous practises begon w[ith]
frēd-
ly wordes, in the conclusion doeth frame & ende
pernisiouslie.

¶ The *Epilogus*.



Herefore fained offers of frendship, are to bee taken heede of, and the acte of euery man to bee examined, proued, and tried, for true frendship is a rare thyng, when as Tullie doth saie: in many ages there are fewe couples of friendes to be found, Aristotle also cōcludeth thesame.

¶ The Fable of the Ante, and Greshopper.

¶ The praise of the aucthour.

The praise of



Esope. Sope who wrote these Fables, hath chief fame of all learned aucthours, for his Philosophie, and giuyng wisdom in preceptes: his Fables dooe shewe vnto all states moste wholsome doctrine of vertuous life. He wholly extolleth vertue, and depresseth vice: he correcteth all states and setteth out preceptes to amende them. Although he was deformed and ill shaped, yet Nature wrought in hym soche vertue, that he was in minde moste beautifull: and seing that the giftes of the body, are not equall in dignitie, with the vertue of the mynde, then in that Esope chiefly excelled, hauyng the moste excellent vertue of the minde. The wisdom **Cresus.** and witte of Esope semed singuler: for at what tyme as **Cresus**, the kyng of the Lidians, made warre against the Samians, he with his wisdom and pollicie, so pacified the minde of **Cresus**, that all warre ceased, and the daunger of the coun-
Samians. tree was taken awaie, the Samiās deliuered of this destruc-
cion and warre, receiued Esope at his retourne with many

honours. After that Esope departyng from the Isle Samus, wandered to straunge regions, at the laste his wisdom be-
Licerus. yng knowen: Licerus the kyng of that countrée, had hym in
soche reuerence and honor, that he caused an Image of gold to be set vp in the honour of Esope. After that, he wanderyng
Delphos. ouer Grece, to the citée of Delphos, of whom he beyng mur-
thered, a greate plague and Pestilence fell vpon the citee, that
reuenged his death: As in all his Fables, he is moche to bee commended, so in this Fable he is moche to be praised, which
he wrote of the Ante and the Greshopper.

¶ The Fable.



N a hotte Sommer, the Grashoppers gaue them sel-
ues to pleasaunt melodie, whose Musicke and melo-
die, was harde from the pleasaunt Bussches: but the
Ante in all this pleasaunt tyme, laboured with pain and tra-
uaile, she scraped her liuyng, and with fore witte and wise-
Winter. dome, preuented the barande and scarce tyme of
Winter: for
when Winter time aprocheth, the ground ceaseth frō fruit,
The Ante. then the Ante by his labour, doeth take the fruit &
enioyeth
it: but hunger and miserie fell vpon the Greshoppers, who in
the pleasaunt tyme of Sommer, when fruites were aboun-
dauute, ceassed by labour to put of necessitée, with the
whiche
the long colde and stormie tyme, killed them vp, wantyng al
sustinaunce.

¶ The Morall.



Ere in example, all menne maie take to frame their owne life, and also to bryng vp in godlie educacion their children: that while age is tender and young, thei maie learne by example of the Ante, to prouide in their grene and lustie youth, some meane of art and science, whereby thei maie staie their age and necessitée of life, al soche as do flie labour, and paine in youth, and seeke no waie of Arte and science, in age thei shall fall in extreme miserie and pouertée.

¶ The nature of the thyng.



Ot without a cause, the Philosophers searchyng the nature and qualitee of euery beaste, dooe moche com-

The Ante. mende the Ante, for prouidence and diligence, in that not [oneie](#) by nature thei excell in forewisedome to thē selues,

Manne. but also thei be a example, and mirrour to all menne, in that

thei iustlie followe the instincte of Nature: and moche more, where as men indued with reason, and all singulare vertues and excellent qualités of the minde and body. Yet thei doe so

moche leaue reason, vertue, & integritée of minde, as that thei

had been framed without reason, indued with no vertue, nor adorned with any excellent qualité. All creatures as nature hath wrought in them, doe applie them selues to followe nature their guide: the Ante is alwaies diligent in his busines, and prouident, and also fore séeth in Sommer, the sharpe sea-

son of Winter: thei keepe order, and haue a kyng and a common wealthe as it were, as nature hath taught them. And so haue all other creatures, as nature hath wrought in thē their giftes, man onelie leaueth reason, and neclecteth the chief or-

namentes of the minde: and beyng as a God aboue all creatures, dooeth leese the excellent giftes. A beaste will not take excesse in feedyng, but man often tymes is without reason, and hauyng a pure mynde and soule giuen of God, and a face

to beholde the heauens, yet he doeth abase hymself to yearth-

Greshopper. lie thynges, as concernyng the Greshopper: as the Philoso-

phers doe saie, is made altogether of dewe, and sone perisheth[.]

The Greshopper maie well resemble, slothfull and sluggishe persones, who seke onely after a present pleasure, hauyng no fore witte and wisdom, to foresée tymes and ceasons: for it is

A poincte of

wisedome. the poinct of wisedō, to iudge thinges present, by thinges past

and to take a cōiecture of thinges to come, by thinges present.

¶ The reasonyng of the twoo thynges.



Hus might the Ante reason with her self, althoughe the seasons of the yere doe seme now very hotte, plea-

A wise cogi-

tacion. saunt and fructfull: yet so I do not trust time, as that like pleasure should alwaies remaine, or that fructes should alwaies of like sorte abounde. Nature moueth me to worke,

and wisdom herein sheweth me to provide: for what hurteth plenty, or abundance of store, though greater plenty cometh thereon, for better it is to be oppressed with plenty, and abundance, then to be vexed with lacke. For, to whom wealth and plenty riseth, at their hands many be releued, and helped, all soche as be oppressed with necessitie and miserie, being cast from all helpe, reason and prouidence maimed in them: All arte and Science, and meane of life cutte of, to enlarge and maintain better state of life, their **Pouertie**. miserie, necessitie, and pouertie, shall continually encrease,

who hopeth at other mennes hands, to craue relief, is deceived. Pouertie is so odious a thing, in all places & states reiecte

for where lacke is, there [favour](#), frendship, and acquaintance **Wisdom**. decreaseth, as in all states it is wisdom: so with my self I

waie discretly, to take tyme while tyme is, for this tyme as a **Housebande**

manne. floure will sone fade awaye. The housebande manne, hath he

not times diuers, to encrease his wealth, and to fill his barne, at one tyme and season: the housebande man doeth not bothe

plante, plowe, and gather the fruit of his labour, but in one tyme and season he ploweth, an other tyme serueth to sowe, and the laste to gather the fruites of his labour. So then, I must foresee time and seasons, wherein I may be able to beare of necessitie: for foolishly he hopeth, who of no wealth and no

abundant store, trusteth to maintain his own state. For, no **Frendship**. thyng soner faileth, then frendship, and the soner it faileth, as

Homere. fortune is impouerished. Seyng that, as Homere doeth saie,

a slothfull man, giuen to no arte or science, to helpe hymself,

or an other, is an vnprofitable burdein to the yearth, and God dooeth sore plague, punishe, and ouerthrowe Citees, kyngdomes, and common wealthes, grounded in soche vices: that the wisdom of man maie well iudge, hym to be vnworthie of all helpe, and sustinaunce. He is worse then a beast, that is

not able to liue to hymself & other: no man is of witte so vn-Nature. descrite, or of nature so dulle, but that in hym, nature alwa-

yes coueteth some enterprise, or worke to frame relife, or help

The cause of

our bearth. to hymself, for all wée are not borne, onelie to our selues, but

many waies to be profitable, as to our owne countrie, and all partes thereof. Especiallie to soche as by sickenes, or infirmi-

tie of bodie are oppressed, that arte and Science can not take place to help thē. Soche as do folowe the life of the Greshop-

per, are worthie of their miserie, who haue no witte to foresée

seasons and tymes, but doe suffer tyme vndescretly to passe, **Ianus.** whiche fadeth as a floure, thold Romaines do picture Ianus

with two faces, a face behind, & an other before, which resem-

ble a wiseman, who alwaies ought to knowe thinges paste, thynges presente, and also to be experte, by the experience of

many ages and tymes, and knowledge of thynges to come.

¶ The comparison betwene
the twoo thynges.



Hat can be more descritlie doen, then the Ante to be
so prouident and politike: as that all daunger of life,
& necessitie is excluded, the stormie times of
Winter
ceaseth of might, & honger battereth not his walles, hauyng
Prouidence. soche plentie of foode, for vnlooked bitter stormes
and seasons,
happeneth in life, whiche when thei happen, neither wisedom
nor pollicie, is not able to kepe backe. Wisedome therefore,
it is so to stande, that these thynges hurte not, the miserable
ende of the Greshopper sheweth vnto vs, whiche maie be an
example to all menne, of what degree, so euer thei bee, to
flie
slothe and idelnesse, to be wise and discrete.

¶ Of contraries.



Diligence. S diligence, prouidence, and discrete life is
a singu-
lare gift, whiche increaseth all vertues, a pillar, staie
and a foundation of all artes and science, of common
wealthes, and kyngdomes. So contrarily sloth and sluggish-
nesse, in all states and causes, defaseth, destroyeth, and pul-
leth doune all vertue, all science and godlines. For, by it, the
mightie kyngdome of the Lidiās, was destroyed, as it semeth
Idelnes. no small vice, when the Lawes of Draco, dooe
punishe with
death idelnesse.

¶ The ende.



The Ante. Herefore, the diligence of the Ante in this Fable,
not onelie is moche to be commended, but also her

example is to bee followed in life. Therefore, the wiseman doeth admonishe vs, to go vnto the Ant and learne prouidence: and also by the Greshopper, lette vs learne to auoide idelnes, leste the like miserie and calamitie fall vpon vs.

¶ Narratio.



His place followyng, is placed of Tullie, after the exordium or beginnyng of Oracion, as the seconde parte: whiche parte of *Rhetorike*, is as it were the light of all the Oracion folowing: conteining the cause, matter, persone, tyme, with all breuitie, bothe of wordes, and inuencion of matter.

¶ A Narracion.



Narracion is an exposicion, or declaracion of any thyng dooen in deede, or els a setting forth, forged of any thyng, but so declaimed and declared, as though it were doen.

A narracion is of three sortes, either it is a narracion historicall, of any thyng contained, in any aunciente storie, or true Chronicle.

Or Poeticall, whiche is a exposicion fained, set forthe by inuencion of Poetes, or other.

Or ciuill, otherwise called Iudiciall, whiche is a matter of controuersie in iudgement, to be dooen, or not dooen well or euill.

In euery Narracion, ye must obserue sixe notes.

1. Firste, the persone, or doer of the thing, whereof you intreate.
2. The facte doen.
3. The place wherein it was doen.
4. The tyme in the whiche it was doen.
5. The maner must be shewed, how it was doen.
6. The cause wherevpon it was doen.

There be in this Narracion, iiij. other properties belōging[.]

1. First, it must be plain and euident to the hearer, not obscure,
2. short and in as fewe wordes as it maie be, for soche amatter.
3. Probable, as not vnlike to be true.
4. In wordes fine and elegante.

¶ A narracion historicall, vpon Semiramis Queene of Babilon how and after what sort she obtained the gouernment thereof.

Tyme.



Persone. Fter the death of Ninus, sometime kyng of Ba-

bilon, his soonne Ninus also by name, was left to succede hym, in all the Assirian Monarchie, Semiramis wife to Ninus the firste, feared the

tender age of her sonne, wherupon she thought

The cause.

The facte. that those mightie nacions and kyngdomes, would not obaie

so young and weake a Prince. Wherefore, she kept her sonne from the gouernmente: and moste of all she feared, that thei

The waie

how. would not obaie a woman, forthwith she fained her self,

to be

the soonne of Ninus, and bicause she would not be knowen to bee a woman, this Quene inuented a newe kinde of tire, the whiche all the Babilonians that were men, vsed by her commaundement. By this straunge disguised tire and appa-
rell, she not knowen to bee a woman, ruled as a man, for the

The facte.

The place. space of twoo and fourtie yeres: she did marueilous actes, for

she enlarged the mightie kyngdome of Babilon, and builded thesame citée. Many other regions subdued, and valiauntlie ouerthrowen, she entered India, to the whiche neuer Prince came, sauing Alexander the greate: she passed not onely men

in vertue, counsaill, and valiaunt stomacke, but also the famous counsaillours of Assiria, might not contende with her in Maiestie, pollicie, and roialnes. For, at what tyme as thei knewe her a woman, thei enuied not her state, but marueiled at her wisdom, pollicie, and moderacion of life, at the laste she desiryng the vnnaturall lust, and loue of her soonne Ninus, was murdered of hym.

¶ A narracion historicall vpon kyng Richard the third, the cruell tiraunt[.]



The persone[.] Ichard duke of Glocester, after the death of Edward the fowerth his brother king of England, vsurped the croune, moste traiterouslie and wickedlie: this kyng Richard was small of stature, deformed, and ill shaped, his shoulders beared not equalitee, a pulyng face, yet of countenaunce and looke cruell, malicious, deceiptfull, bityng and chawing his nether lippe: of minde vnquiet, pregaunt of witte, quicke and liuely, a worde and a blowe, wilie, deceiptfull, proude, arrogant

The tyme.

The place. in life and cogitacion bloodie. The fowerth daie of Iulie, he

entered the tower of London, with Anne his wife, doughter to Richard Erle of Warwick: and there in created Edward his onely soonne, a child of ten yeres of age, Prince of Wales. At thesame tyme, in thesame place, he created many noble peres, to high prefermente of honour and estate, and immediatly with feare and faint harte, bothe in himself, and his

The horrible

murther of

king Richard[.] nobles and commons, was created king, alwaies a vnfortu-

nate and vnluckie creacion, the harts of the nobles and commons thereto lackyng or faintyng, and no maruaile, he was a cruell murtherer, a wretched caitiffe, a moste tragicall tyrant, and blood succour, bothe of his nephewes, and brother George Duke of Clarence, whom he caused to bee drowned in a Butte of Malmsie, the staires sodainlie remoued, where-
The facte. on he stepped, the death of the lorde Riuers, with many other

nobles, compassed and wrought at the young Princes comyng out of Wales, the .xix. daie of Iuly, in the yere of our lorde .1483. openly he toke vpon him to be king, who sekyng

hastely to clime, fell according to his desart, sodainly and ingloriously, whose Embassage for peace, Lewes the Frenche king, for his mischeuous & bloodie slaughter, so moche abhor-

red, that he would neither see the Embassador, nor heare the Embassage: for he murthered his .ij. nephues, by the handes

The tyme.

The maner

how. of one Iames Tirrell, & .ij. vilaines more associate with him

the Lieutenaunt refusyng so horrible a fact. This was doen

he takyng his waie & progresse to Glocester, whereof he was before tymes Duke: the murther perpetrated, he doubted the good squire knight. Yet to kepe close this horrible murther, he caused a fame and rumour to be spread abroad, in all partes of the realme, that these twoo childrē died sodainly, there-

The cause. by thinkyng the hartes of all people, to bee quietlie setteled,

no heire male lefte a liue of kyng Edwardes children. His mischief was soche, that God shortened his vsurped raigne: he was al together in feare and dread, for he being feared and

dreaded of other, did also feare & dread, neuer quiete of minde

faint harted, his bloodie conscience by outward signes, condē-

pned hym: his iyes in euery place whirlyng and caste about,

The state of

a wicked mā. his hand moche on his Dagger, the infernall furies tormen-

ted him by night, visions and horrible dreames, drewed him from his bedde, his vnquiet life shewed the state of his consci-

ence, his close murther was vttered, frō the hartes of the subiectes: thei called hym openlie, with horrible titles and names, a horrible murtherer, and execrable tiraunt. The peo-

A dolefull

state of a

queene. ple sorowed the death of these twoo babes, the Queene, kyng

Edwardes wife, beeyng in Sanctuarie, was bestraught of witte and sences, sounyng and falling doune to the grounde as dedde, the Quéene after reuiued, knéeled doune, and called on God, to take vengauce on this murtherer. The conscience of the people was so wounded, of the tolleracion of the

The wicked

facte of kyng

Richard, a

horror and

dread to the

commons. facte, that when any blustryng winde, or perilous thonder, or

dreadfull tempest happened: with one voice thei cried out and

quaked, least God would take [vengauce](#) of them, for it is alwaies séen the horrible life of wicked gouernors, bringeth to ruin their kyngdom and people, & also wicked people, the like

daungers to the kyngdome and Prince: well he and his supporters with the Duke of Buckyngham, died shamefullie.

God permit

meanes, to

pull doune

tyrauntes. The knotte of mariage promised, betwene Henrie Erle of

Richemonde, and Elizabeth doughter to kyng Edward the fowerth: caused diuerse nobles to aide and associate this erle,

fledde out of this lande with all power, to the attainmente of the kyngdome by his wife. At Nottyngham newes came to kyng Richard, that the Erle of Richmonde, with a small cōpaignie of nobles and other, was arriued in Wales, forthewith exploratours and spies were sent, who shewed the Erle **Lichefelde.**

Leicester. to be encamped, at the toune of Litchfield, forthwith all pre-

paracion of warre, was set forthe to Leicester on euery side, the Nobles and commons shranke from kyng Richarde, his **Bosworthe[.]** power more and more weakened. By a village called Bos-

worthe, in a greate plaine, méete for twoo battailes: by Lei-

cester this field was pitched, wherin king Richard manfully
fightyng hande to hande, with the Erle of Richmonde, was
Kyng Ri-
chard killed
in Bosworth
fielde. slaine, his bodie caried shamefullie, to the toune of
Leicester
naked, without honor, as he deserued, trussed on a horse, be-
hinde a Purseuaunte of Armes, like a hogge or a Calfe, his
hedde and his armes hangyng on the one side, and his legges
on the other side: caried through mire and durte, to the graie
Friers church, to all men a spectacle, and oprobrie of tiran-
nie this was the cruell tirauntes ende.

¶ A narracion historicall, of the commyng
of Iulius Cesar into Britaine.

The tyme.



The persone. Hen Iulius Cesar had ended his mightie
and huge

battailes, about the flood Rhene, he marched into
the

regiō of Fraunce: at thesame time repairing with a
freshe multitude, his Legiōs, but the chief cause of his warre
in Fraunce was, that of long time, he was moued in minde,

The cause.

**The fame
and glorie of**

Britaine. to see this noble Islande of Britain, whose fame for
nobilitée

was knowen and bruted, not onelie in Rome, but also in the
vttermoste lādes. Iulius Cesar was wroth with thē, because
in his warre sturred in Fraunce, the fearce Britaines aided
the [Fenche](#) men, and did mightilie encounter battaill with
the Romaines: whose prowes and valiaunt fight, slaked the

proude and loftie stomackes of the Romaines, and droue thē

The prowes

of Iulius

Cesar. to diuerse hasardes of battaill. But Cesar as a noble warrier

preferryng nobilitee, and worthinesse of fame, before money or cowardly quietnes: ceased not to enter on y^e fearce Britaines, and thereto prepared his Shippes, the Winter tyme following, that assone as oportunitie of the yere serued, to passe

The maner

how.

Cesars com-

municacion

with the mar[-]

chautes, as

concernyng

the lande of

Britaine. with all power against them. In the meane tyme, Cesar in-

quired of the Marchautes, who with marchaundise had accesse to the Islande: as concernyng the quātitée and bignes of

it, the fashion and maner of the people, their lawes, their order, and kinde of gouernement. As these thynges were in all poinctes, vnknown to Cesar, so also the Marchaūtes knewe

The ware &

politike go-

uernement of

y^e Britaines.

Aliaunce in

tyme traite-

rous. no more thā the places bordring on the sea side. For, the Brit-

taines fearing the traiterous and dissembled hartes of aliaūces, politikelie repelled them: for, no straunger was suffered

to enter from his Shippe, on the lande, but their marchaundice were sold at the sea side. All nacions sought to this land,
the felicitie of it was so greate, whereupon the Grekes knowyng and tastyng the commodité of this Islande, called it by

Britain som-
tyme called of
the Grekes

Olbian, not

Albion. a Greke name *Olbian*, whiche signifieth a happie and fortu-

nate countrie, though of some called *Albion*, tyme chaunged the firste letter, as at this daie, London is called for the toun of kyng Lud. Cesar thereupon before he would marche with

Caius Uo-

luseus, Em[-]

bassadour to

Britaine. his armie, to the people of Britain, he sent Caius Uoluseus

a noble man of Rome, a valiaunte and hardie Capitaine, as Embassadour to the Britaines, who as he thoughte by his Embassage, should knowe the fashion of the Island, the manner of the people, their gouernemente. But as it seemeth, the Embassadour was not welcome. For, he durste not enter frō his Ship, to dooe his maisters Embassage, Cesar knewe no-

Comas A-

trebas, secōde

Embassador

from Cesar. thing by him. Yet Cesar was not so contented, but sent an o-

ther Embassadour, a man of more power, stomack, and more hardie, Comas Atrebas by name, who would enter as an Embassadour, to accomplish the will & expectacion of Cesar,

Comas Atrebas was so welcome, that the Britains cast him

in prison: Embassages was not common among them, nor the courteous vsage of Embassadors knowen. Al these thin-

Cassibelane

king of Lon-

don, at the a-

riue of Cesar[.]

Cassibelane

a worthie

Prince. ges, made Cesar more wrothe, to assaie the vncourtous [Bris\[-\]](#)

[taines](#). In those daies Cassibelan was kyng of London, this Cassibelan was a prince of high wisdom, of manly stomacke

and valiaunt in fight: and for power and valiauntnesse, was chosen of the Britaines, chief gouernour and kyng. Dissension and cruell warre was among thē, through the diuersitie of diuers kinges in the lande. The Troinouaūtes enuied the **Imanuēcius[.]** state of Cassibelan, bicause Immanuencius, who was kyng

of London, before Cassibelan, was put to death, by the counsail of Cassibelan. The sonne of Immanuencius, hearing of the commyng of Cesar, did flie traiterouslie to Cesar: The Troinouauntes fauoured Immanuēcius part, & thereupon

The Troy-

nouauntes by

treason let in

Cesar. promised, as moste vile traitours to their countrie, an ente-

ryng to Cesar, seruice and homage, who through a self will, and priuate fauour of one, sought the ruine of their countrie, and in the ende, their own destruccion. But Cassibelan gaue many ouerthrowes to Cesar, and so mightelie encountred with hym, so inuincible was the parte of Cassibelane: but by treason of the Troinouauntes, not by manhod of Cesars power, enter yng was giuen. What house can stande, where-

Treason a

confusion to
 the mightiest
 dominions. in discord broile? What small power, is not able to
 enter the
 mightiest dominions or regions: to ouercome the strongeste
 fortresse, treason open the gate, treason giuyng passage. Al-
 though Cesar by treason entered, so Cesar writeth. Yet the
 fame of Cesar was more commended, for his enterprise into
 Britain, and victorie: then of all his Conquest, either against
 A sentēce gra[-]
 uen of Bri-
 taine, in the
 commendaci-
 on of Cesar. Pompey, or with any other nacion. For in a Pillar
 at Rome
 this sentence was engrauen: Of all the dominions, Citees,
 and Regions, subdued by Cesar, his warre attēpted against
 the fearce Britaines, passeth all other. After this sort Cesar
 entred our Islande of Britaine by treason.

¶ A narracion iudiciall, out of Theusidides,
 vpon the facte of Themistocles.



He Athenians brought vnder the thraldome of
 the Lacedemonians, soughte meanes to growe
 mightie, and to pull them from the yoke, vnder
 the Lacedemonians. Lacedemonia was a citee
 enuironed with walles. Athenes at thesame
 tyme without walles: whereby their state was more feeble,
 and power weakened. Themistocles a noble Sage, and a
 worthie pere of Athens: gaue the Atheniās counsaile to wall
 their citée strōgly, and so forthwith to be lordes and rulers by
 them selues, after their owne facion gouerning. In finishing
 this enterprise, in all pointes, policie, and wittie conuei-
 aunce wanted not. The Lacedemonians harde of the pur-

pose of the Athenians, & sent Embassadours, to knowe their doynge, and so to hinder them. Themistocles gaue counsaill to the Athenians, to kepe in safe custodie, the Embassadours of Lacedemonia, vntill soche tyme, as he from the Embassage was retourned frō Lacedemonia. The Lacedemonians hearyng of the commyng of Themistocles, thought little of the walle buildyng at Athens. Themistocles was long looked for of thē, because Themistocles lingered in his Embassage, that or the matter were throughly knowen: the walle of Athens should be builded. The slowe commyng of Themistocles, was blamed of the Lacedemonians: but Themistocles excused hymself, partly infirmitie of bodie, lettynge his commyng, and the expectacion of other, accompaigned with hym in this Embassage. The walle ended, necessitie not artificiall workemanship finishing it, with al hast it was ended: then Themistocles entered the Senate of Lacedemonia, and saied: the walle whom ye sought to let, is builded at Athens, ye Lacedemonians, that wee maie be more strong. Then the Lacedemonians could saie nothyng to it, though thei enuied the Athenians state, the walle was builded, and leste thei should shewe violence or crueltie on Themistocles, their Embassabours were at Athens in custodie, whereby Themistocles came safe from his Embassage, and the Athenians made strong by their walle: this was politikely dooen of Themistocles.

¶ A narracion Poeticall vpon a Rose.



Ho so doeth maruaile at the beauté and goodly colour of the redde Rose, he must consider the blood, that came out of Uenus the Goddes foot. The Goddes Uenus, as foolishe Poetes dooe feigne, beyng the aucthour of Loue: loued Adonis the soonne of Cynara kyng of Cypres. But Mars called

the God of battaile, loued Uenus, beyng nothyng loued of Uenus: but Mars loued Uenus as feruently, as Uenus loued Adonis. Mars beyng a God, loued Uenus a goddes, but Uenus onely was inflamed with the loue of Adonis, a mortall man. Their loue was feruent, and extremely set on fire in bothe, but their kinde and nature were contrary, wherevpon Mars beyng in gelousie, sought meanes to destroye, faire amiable, and beautifull Adonis, thinkyng by his death, the loue of Uenus to be slaked: Adonis and Mars fell to fighting Uenus as a louer, ranne to helpe Adonis her louer, and by chaunce she fell into a Rose bushe, and pricked with it her foote, the blood then ran out of her tender foote, did colour the Rose redde: wherevpon the Rose beyng white before, is vpon that cause chaunged into redde.

[¶] *Chria.*



Hria, this profitable exercise of *Rhetorike*, is for the [porfite](#) of it so called: it is a rehearsall in fewe wordes,

of any ones fact, or of the sayng of any man, vpon the whiche an oracion maie be made. As for example, Isocrates did say, that the roote of [learnng](#) was bitter, but the fruites pleasaunt: and vpon this one sentence, you maie dilate a ample and great oracion, obseruyng these notes folowyng. The sayng dooeth containe so greate matter, and minister soche plentie of argumente.

Auchthors intreatyng of this exercise, doe note three sortes to bee of them, one of them a *Chria verball*, that is to saie, a profitable exercise, vpon the sayng of any man, onely conteynyng the wordes of the auchthour, as the sentence before.

The seconde is, conteinyng the facte or deede of the persone: As Diogines beyng asked of Alexander the Greate, if he lacked any thyng, that he was able to giue hym, thinkyng his demaūde vnder his power, for Diogenes was at thesame tyme warmyng hymself in the beames of the Sunne: Diogenes aunswered, ye take awaie that, that ye are not able to giue, meanyng that Alexander by his bodie, shadowed hym, and tooke awaie that, whiche was not in his power to giue, Alexander tourned hymself to his men, and saied, if I were not Alexander, I would be Diogenes.

The thirde is a *Chria* mixt, bothe *verball* and notyng the facte, as Diogenes seyng a boie wanton & dissolute, did strike his teacher with a staffe, vtteryng these woordes: why dooest thou teache thy scholer so dissolutlie.

You shall learne to make this exercise, obseruyng these notes.

Firste, you shall praise the aucthour, who wrote the sentence, waighing his life, if his life be vnknownen, and not easie to finde his sentence or sentences: for godlie preceptes will minister matter of praise, as if these saynges bee recited, thei are sufficient of them selues, to praise the aucthour.

Then in the seconde place, expounde the meanyng of the aucthour in that sayng.

Then shewe the cause, why he spake this sentence.

Then compare the matter, by a contrary.

Then frame a similitude of thesame.

Shewe the like example of some, that spake the like, or did the like.

Then gather the testimonies of more writers of the same[.]

Then knit the conclusion.

¶ An Oracion.

In Socrates did saie, that the roote of learnyng [is](#) was bitter, but the fruites were pleasaunt.

¶ The praise.



His Oratour Isocrates, was an Athenian borne, Lusimachus[.] who florished in the time of Lusimachus the chief gouernor of Athens: this Isocrates was brought vp in all excellēcie of learning, with the moste fa-

Prodicus.

Gorgias Le-

ontinus. mous and excellent Oratour Prodicus, Gorgias Leontinus

indued him with all singularitie of learnyng and eloquence.

The eloquēce of Isocrates was so famous, that Aristotle the

Demosthe-

nes learned

eloquence of

Isocrates. chief [Pholosopher](#), enuied his vertue & praise therin:

Demo-

sthenes also, who emong the Grecians chieflie excelled, learned his eloquence, of the Oracions whiche Isocrates wrote, to many mightie and puisaunt princes and kinges, do shewe his wisdom, & copious eloquēce, as to Demonicus the king

to Nicocles, Euagoras, against Philip the king of the Macedoniās, by his wisdom and counsaill, the Senate and vniuersal state of Athens was ruled, & the commons and multitude thereby in euery part florished: chieflie what counsaill,

what wisdom, what learning might be required, in any man of high fame and excellencie: that fame was abundant[-]

ly in Isocrates, as in all his Oratiōs he is to be praised, so in this sentence, his fame importeth like commendacion.

¶ The exposition.



IN that he saith, the roote of learning is bitter, and the fruites pleasaunt: he signifieth no excellent qua-

All excellencie with labor

is attained. litie or gift, vertue, arte or science can be attained, except paine, labour, diligence, doe plant and sette thesame: but when that noble gift, either learning, or any excellent qualitee, is lodged and reposed in vs, then we gather by painfull labours, greates profite, comforte, delectable pleasures, wealth, glorie, riches, whiche be the fruites of it.

¶ The cause.



AND seyng that of our owne nature, all men are enclined from their tender yeres and infancie, to the ex-

tirpacion of vertue, folowyng with all earnest studie and gréedie, the free passage to vice, and specially children, whose iudgementes and reason, are not of that strengthe, to rule their weake mindes and bodies, therefore, in them chiefly, the roote of learning is bitter, because not onely many yeres thei runne their race, in studie of arte and science. With care and paine also, with greuous chastisement and correcciō, thei are compelled by their teachers and Maisters, to appre-

hende thesame: the parentes no lesse dreaded, in the educaciō of their children, in chastisement and correction, so that by all

**The roote of
learnynge bit-**

ter. meanes, the foundation and roote of all learnynge, in what sort so euer it is, is at the firste vnpleasaunte, sower, and vn-sauerie. To folowe the times and seasons, appoynted for the same, is moste painfull, and in these painfull yeres: other greate pleasures, as the frailtie of youth, and the imbecilitie of nature iudgeth, dooeth passe by, but in miserable state is

**Who is a vn-
fortunate**

childe. that childe, and vnfortunate, that passeth the flower of his youth and tender yeres, instructed with no arte or Science, whiche in tyme to come, shalbe the onelie staie, helpe, the pillar to beare of the sore brent, necessitie, and calamities of life.

**Good educa-
cion the foun-
dacion of the
Romaine**

Empire. Herein the noble Romaines, laied the sure foundation of their mightie dominion, in the describe prouidente, and politike educacion of children: to whom the Grecians gaue, that necessarie bulwarke and [faundacion](#), to set vp all vertue, all arte and science. In Grece no man was knowen, to liue in that common wealth, but that his arte and science, gaue manifest probacion and testimonie, how and after what sorte he liued. The Romaines in like sorte, the sworde and auctoritie of the Magistrate, executyng thesame, did put forthe, and draw to the attainment of learnynge, art or science, all youth

hauyng maturitie and ripenesse to it, and why, because that in a common wealth, where the parentes are vndescrete and foolishe, as in all common wealthes, there are not a few, but many, thei not ponderyng the state of the tyme to come, bringing vp their children without all ciuilitie, vnframed to vertue, ignoraunt of all arte and science: the children of their owne nature, vnbrideled, vntaught, wilfull, and heddie, doe run with free passage to all wickednes, thei fall into al kinde of follie, oppressed with all kinde of calamitie, miserie, and

Euill educa-

cion bringeth

to ruine migh[-]

tie kingdoms[.] vnfortunate chaunces, whiche happen in this life. Nothyng

doeth soner pulle doune a kyngdome, or common wealthe, then the euill and leude educacion of youth, to whom neither substaunce, wealth, riches, nor possessions doe descende, from

their auncestours and parentes, who also of them selues wāt all art, science and meanes, to maintain them to liue, who of them selues are not able to get relief, for onely by this meanes, life is maintained, wealth and riches ar possessed to many greate siegnories, landes, and ample possessions, left by their parentes, and line of auncetours, haue by lacke of vertuous educacion, been brought to naught, thei fell into extreme miserie, pouertie, and wantyng learnyng, or wealth, to maintaine their state and delicate life, thei haue robbed, spoiled, murdered, to liue at their owne will. But then as rotten, dedde, and putride members frō the common wealth thei are cutte of by the sworde, and authoritie of the Magistrate. What kyngdome was more mightie and strong, then **Lydia**. the kyngdome of Lidia, whiche by no other meanes was

brought to ruine and destruccion, but by idlenes: in that thei were kepte from all vertuous exercise, from the studie of artes and sciences, so longe as thei meditated and liued in the

schoole of vertuous life: no nacion was hable to ouerthrowe them, of them selues thei were prone and readie, to practise all

Cyrus. excellencie. But Cyrus the kyng of Persians, by no other

meanes was able to bring them weaker. He toke from thē al furtherance to artes, destroyed all occupaciōs of vertue wher-vpon by commaudemēt [aud](#) terrour, wer driuen to practise

The decay of

a kyngdome. the vaine and pestiferous practise, of Cardes and Dice. Har-

lottes then schooled them, and all vnhoneste pastyme nurtered them, Tauernes an quaffyng houses, was their accustomed and moste frequented vse of occupacion: by this meanes

their nobilitie and strengthe was decaied, and kyngdome made thrall. Ill educacion or idlenes, is no small vice or euill when so mightie a prince, hauyng so large dominions, whō all the Easte serued and obaied. Whose regimente and gouernemente was so infinite, that as Zenophon saieth, tyme

The mightie

dominions of

Cyrus. would rather want, then matter to speake of his mightie and

large gouernement, how many nacions, how diuerse people and valiaunte nacions were in subieccion to hym. If this mightie Prince, with all his power and populous nacions, was not hable to giue the ouerthrowe, to the kyngdome of

Euill educa-

cion. Lidia, but by ill educacion, not by marciall attēptes, sworde

or battaill: but by giuyng them scope and libertie, to dooe as he would. No doubt but that Cyrus sawe, by the like example of other kyngdomes, this onelie pollicie to bee a ruine

Pithagoras. of that kyngdome. Pythagoras the famous and godlie Phi-

philosopher, saved the kyngdome and people of Crotona, their leaving all studie of arte, vertue and science. This people of [Catona](#). Crotona, was overcome of the people of Locrus, they left all

exercise of vertue, neglecting the feates of chivalrie, wherupon

Pythagoras having the profitable and godly lawes of Lycurgus, which he brought from Lacedemonia: and the lawes of Minos kyng of Creta, came to the people of Crotona, and by his godly teaching and Philosophie, reuoked & brought backe the people, given over to the neglecting of all vertue, declaring to them the nobilitie and excellencie thereof, he lively set forth the beastlinesse of vice. Pythagoras recited to

them, the fall and ruine of many regions, and mightie kingdomes, which took after those vices. Idleness being forsaken, vertue embraced, and good occupations practised, the kyngdome and people grew mightie.

Lycurgus. Among the godly lawes of Lycurgus, Lycurgus omitted

not to ordaine Lawes, for the education of youth: in the which he cutte off all pamperyng of them, because in tender yeres, in whose bodies pleasure harboreth, their vertue, science, cunning rooteth not: labour, diligence, and industrie **Vertue.**

Vice. onely rooteth vertue, and excellencie. Vices as vnprofitable

weedes, without labour, diligence and industrie growe up, and thereby infecteth the minde and bodie, poisoneth all the motions, incensed to vertue and singularitie. Who euer attained cunning, in any excellent arte or science, where idleness or pleasure helde the swaie. Philosophie sheweth, **Pleasure.**

Idleness.

Ignorance. sure to bee vnmete for any man of singularitie, for

pleasure,
idlenes, and ignoraunce, are so linked together, that the possession of the one, induceth the other. So many godlie monu-
mētes of learning, had not remained to this posteritie of ours and of all ages: if famous men in those ages and tymes, had hūted after immoderate pleasure. Thindustrie of soche, who left to the posteritie of all ages, the knowlege of Astronomie is knowen: the monumentes of all learnyng of lawes, and of all other woorkes of antiquitie, by vertue, noble, by industrie, labour, and moderacion of life in studie, not by pleasure and wantones, was [celebraied](#) to all ages. The mightie volumes of Philosophers, bothe in morall preceptes, and in naturall causes, knewe not the delicate and dissolute life of these our daies. Palingenius enueighyng against the pāpered, and lasciuious life of man, vttereth a singulare sentēce

*Qui facere et qui nosce, cupit quam plurima et altum,
In terris virtute aliqua sibi querere nomen:
Hunc vigilare opus est, nam non preclara geruntur,
Sertendo, et molles detrectat gloria plumas.*

Who so coueteth to purchase fame by actes, or whose minde hunteth for aboundaunte knowledge, or by vertue in this life, to purchase good fame. He had not nede to slugge and slepe in his doynges: for good fame is not vpholded by gaie Pecoockes feathers. Of this, Demosthenes the famous Oratour of Athens, vttereth a worthie saiying to the Athenians in his Epistle: if any will iudge Alexander the greate, to be famous and happie, in that he had successe in all his do-

Alexander

the great, cō-

mended for

diligence. ynges, let this be his cogitacion, that Alexander the greate,

alwaies did inure hymself to doe thynges, and manfullie to assaie that he enterprised. The felicitie of his successe came to hym not slepyng, or not cogitatyng thereof: Alexander the greate now dedde, Fortune seketh with whom she maie accompanie, and associate her self.

Thusidides comparyng the Lacedemonians, and the Athenians together, shewed a rare moderacion, and temperature of life, to be in the Athenians: wherupon thei are moste commended, and celebrated to the posteritie.

¶ The contrarie.

 Uen as idlenes and a sluggishe life, is moste pleasant to all soche, as neglecte vertuous exercises, and godlie life. So paine, labour, and studie, bestowed and employed, in the sekyng out of vertue, arte, or science is moste pleasaunt to well affected mindes: for no godlie thyng can be attained to, without diligence and labour.

¶ The similitude.

 Uen as housbandmen, with labour and trauaile, dooe labour in plantyng and tillyng the grounde, before thei receiue any fructe of thesame. Euen so no vertue, arte, or science, or any other thyng of excellencie is attained, without diligence and labour bestowed thereto.

¶ The example.

 Et Demosthenes, the famous Oratour of Athenes, bee an example of diligence to vs, who to auoide all let from studie, vsed a meanes to kepe hymself ther-

to: preuentynge also the industrie of artificers. Thesame Demosthenes, wrote seuen tymes out the storie of Thusidides, to learne thereby his eloquence and wisdom.

¶ The testimonie.



Linie, Plato, and Aristotle, with many other mo, are like examples for diligence to vs: who wrote vpon vertue and learnynge like sentences.

¶ The conclusion.



Herefore, Isocrates dooeth pronounce worthelie, the roote of learning and vertue to be bitter, and the frutes pleasaunte.

¶ A Sentence.



He Oracion, whiche must be made by a sentēce
is in al partes like to *Chria*, the profitable exercise, onelie that the Oracion made vpon a sentence, as authours do saie: hath not alwaie the name of the authour prefixed in the praise, a small matter of difference, who so can make the one, is expert and exquisite in the other, authours doe define a sentēce
in this maner. A sentence is an Oracion, in fewe woordes, shewynge a godlie precept of life, exhorting or diswadyng: the
Gnome. Grekes dooe call godly preceptes, by the name of *Gnome*, or
Gnomon, whiche is asmoche to saie, a rule or square, to direct
any thyng by, for by them, the life of manne is framed to all

singularitie. Thei are diuers sortes of sentences, one exhorteth, an other diswadeth, some onely sheweth: there is a sentence simple, compounde, profitable, true, & soche like.

Frame

your Oracion vpon a sentence, as in the Oracion before.

- { 1. The praise of the aucthour.
- { 2. The exposition of the sentence.
- { 3. A confirmacion in the strength of the cause.
- { 4. A conference, of the contrarie.
- { 5. A similitude.
- { 6. The example.
- { 7. The testimonie of aucthors, shewing y^e like.
- { 8. Then adde the conclusion.

¶ An Oracion vpon a sentence.

¶ The sentence.

In a common wealthe or kyngdome, many kynges to beare rule, is verie euill, let there be but one kyng.

¶ The praise of the aucthour.



Omere, who of all the Poetes chiefly excelled, spake this sentence in the persone of Ulisses, vpon the king

Agamemnon, kyng of Grece. This Homere intreating of all princely affaires, and greate enterprices of the Grecians: and of the mightie warre againste the Troians, among whom soche discorde rose, that not onely the warre, for lacke of vnitie and concorde, continued the space of tenne

yeres. But also moche blood shed, hauocke, and destruccion, came vpon the Grecians, vttered this sentēce. This Homere for his learnyng and wisdom remaineth, intteled in many monumentes of learnyng: with greate fame and commen-

The praise of

Homere. dacion to all ages. What Region, Isle, or nacion is not, by

his inuencion set foorth: who although he were blinde, his minde sawe all wisdom, the states of all good kyngdomes

The content

of Homers

bookes. and common wealthes. The verie liuely Image of a Prince

or gouernour, the faithfull and humble obediēce of a subiect, toward the prince, the state of a capitaine, the vertue and noble qualities, that are requisite, in soche a personage, be there

set forth. The perfite state of a wiseman, and politike, is intreated of by hym. The Iustice, and equitie of a Prince, the strength of the bodie, all heroicall vertues: also are set forth his eloquence and verse, floweth in soche sorte, with soche pleasauntnes: so copious, so aboundaunt, so graue and sentencious, that his singularitie therein excelleth, and passeth.

Alexander. The mightie prince Alexander, in all his marciall enter-

prices, and great conquestes, did continually night by night,

The Ilias

of Homere,

mete for prin-

ces to looke

vpon. reade somewhat of the Ilias of the Poete Homere, before he

slepte, and askyng for the booke, saied: giue me my pillowe.

Alexander as it semeth, learned many heroical vertues, policie, wisdom, & counsaill thereof, els he occupied in so migh-

tie and greates warres, would not employed studie therein.

Iulius Cesar the Emperour, commendeth this Poete,
for his singularitie, his commendacion giueth, ample argu-
ment, in this singulare sentence, whiche preferreth a Monar-
chie aboue all states of common wealthes or kyngdome.

¶ The exposition.



Omere the Poete, signified by this one sentence, no
kyngdome or common wealthe can prospere, or flo-
rishe to continue, where many holde gouernement
as kynges. For, the mindes of many rulers and princes, doe
moste affecte a priuate wealthe, commoditie and glorie: and
where, many doe beare soche swaie and dominion, the com-
mon wealth can not be good. For, thei priuatly to theim sel-
ues, doe beare that regiment, and alwaie with the slaughter
of many, do seke to attain and clime, to the whole
[gouermēt](#)[.]

¶ The cause.

The state of
many kinges



in one lande. Any occasions dooe rise, whereby many
princes, and
gouernours in a common wealth, be diuerslie affec-
ted, so that the gouernmēt of many, can not prosper.
For, bothe in quiete state, their counsailes must bee diuerse,
and vncertaine: and where thei so differ, the kyngdome stan-
deth in great ieopardy and daunger. Isocrates intreatyng of
Athenes. a Monarchie, sheweth that the common wealth of
Athenes,
whiche detested and refused, that forme and state, after the
ruine and fall of their citee: beyng vnder the thraldome of
the
Lacedemoniās, bothe in their externall chiuallrie and feates,

bothe by sea and by lande, and also in regimēte otherwise,
their citee grewe mightie, and state stedfast.

Carthage in

a monarchie. The Carthagineans also, gouerned by one, had
their go-

uernment stedfaste, and kyngdome roiall: who in puisaunte
actes, might compare with the noble Romaines. As the obe-
dience to one ruler and chief gouernour, sekyng a common
wealth, is in the hartes of the subiectes: feruent and maruei-
lous with loue embraced, so the Maiestie of hym is dreade,
with loue serued, and with sincere harte, and fidelitie obeied,

The state of

many kinges

in one lande. his maners folowed, his lawes imitated. Many
gouernours

bearyng regiment, as their maners be diuers, and fashion of
life: euen so the people bee like affected, to the diuersitie of di-

uers princes. And if we weigh the reuolucion of the heauens
and the marueiles of God therein, the maker of thesame,
who

A monarchie

in heauen. beyng one God, ruleth heauen and yearth, and all
thynges

cōtained in thesame. The heauen also adorned with many a
One Sunne[.] starre, and cleare light, haue but one Sunne to
gouerne thē:

who being of a singulare vertue aboue the rest, by his vertue
and power, giueth vertue to the reste. Also in small thynges

The Ante.

The Bee. the Ante and the Bee, who for prouidence and
wisedome, ar

moche commended: haue as it were a common wealth, and a
king to gouerne thē, so in all thynges as a confusion, the state
of many kinges is abhorred in gouernmēt. After the death of

Constancius[.]

Licinius[.]

Marabodius[.] Constantinus the greate, Constancius his sonne was made

Emperour, and Licinius with him, partaker in felowship of the Empire. But forthwith, what blood was shed in Italie, with all crueltie, vntill Constancius had slaine Licinius, partaker of the Empire, and Marabodius was slaine also, whom Licinius did associate with hym in the gouernment. So moche princes and chief gouernours, doe hate equalitie,

Pompey.

Cesar.

Marius.

Silla. or felowship in kingdomes. After thesame sort, in this migh-

tie Monarchie of Rome, diuerse haue attempted at one and sondrie tymes, to beare the scepter and regiment therein, but that mightie Monarchie, could not suffer but one gouernor. The kyngdome of Thebes, was in miserable state, the twoo sonnes of Oedipus, Eteocles, and Polunices: striuing bothe

Assiria the

first monar-

chie. to be Monarche, and onely kyng. The kyngdome of Assiria,

whiche was the golden kyngdome, and the first Monarchie: hauyng .36. kynges by succession, continued .1239. yeres, this

kyngdome for all nobilitie and roialnes excelled, and all in a Monarchie. The kyngdome of the Medes, in a Monarchie florished in wealthe and glorie and all felicitie: who in domination had gouernmente .300. lackyng .8. yeres. After that, the

The monar-

chie of the

Medes.

The Persiā.

Macedonia. monarchie of the Medes ceased, the Persiā people

rose migh-

tie, bothe in people and Princes, and continued in that state
236 and 7 monethes. Macedonia rose from a base and meane
people, to beare the whole regiment, and power ouer all
king[-]

domes. So God disposeth the state and seate of princes,
ouer-

throwyng often tymes mightier kyngdomes at his will: the
continuaunce of this Monarchie was .157. and eight mone-

Asia[.]

Siria[.] thes, ten kynges linealie descendyng. Asia and Siria,
was

gouerned by one succedyng in a sole gouernement. Nicanor
gouerned Siria .32. yeres. In the other Antigonus raigned,
Demetrius Poliorchetes one yere, Antiochus Soter also, the
scepter of gouernment, left to the succession of an other,
then

Antiochus Soter, ruled all Asia and Siria, hauyng .16. kin-

Egipte in a

Monarchie[.] ges whiche in a monarchie, cōtinued 189 yeres.

The Egipci-

ans, had famous, wise, and noble princes, whose kyngdome
and large dominion, in all felicitée prospered: whiche was in
the tyme of Ninus, the first king of the Assiriās, who hauing
10. princes, one by one succedyng, Cleopatra their Quéene,
gouerning, stode in a monarchie .288. This one thyng she-
weth, that kinde of gouernmente to bee roiall, and moste fa-
mous, not onely for the felicitée and glory therof: but also
for

the permanent and stedfast state thereof. Aristotle and Plato
setteth forthe, thother formes of gouernmēt. But in all those,
no long cōtinuaunce of felicitée, nor of happy state can
appere

Tirannis[.]

Nero[.]

Domicianus[.]

Caligula. in them, as for the contrarie to a Monarchie, is
tirannis, pe-
stiferous, and to be detested, where one man gouerneth to
his

priuate gaine, pillyng and polyng his subiectes, murderynge
with all crueltie, neither Lawe nor reason, leadynge thereto:
but will bearyng regiment ouer lawe, Iustice and equitee,
whiche princes often tymes see not. How the wilfull rashe-
nes, or tirannicall minde doeth abase them, and make them,
though in vtter porte thesame princes, yet in verie déede,
thei

What doeth

beautifie the

throne of a

Prince[.] bee thrall and slaue to beastlie affeccion. Nothyng
dooeth so

moche adorne and beautifie, the seate and throne of a prince,
as not onely to beare dominion, ouer mightie people and re-
Aristocratia. gions, then to be lorde ouer hymself. The state of
a fewe pée-

res or nobles, to holde the chief and whole gouernment, who
bothe in vertue, learnynge, and experience dooe excelle, is a
goodlie state of common wealth. But the profe of that com-
mon wealthe and ende sheweth, and the maner of Princes:
who, although thei be, of life godlie, wise, graue, expert and
politike. For, these vertues or ornamentes, ought to be repo-
sed in soche noble personages, thei doe marueilously
chaunge

and alter: So honour and preeminente state, puffeth them
vp, and blindeth them, that euerie one in the ende, seeketh to
climbe ouer all, as hed and gouernour. Shewe me one kinde
of this state, and forme of gouernmente, whiche either longe
prospered, or without bloodshed, and destruccion of the rest
of

the nobles and peres, haue not caught the whole regimente.
Seyng that in all common wealthes and kingdomes, equa-

litée or felowshippe, will not be suffred in gouernmente: for, it can not bee, that this forme of common wealthe maie bée

The ende of

Aristocratia. good, as Aristotle and Plato sheweth: The ende of this go-

uernemente, fell euer to one, with a ruine of the kingdome

Politcia. and people. The multitude to beare dominion, and though a

publike wealth bée sought for a tyme, moche lesse thei conti-

nue in any good state: for in the ende, their rule and gouerne-

ment, will be without rule, order, reason, modestie, and their lawe must bee will. The other three states, are the refuse of good common wealthes, not to bée tollerated in any region.

Tirannis. The one of them is a tyraunte, to bée gouernour onely to his

owne glorie, with crueltie tormented his subiectes, onelie to

Oligarthia. haue his will and lust, ouer all lawe, order, and reason. The

nobilitée rulyng to them selues, euery one for his owne time[.]

Democratia. The third, the base and rude multitude, euery one for hym-

self, and at his will. This troublous state, all Regions and

common wealthes, haue felte in open sedicions and tumul-

tes, raised by theim, it is a plagued and pestiferous kinde of

gouernemente. The example of a good Monarchie, is of

greate force, to confounde the state of al other common weal-

thes, and formes of Regimente.

A monarchie

preferred of

the Persians[.] The nobilitée of Persia hauyng no kyng, linially des-

cendyng, to rule that mightie dominion of Persia, Cambises beyng dedde, the vsurper murdered, thei tooke counsaill in their assemble, what state of gouernment was beste, thei hauyng the profe of a Monarchie: in their longe counsaill, thei knewe the felicitie of that state, thei knewe as it seemed, the perilous state of the other gouernmentes. If these noble and peres had been ambitious, and that eche of them would haue had felowshippe, or participacion in kyngdomes: thei would not haue preferred a Monarchie aboue the reste. The antiquitie of that tyme sheweth, their personages, wisdomes, grauitie, and maiestie was soche, that eche one of them was mete for his vertues, to haue a whole kyngdome. If Aristocratia would haue contented them, then was tyme and occasion offerred, no kyng remainyng to haue preferred that state.

The duetie of

al noble peres[.] But thei as vpright nobles, sincere and faithfull, hauyng al-

together respecte to a publique wealthe: to a permanent state and felicitie of kingdome, sought no participacion by priuate wealthe, to dissolue this Monarchie. But thei beyng moste godlie, eche were content to proue, whose chaunce might be, to set vp againe that Monarchie. The kyngdome at the laste **Darius.** came to the handes of Darius, who was after kyng of the

Persians. This is a goodly example, to shewe the worthines of a Monarchie, the Persian kingdome after many yeres declining, from his power and state, not for any faulte of go-

Kyngdomes

rise and fall. uernment, but God as he seeth tyme, raiseth vp kyngdomes

and plucketh them doune. Afterward Darius the kyng, not able to make his parte good with Alexander the Greate: offered to hym the greatest parte of his kyngdome, euen to the flood of Euphrates, and offred his daughter to wife: Alexander was content to take the offer of Darius, so that he would bee seconde to hym, and not equall with hym in kyngdome.

**The answer
of Alexander
to Darius,
as cōcernyng
a monarchie.** For, Alexander saied, that as the worlde can not
bee gouer-
ned with twoo Sunnes, neither the worlde can suffer twoo
mightie kingdomes: wherupon it is manifest, that no king-
dome will suffer equalitie or felowship, but that if the will &
minde of Princes might brust out, the state of all the worlde,
would bee in one mightie gouernours handes. For, alwaies
**Alexāder the
great prefar-
red a Mo-
narchie.** Princes dooe seke to a sole regimente. Alexander the
greate
cōquerour also, preferring for worthines a Monarchie, at the
tyme of his death, demaunded whō he would haue to
succeede
him in his mightie dominiōs, he by one signifyng a Monar-
chie, sayng: *Dignissimus*, that is to saie, the worthiest. After
**Alexanders
monarchie fel
by many kin-
ges.**
**Antipater.
Crates.
Meliagrus.
Perdiccas.
Ptolomeus.
Learcus.
Cassander.
Menander.
Leonatus.
Lusimacus.
Eumenes[.]**

Seleucus. the death of Alexander, Antipater caught the gouernmente

of Macedonia and Grece, and Crates was Treasurer. Meleagrus and Perdiccas caught other of his dominions, then Ptolemeus possessed Egipte, Africa and a parte of Arabia, Learchus, Cassander, Menāder, Leonatus, Lusimachus, Eumenes, Seleucus and manie other, who were for their worthines in honor and estimacion with Alexander, caught into their handes other partes of his dominions, euerie one sekyng for his time, his owne priuate glorie, dignitie, and aduancemente, but not a publike wealthe, and so in fine, ambition broiled in their loftie stomackes, eche to attaine to others honor. Whereupon bloodshed, destruction of the people and countries, the fall of these Princes ensued. So moche kingdomes hate equalitie or felowship: let vs laie before our **Fraunce.**

Spaine.

Germanie.

Britaine. iyes, the kyngdomes nere at hand. Fraunce, from the tymes

of Faramundus vntill this daie haue stooode, and did florishe in a Monarchie. The state of Spaine, from the tyme of the firste kyng, vntill this daie, hath florished continually in a Monarchie. The great seigniories of Germanie, by one succedyng in gouernment, haue been permanent in that goodlie state. Our noble Isle of Britain from Brutus, hath stooode by a Monarchie: onely in those daies, the state of gouernmēt chaunged, at the commyng of Iulius Cesar, Emperour of Rome. The lande beyng at diuision, and discorde, through the diuersitie of diuerse kynges: so moche the state of diuerse

kynges in one lande, is to be expelled, or the gouernment of the base multitude, to haue vniuersally power of dominion, or the state of peres, to bee chief in regiment, no kyng left to

commaunde ouer the people, and nobles, or els there can not

be but discorde in thende, whiche pulleth doune moste
migh-
tie Regions and dominions, so that the beste state, the moste
stedfaste and fortunate, is in all tymes, in all ages, in all la-
wes, and common wealthes, where one king sekynge the ad-
uauncement, wealthe, glorie, of hym and his people.

¶ The contrarie.



Hat housholde or familie, can not be well gouerned,
where many and diuerse beareth gouernment, nec-
lectynge the state prosperous vniuersallie: for where
obedience is drawen to diuers and many, there can not bee
good gouernment, nor faithfull obedience. And so in a king-
dome where one chiefly gouerneth, and to a common wealth
there the hartes of the subiectes, be moste knitte to obaie.

¶ The similitude.



Uen as thei, whiche serue one maister, shall soneste
with labour please, and with fidelitie, accomlishe
his will and pleasure. For, the maners of many mē
be diuerse, and variable, so in a Monarchie, the state of one
is
sone obaied, the minde and lawe of one Prince sone
folowed,
his Maiestie dreaded and loued.

¶ The example.



ET the fower chief Monarchies of the Assirian, the
Persian, Grecian, and the Romaine, whiche haue
continued from the beginnyng mightie, moste hap-
pie, bee an example herein. If that state of gouernement, had

not been chiefe of all other, those mightie kyngdomes would not haue preferred, that kinde of gouernment.

¶ The testimonie of auncient writers.



Herefore, Aristotle, Plato, and all the chief Philosophers, intreatyng of the administracion of a common wealthe: doe preferre before all states of gouernment a Monarchie, bothe for the felicitie of it, and stedfaste state.

¶ The conclusion.

HOmere therefore deserueth greate commendacion, for this one sentence, whiche preferreth a Monarchie before all states.

¶ The destruccion.



His exercise of [*Rhetotike*](#), is called destruccion, or subuersion, because it is in a oracion, a certain reprehension of any thyng declaimed, or dilated, in the whiche by order of art, the declaimer shall procede to caste doune by force, and strengthe of reason, the contrarie induced.

In this exercise of *Rhetorike*, those proposicions are to be subuerted, whiche are not manifeste true, neither it so repugnaunt from reason, as that there can appere no holde, to induce a probable reason to confounde thesame. But soche proposicions are meete for this parte, as are probable in both sides, to induce probabilitie of argument, to reason therupon.

1. It shall behoue you firste, for the entryng of this matter, to adde a reprehension there against those, whiche haue confirmed as a truthe, that, whiche you will confute.
2. In thesame place, adde the [exposicion](#), and meanyng of his sentence.
3. Thirdly, shew the matter to be obscure, that is vncertain[.]
4. [Incrediblie](#).
5. Impossible.
6. Not agreyng to any likelihode of truthe.
7. Uncomlie to be talked of.
8. Unprofitable.

This exercise of *Rhetorike* doeth contain in it al strength of arte, as who should saie, all partes of *Rhetorike*, maie copiously be handled in this parte, called confutacion, so ample a matter Tullie doeth note this parte to be.

¶ The theme or proposicion of this Oracion.

It is not like to be true, that is said of the battaill of Troie.

¶ The reprehension of the author, and of all Poetes.



Ot without a cause, the vanities of Poetes are to bee reprobued, and their forged inuencions to bee reiected: in whose writynges, so manifestlie

are set forth as a truthe, and Chronicled to the posteritie of ages and times, soche forged mat-

The vanities

of Poetes. ters of their Poeticall and vain wittes. Who hath not heard

of their monsterous lies against God, thei inuentyng a genealogie of many Goddes procreated, where as there is but one God. This vanitie also thei haue set forth, in their monumentes and woorkes. How a conspiracie was sometyme among the Goddes and Goddes, to binde the great God Iupiter. How impudentlie doe thei set forth the Goddes, to bee louers of women, and their adulterous luste: and how thei haue transformed them selues, into diuers shapes of beastes and foules, to followe after beastly luste. The malice and enuie of the Goddes, one to an other: [The](#) feigne also the heauē to haue one God, the sea an other, helle an other, whiche are mere vanities, and false imaginaciōs of their Poeticall wittes. The like forged inuencion haue thei wrote, of the migh-

The battaill

of Troie .x.

yeres for a

herlotte. tie and terrible battaill bruted of Troie, for a beautifull har-

lot sustained ten yeres. In the whiche, not onely men and noble péeres, gaue the combate of bataille, but the Goddes toke partes against Goddes, and men wounded Goddes: as their

The vain in-

uention of

Poetes. lies exceade all nomber, because thei bee infinite, so also thei

passe all truthe, reason, and iudgemente. These fewe examples of their vanities and lies, doe shewe the feigned ground and authoritie of the reste. Accordyng to the folie and super-

sticiousnes of those tymes, thei inuented and forged folie vpon folie, lye vpon lye, as in the battaill of Troie, thei aggra-

uate the dolour of the battaill, by pitifull and lamentable in-

Plato reie-

cteth Poetes

from the com[-]

mon wealth. uencion. As for the Poetes them selues, Plato in his booke,

made vpon the administracion of a common wealth, maketh them in the number of those, whiche are to bee banished out of all common wealthes.

¶ The exposition.



Omere dooeth saie, and many other Poetes, that the warres of the Grecians against the Troians, was for beautifull Helena, and continued tenne yeres. The Goddes and Goddis toke partes, and all the people of Grece, aided Menelaus, and the kyng Agamemnon, to bryng home again Helena, neclecting their own countrie, their wife and chidrē, for one womā. The Grekes inuentying a huge and mightie horse made of Firre trée, and couered with brasse, as huge as a moūtain, out of the whiche the Grecians by treason issuynge, brought Troie to ruine.

¶ The obscuritie of the matter.



T semeth a matter of folie, that so many people, so mightie nacions should bee bewitched, to raise so mightie a armie, hassardying their liues, leauyng their countrie, their wiues, their children, for one **Helena.** woman: Be it so, that Helena passed all creatures, and that Nature with beautie had indued her with all vertue, and singularitie: yet the Grecians would not be so foolishe, that vniuersallie thei would seke to caste doune their owne wealthes,

and moche more the common wealthe of Grece, and kyngdome to stande in perill. Neither is it to be thought, the Grecians, sekyng to aduaūce the beautie of Helena: would leaue

The cause of

the forged in-

uencion. their owne state. But it is like, the wittes of Poetes did im-

agine so forged a Chronicle, that the posteritie of ages following, should rather wounder at their forged inuencion, then to beleue any soche warre truly mencioned. There was no soche cause, seyng that the kyngdome of Grece, fell by no

title of succession to Helena, for them to moue warre, for, the

bringyng backe of that beutifull harlotte Helena. Neither in Helena was there vertue, or honestie of life, to moue and exasperate the Grecians, to spende so greate treasures, to raise

No commen-

dacion in vp-

holdyng and

maintainyng

of harlottes. so mightie an armie on euery side. What commēdacion had

the Troians to aduaunce Helena, and with all roialnesse to entreate her, she beyng a harlotte: the folie of the Grecians and the Troians, is so on euery side so greate, that it can not be thought, soche a warre truely chronicled. If violence and power, had taken Helena from her housebande, and not her

Helena follo-

wed Paris. owne will and luste, caught with the adulterous loue of Pa-

ris, beyng a straunger. If her moderacion of life had been so rare, as that the like facte for her chastitie, had not been in any age or common wealthe, her vertues would haue giuen occasion: The Princes and nobles of Grece to stomacke the matter. The example of the facte, would with all praise and

**Uertuous
life, worthie
commendaci-
on in al ages.**

**Lucrecia.
Tarquinius
the kyng ba-
nished for ra-
uishyng Lu-
crecia, and all
of his name**

banished. commendacion be mencioned, and celebrated to al
ages. Lu-
cretia for her chastite, is perpetuallie to be aduanunced,
wher-

vpon the Romaines banished Tarquinius their kyng, his
stocke and name from Rome. The rare chastite of Penelope,
is remainyng as a example herein: So many snares laied to
caste doune her vertuous loue towarde her housebande U-
lisses. But Ulisses made hauocke by murder, on these gaie
and gallante Ruffins, who in his absence sought to alienate
and withdrawe, the chaste harte of Penelope, consumyng

Penelopes

chastitie. his substance. A greater example remaineth in no
age, of the

like chastite. As for the battaile of Troie, raised for Helena,
could wise men, and the moste famous nobles of Grece: So
occupie their heddes, and in thesame, bothe to hasarde their
liues for a beautifull strumpet or harlot. The sage and wise

Nestor.

Ulisses. Nestor, whom Agamemnon for wisdom preferred,
before

the moste of the péeres of Grece, neither it Ulisses wanted at
thesame tyme, hauyng a politike and subtyll hedde, to with-
drawe them from so leude and foolishe a enterprise. Grece

Grece the

lande of faire

women. wanted not beautifull creatures, Nature in other had besto-

wed amiable faces, personage, and comelie behauour. For, at those daies, Grece thei called *Achaida calligunaica*, that is,

Grece the lande of faire women. The dolorous lamentacion of the Ladies and Matrons in Grece, would haue hindered soche a foolishe enterprise, seyng their owne beautie neclected, their honestie of life caste vp to perilles, one harlot of in-

Uncomelie. numerable people followed and hunted after, in whom neither

honestie, vertue, nor chastite was harbored.

¶ Uncredible.



Lthough the folie of men is greate, and the will of princes and gouernours beastlie and rashe, yet by no meanes it can be so many yeres, so greate folie to take roote in their hartes, and that the wisdom

Beautie

without ver-

tue, nothyng

of valour. of the Greciās, should not rather caste of as naught, the beau-

tie of Helena: rather then the whole multitude, the state of the Prince, the welfare of the subiecte, to stande in perill for

Beautie a

poison, in a

adulterous

mynde. the beautie of one. What is beautie, when a beastlie and ad-

ulterous minde is possessed: Beautie without chastitie, harboreth a monstrous rabelmente of vices, a snare and baite,

Beautie sone

fadeth. to poison other. Beautie in fewe yeres, is not onely
blemi-

shed, but decaied, and wholie extinguished: it is vncredible,
that the Grecians would seeke to bryng home Helena, who
had loste the chaste loue toward her housband, beyng caught

Paris Hele-

nas louer.

Phrigia. with the adulterous loue of Paris, soonne to Priamus
kyng

of Troie. The lande of Phrigia was a mightie Region, the
people noble, puissaunte in warre: the kyng for nobilitie of
actes famous. The Citee of Troie, wherein the kyng helde
his Scepter of gouernement, was riche, mightie, and popu-
lous: ruled and gouerned, by the wisdomes and policie of fa-
mous counsailours, so that by all meanes it is vncredible,

Uncomelie. without any possibilitie. Thei neclectyng their
owne state

and kyngdō, so to preferre the beautie of one, that the whole
multitude of Grece thereby to perishe. It is a matter vncre-

Grece the

fountain of al

learnynge. dible in all Grece, whiche for the fame of wisdomes,
is moste

celebrated among all nacions, not one wiseman at thesame
tyme to be therein: whose counsaile and politike heddes,
might

ponder a better purpose. Grece, whiche was the mother and
fountaine of all artes and sciences, all Eloquence, Philoso-
phie, wisdomes flowyng from them, and yet wisdomes to
want in their breastes. Reason can not make any perswasion
that any probabilitie can rise, of any soche matter enterpri-
sed, what could the intent be of the Grecians, as concerning

Menelaus

housbande to

Helena. Menelaus. In Menelaus there was no wisdom, to

seke and

hunte after Helena, or by any meanes to possesse her, she be-

ying a harlotte, her loue alienated, her hart possessed with the loue of an other manne: foolishlie he hopeth to possesse loue,

Harlottes

loue dissem-

bled. that seeketh to enioye the cloked, poisoned, and dissembled

harte of a harlotte, Grece was well ridde of a harlotte, Troie Troians. harbouryng Helena. In the Troians it is not to be thought,

that either the kyng, or nobles, for a harlotte, would see the [the](#) people murthered, their owne state, the king to be in danger of ruine. In the Grecians there was neither wisdom,

neither commendacion, to pursue with a maine hoste, with a greate Nauie of Shippes, to bryng backe againe a harlotte, whose enterprise rather might better bee borne, to banishe & exile soche a beastlie disposed persone. The Troians mighte Absurditie. well scorne the Grecians, if that the possession of a beautifull

moste amiable, and minsyng harlotte, was of soche valour, estimacion, and price with them, not onely the beautie of all other to bee reiected. But moste of all the vertuous life, and chastitie of all their matrons and honourable Ladies, to bee caste of as naught. Grece that had the name of all wisdom,

The defence

of Helena. of all learnyng and singularitie, might rather worthelie bee

called, a harbouryng place of harlottes: a Stewe and vpholder of whoredome, and all vncleanes. Wherefore, these absurdities ought to bee remoued, from the minde and cogitation of all menne, that should worthelie ponder the state of

Troie a king[-]

dome of whor[-]

dome. Grece. Troie of like sorte to bee a kyngdome and common

wealthe of all vice: whoredome in soche price with the kyng, and people, that moste fortunate should the harlotte bee, and the adulterour in soche a common wealthe, that for adulterous loue, putteth rather all their state to hasarde and perill, for the maintenaunce of beastlie loue, brutishe societie moste

in price with soche a nacion, chastitie, and moderaciou of life, abandoned and caste of.

¶ Impossible, and not agreyng.

Nature ab-

horreth the

warre of the



Grecians. F wee weigh naturall affeccion, it can not bee, that

the Grecians so moche abhorring frō nature, should cast of the naturall loue of their wives, their children and countrie, to bryng home againe, by slaughter of infinite people: soche an one as had left honestie, and chaste loue of her housbande. For, what praise can redounde to the Greci-
Helena. ans by warre, to bryng home Helena, though she of all crea-

tures was moste beautifull, beyng a harlotte: followyng the bridell and will of an other man. Maie shame or commendacion rise to the Troians, can wisdom, counsaile, or grauitie,

Priamus. defende the adulterous luste of Priamus soonne, yea, could

Priamus so loue Helena, for Paris his sonnes sake, as that he had rather venter the ruine and destruccion of his citée,

and

the falle of his people, the murder and ruine of his children, and wife for the beautie of one. For what is beautie, where honestie and vertue lacketh, it is an vncomly matter, though the Poetes so faigne it, not onely that in heauen, a contenciō should fall emong the Goddises of their beautie, or that Iupiter of whom thei make an ignoraunt God, to chuse Paris the kynges sonne of Troie, chief arbitratour & Iudge of that matter, to whō he should giue the goldē Apell to her beautie, as chief of al other, was ascribed these thynges, are vndecent to thinke of the Goddeses, and moste of all, to thinke there is more Goddes then one. And euen as these are vanities, and forged imaginacions of the Goddes, so of the battaile.

¶ Uncomelie and vnprofitable.



HE daunger of many people doeth shewe, that no soche thyng should happen, either of the Grecians or of the Troians: for, it is a matter dissonaunt frō all truthe, that thei should so moche neclecte the quiete state, and prosperous renoume of their kyngdome, in all tymes and ages, since the firste constitucion of all Monarchies and kyngdomes. Who euer harde soche a forged matter to be Chronicled, and set forthe. Or who can giue credite to soche warre, to be enterprised of so small a matter: to leaue

the state of waightier thynges for one woman. All the women of that countrie to stande in perill, the slaughter of their deare housbandes, the violent murder of their children to insue. Therefore, the wilfulnesse of people and princes, are the cause of the falle and destruccion, of many mightie kyngdomes, and Empires. The fall of Grece ensued, when the chief **Ambicion.**

Cesar fell by

ambicion. citées, Athenes and Lacedemonie tooke partes, and

did con-

federate diuers citees to them, to assiste theim, and aide them

in battaile onely: ambicion and desire of glorie, moued bothe **Discorde.** the Athenians and Lacedemonians, frō concorde and vnitie

by whiche meanes, the power, glory, and strēgth of all king-
Pompey. domes falleth. Ambicion was the cause that mightie Pom-

pey fell, and died violently. Cesar likewise caught with ambicion, not bearyng the equalité, or superioritie of Pompei, was tourned of violentlie frō Fortunes whéele. Many princes of like sorte and kingdomes. By ambicion onely, had the cause of their ruine. The glorie of the Assirian Monarchie grewe moste mightie, by the ambicion of Ninus kyng of Babilon: the ofspring of Ninus, whiche were kynges line-allie descendyng to the firste kyngdome of the Medes, bothe enlarged their kyngdomes, and also had the decaie of them by ambicion. Let the Medes also associate them selues to thē,

from Arbactus the first kyng, vnto Astiages the laste: the beginnyng and falle of the Persian Monarchie. The mightie

Romulus kill[-]

led Remus

by **ambicion.** state of Grece, the seate Imperiall of Rome, by ambiciō first

extolled them selues: and also by it, their glorie, scepter, and

kyngdome was translated, but the falle of Troie came not, by ambicion, that the Grecians sought. But as the Poetes doe faigne, the beautie of one woman so wounded their hartes, that the Grecians did hasarde, the perilles of their countrie. The Troians so moche esteemed, the beautie of Helena, as that the state of all their kyngdome perished. It was no glorie nor honour to the Grecians, to resiste by armour, and to defende the violente takyng awaie of Helena, from her

housbande: nor it was no honour, the Grecians to pursue by armour, the takynge awaie of Helena, beyng a harlotte. So that by no meanes it can followe, these thynges to bee true, of the battaile of Troie.

¶ Confirmacion.

The other part, contrary to destruccion or subuersion, is called confirmacion.

Confirmacion, hath in it so greate force of argumente, to stablishe and vpholde the cause or proposicion: as destruccion hath in castyng doune the sentence or proposicion.

Confirmacion is a certain oracion, whiche with a certain reprehension of the persone or facte, by order and waie of art, casteth doune, the contrary propounded.

As in the other parte called destruccion, those propositions are to bee subuerted, whiche are not manyfestlie true, with all other notes before specified: so in contrariwise, this oracion by contrary notes is declaimed by, as for example.

1. It shall behoue you first, for the entring of the oracion, to induce a reprehension againste those, whiche haue confuted as a truthe, that whiche you will confirme.
2. In the seconde parte, place the exposicion and meanyng of the aucthours sentence.
3. Shewe the matter to be manifest.
4. Credible.

5. [Possible](#).
6. Agreyng to the truthe.
7. Shewe the facte comelie.
8. Profitable.

This exercise of [Rhetotike](#), doeth contain in it all strēgh of arte, as who should saie, all partes of *Rhetorike* maie copiously be handled in this parte, called confirmacion. You maie as matter riseth, ioigne twoo notes together, as the reason of the argumente cometh in place, whiche Athonius a Greke aucthour herein vseth. As manifest and credible, possible and agreyng to truthe, comelie and profitable, but in all these, as in all the reste: the theme or proposicion by it self, is to be placed, the reprehension of the aucthour by it self, the exposition of the theme by it self.

¶ The theme or proposicion.



T is true that is saied of Zopyrus, the noble Persian, who vētered his life: & did cause the deformitie of his bodie, for the sauegarde of this countrie.

¶ The praise.



Iustinus. Ustinus the Historiographer, for worthinesse of fame and wisdom, deserueth in the posteritie of all tymes, immortall fame, by whom the famous actes of Princes, and other noble

Chronicles

moste neces-

sary to be red. men, doe remaine Chronicled. Giuyng exam-

ples of all valiauntnesse and vertue: for, bothe the actes and worthie feactes of Princes, would passe as vnknownen in all ages, excepte the worthinesse of them, were in monumentes of writyng Chronicled. For, by the fame of their worthines, and vertues, cōmon wealthes and kyngdomes, doe stablishe and make Lawes, the hartes of people are incensed, and inflamed, to the like nobilitie of actes, and famous enter-

The worthi-

nesse of histo-

ries. prices, Histories of auncient tymes, bee vnto vs witnesses of

all tymes and ages, of kyngdomes and common wealthes, a liuely example. A light to all truthe and knowlege, a schole-

What is a hi-

storie. maister: of maners a memorie of life, for, by it we se the wise-

dom of all ages, the forme of the beste and flourishing common

wealthes. We learne by the vertues of Princes and gouernours, to followe like steppe of vertue: to flie and auoide vices, and all soche thynges, as are to the destruccion and de-

An ignorant

life, a brutish

life. caie, of realme and countrie. How brutishe wer our life, if we

knewe no more then we se presently, in the state of our common wealthe and kyngdome. The kyngdomes of all Princes and common wealthes that now flourisheth, doe stande by the longe experience, wisdom, pollicy, counsaile, and godlie lawes of Princes of auncient times, no smal praise and

The know-

lege of Histo-

ries maketh

vs as it were

liuyng in all

ages.

Historiogri-

phers. commendation can be attributed, to all suche as doe trauell

in the serching out the veritie of auncient Histories, for bi the

knowledge of them, we are as it were liuyng in all ages, the fall of all kyngdomes is manifeste to vs, the death of Princes, the subuersions of kingdomes and common wealthes, who knoweth not the first risynge & ende of the Assiriane mo-

narchie, the glorie of the Persians, and the ruyng of the same, the mightie Empire of the Grekes, risynge & fallynge, the Romane state after what sorte florishynge and decayng, so that no state of common wealth or kyngdome is vnknown to vs, therefore Iustine, and all suche as doe leue to the posteritie, the state of al things chronicled, deserue immortal commendacions.

¶ The exposition.

The treason

of the Assy-



rians. In the time of Darius kyng of the Persians, the

Assyriāns who were subiects to him, sence the time

of Cirus the firste kyng of the Persians, rebelled, inuaded and toke the myghtie Citie of Babi-

lon, whiche beyng possessed, with much difficultie, and not **Darius**. withoute greates daungers coulde bee attained. Darius the

kyng hearyng of the treason of the Assyrians and that the

Babilon ta-

ken of the As-

syrrians. mightie Citie of Babilon was taken, was very wroth

wai-

ynge with him selfe, that there by, the ruyne of the Persian kyngdome mighte happen. Zopyrus one of the .vij. noble Peres of Persia, seing the daunger of the countrie, the state of the Prince, and the welfare of the subiectes to decaie, in the

safegarde of his countrie, leuyng all priuate commoditie, for the behoufe and felicitie of the Persian kyngdome, did ven-

The fact of

Zopyrus. ter his owne life, commaunded his seruauntes at home to

teare and rēte his bodie with whippes, to cut of his nose, his lippes and his eares, these thinges being vnknownen to Darius the kyng. As sone as Darius sawe Zopyrus so torne

Zopyrus cau[-]

sed the defor-

mitie of his

bodie, for the

good state of

his countrie. and deformed, bewailed his state being astonished, at so hor-

rible a faict: but Zopyrus shewed to the kyng his hole intente and purpose that he mynded to go to Babylon, whiche the Assyrians dyd traitorouslie possesse, & complained as that

these things had ben don by the tyrannie and crueltie of Darius, he wēt to Babilon, and there complained of the crueltie of his kyng, whereby purchasyng the fauor and loue of the Assyrians, he shewed them how Darius came to be kyng not by worthines, not by vertue, not by the common consent of men, but by the neynge of a horse. Zopyrus therefore admonished them, that they should trust more to their armour,

The pollicie

of Zopyrus. then to their walles, he willed them to proclame opē warre,

forthwith they encountred with the Persians, and for a time

victorie fel on the Babilonians side, suche was the pollice of Zopyrus. The Assyrians reioised of the successe and felicitie of their warres, the king of the Babilonians gaue to Zopyrus, the chiefe power & office, to leede a mightie armie, of the
whiche beyng Lieutenaunt, he betraied the Babilonians and their Citie.

¶ Manifeste.

Trogus Pō[-]



peius. Ot onlie Trogus Pompeius the famous Historiographer, and Iustine which tooke the Story of him, but also the Greke writers doe sette forthe, as matter of truthe, the valiaunte enterprises of Zopyrus: so that the straunge and mightie facte of him can not seme vncredible, **Zopyrus.** hauyng testimonie of it in all ages. Zopyrus hauing not respect to his owne life, to his owne priuate wealthe or glorie, did thereby put of the daunger that insued to the Persiane kyngdome: It maie seme a greate matter, to a mynde not well affected towarde his cuntrye, to destroie or deforme his
The saiyng
of Tullie. owne bodie, for the sauegarde of cuntrye or common welth.
But if we waie the State of oure bearth, oure cuntrye chalengeth more at oure handes then frindes or parentes, so
Plato.
Aristotel. mucche price Plato the Philosopher, and Aristotle doe attri-
bute vnto our cuntrye, the volumes of all lawes and bokes doe prefare oure naturall cuntrye before the priuate state of
The state of
a publike

wealthe, is to
bee preferred
before a pri-
uate wealth.

Pericles. owne manne, wealthe, glorie, honor, dignitie, and riches of

one or fewe, the Statutes of all Princes, sekyng the glorie of their countrie, doe prefare a vniuersal welthe, before a pri-

uate and particulare commoditie. Pericles the noble Athenian in his oration made to the Athenians, sheweth that the glorie and welthe of one man or manie, cannot plante suche glorie, and renowne to their countrie, as that in all partes thereby to be beautified and decorated, but whē glorie a happie and florishyng state redoundeth to the kyngdome, the subiectes, the nobelles and hye peres, the gouernour standeth happie and fortunate. Who so hopeth in sparing costes and charges, monie or ornaments, to the behouf and imploiment of his countrie and not by all meanes to his power and strength aydeth and defendeth his naturall countrie, from

A good sub-

iecte is redie

to liue and

die for his

countrie. the daunger and inuasion of his enemye, what state inioyeth

he, or what wealth remaineth priuatlie, when the trone and scepter of his kyng faileth, the enemye wasteth, spoileth and destroyeth all partes of his state, with the reste his life perisheth, so that no daunger, coste, is to bee refused, to serue the kingdom and prince, by whose scepter, iustice, lawes, and

equitie we are gouerned, there is no subiect well affected, but that he onlie liueth to proffite his countrie, to liue & dye therein.

¶ Probabell.



F only Zopyrus had enterprised this valiaunt act, and that no memorie were remainyng in anie age of the noble acts of other men, it may seme not true-

lie chronacled, but from time to time, in all ages & cōmon wealthes, famous men for their acts & nobilitie haue ben, whiche with like courage and magnanimitie haue sa-

Horacius Co[-]

cles. ued their countrie, by the losse of their owne liues.
Horatius

Cocles is bothe a witnesse and a light to the same, by whose aduenture the mightie and stronge Citie Rome was saued: For at what time as the Hetruscians entred on the citie, and were on the bridge, Horatius cocles defendid the ende of the same, baryng of the brunte, and stroke of the enemye, vntill the Romans, for the sauegarde of the cytie, had broken doun the bridge, as sone as Horatius Cocles sawe the Cytie thus deliuered, and the repulse of the enemye, he lepte with his armours into the flud Tibar, it semed he had not regard to his life, that beyng burdened with the waighte and grauitie of his armour, durst venter his life to so main and depe a water.

Marcus

Attilius. Marcus Attilius in the defence of his Prince, his right hand

being cut of, the which he laide on the ship of the Massilians,

forthwith he apprehended with the lefte hand, and ceased not **Cynegerus.** vntill he hadde soouncke thesame ship. Cynegerus the Athe-

nian [lineth](#) by fame and like nobilitie of actes, vēteryng his life for his countrie. The mightie cytie of Athenes, brought

Hismenias.

Thrasibulus[.] vnder the dominions of the Lacedemonians.

Thrasibulus,
Hismenias and Lisias bi their aduenture, and noble atchiue
reduced Athenes to his felicitie so moche loue, soo faithfull
hartes they hadde towards theire countreie. Leonides the
King of the Lacedemonians, defendyng the narrow straights
of the cytie Thermopolie with fower thousand men against
the mightie and huge armie of Xerxes, for Xerxes
contemned

Leonides

kyng of the

Lacedemo-

nians. theire smalle number and armie: Leonides the kyng
hearde

that the place and hill of the battell was preuētid of .xx.
thou-

sande enemies, he exorted his souldiours parte of them to
de-

parte vntill a better time might be locked for, and onlie with
the Lacedemonians he proued the conflicte and the combate,
although the campe of Xerxes was mightier & more in num-
ber: yet Leonides the kyng thought it good for the sauegarde
of his contrie, for saieth he, I must rather saue it, then to
haue

respecte to my life, although the oracle of Delphos had fore-
shewed, that euen Leonides muste die in the fielde or battell
of the enemye, and therefore Leonides entred battail, & com-
fortid his men for their countrie sake, as to die therein, there-
fore he preuented the narrowe straightes of the countrie, and
the dangerous places, where the force of the enemye mought
bruste in, he lingered not, leste the enemye mighte compasse
him in, but in the quiet season of the nighte, he set vppon his
enemye vnlooked for, and they beyng but sixe hundred men
Leonides. with the kyng Leonides, brust into the cāpe of their
enemies

beyng sixe hundred thousand menne, their valiauntnes was
suche, and the [ouerthowe](#) of their enemies so great, and Xer-

xes the kyng hauyng two woundes, retired with shame and
Agesilaus.

Conon. loste the honor. Agesilaus and Conon valiaunte in
actes,

and excellynge in all nobilitie, what great and mightie dan-
gers haue thei atchiued and venterid for their countrie sake,
howe moche haue thei neglectid their owne wealth, riches,
life and glorie, for the aduauncement and honor of their coū-

Lisander. trie. Lisander also the Lacedemonian, was indued
with like

nobilitie with faithfull and syncéer harte towarde his coun-
Archidamus[.]

Codrus. try. Archidamus also lieth not in obliuiō, whose fame
death

buried not the famous aduenture of Codrus kyng of the A-
thenians is maruelous and almoste incredible, but that the
Histores, truelie set forth, and declare a manifest truthe ther-

[Epamniun-](#)

[das.](#) of, who is more famous then Epaminundas, bothe for
vir-

tue, nobilitie and marciall feates among the Thebans, the
Grecians. mightie armie of the Grecians, at the longe sege of
Troie,

what valiaunte Capitains hadde thei, whiche in the defence
Troians. of their countrie hasarde their life: the Troians also
wanted

not for proues valiauntnes and al nobilitie, their péeres and
Romans. nobles: amonge the Romans, what a greate number
was

of noble peres, whose studie alwaies was to liue and dye in
the glorie, aide and defence of their countrie, for he liueth
not

by whose cowardlines fainted harte and courage, the contrie

Who liueth in

shame. or kyngdome standeth in perrill, he liueth in shame,
that re-

fuseth daunger, coste or charge, in the defence or procuring, better state to his countrie. The worthie sayng of Epaminundas declareth, who liueth to his countrie, who dyng valiauntlie in the felde, beyng thrust thorow with the speare of his enemie, asked those questions of these that stoede by him

at the poincte of deathe, is my speare manfullie broken, and my enemies chassed awaie, the whiche things his cōpanions

Epameunn-

das a most no[-]

ble and vali-

aunt pere. in warre affirmed, then saide he: nowe your Capitaine Epa-

minundas beginneth to liue in that he dieth valiauntlie for his countrie, and in the proffite & aduauncement of the same,

a worthie man, noble and valiaunte, his sentence also was worthie to be knowen, and followed of all suche as bee well affected and Godlie mynded to their countrie. Marcus Marcellus of like sorte, and Titus Manlius Torquatus, & Scipio Aemilianus, Marcus Attilius shewed in what hye price our naturall countrée ought to bee had, by their valiaunt atchifes, and enterprises: I might passe by in silēce Scipio Cato, and Publius Scipio Nasica, but that thei by like fame, honour and glorie liue immortall to their countrie, the same also of Uibeus, Ualerius Flaccus, and Pedanius Centurio giueth ampell and large matter to all menne, endued with nobilitie and valiaunt proues, for the defence of their countrie with Quintus Coccus, Marcus Sceua and Sceuola.

¶ Possibilitie.



Here nedeth no doute to rise of possibilitie, seinge that examples doe remain of famous men, of god-

lie and well affected persones, whiche haue with
like magnanimitie putte in daunger their life, to

The order of

Athenes. saue their Prince, kyngdome, and countrie. Greate
honour

was giuen of the Athenians, to soche noble and valiaunte
men, whiche ventured their liues for their common wealthe,
to maintaine the florishyng state thereof. The eloquente and

Thusidides. copious oracion of Thusidides, the true, faithfull,
and elo-

quente Historiographer doeth shewe: what honour and im-
mortall fame was attributed, to all soche as did venter their
liues, in the florishyng state of their countrie, in supportyng,
mainteinyng, and defendyng thesame. Who, although thei
lost their liues, whiche by death should bee dissolued, their
fame neuer buried, liueth with the soule to immortalitie, the
losse of their Priuate wealthe, glorie, riches, substaunce, or
dignitie, hath purchased and obtained fame, that withereth
not, and glorie that faileth not.

¶ Agreyng and comelie.



Othe the true Histories, doe leaue in commenda-
cion, the facte of Zopyrus, and the noble and wor-

thie enterprises of other: whiche haue giuen the
like assaie, and their fame is celebrated and titeled
with immortall commendacion and glorie, to the posteritie

The duetie

of all good

subjectes. of all ages followyng. What harte can bee so stonie,
or bru-

tishly affected, that wil not venter his life, goodes, landes, or
possessions: if with the daunger of one, that is of hymself, the

whole bodie and state of his countrie, is thereby supported, and saued. What securitie and quietnesse remained, what wealth, honour, or fame to Zopyrus: if not onely Zopyrus had perished, but the kyng & people vniuersally had been de-

stroied. Therevpon Zopyrus weighing and cōsideryng, the

The cause of

our birthe. state of his birthe, that his countrie chalenged his life, rather

then the dissolucion of the whole kyngdome, the decaie of the

Prince, the takyng awaie of the scepter, the slaughter of infinite people to ensue. He was borne to be a profitable member to his countrie, a glorie and staie to thesame: and not spa-

ryng his life, or shunnyng the greate deformitie of his bodie, to bee a ruine of thesame. Was it not better that one perished, then by the securitie of one, a whole lande ouer runned, as partes thereby spoiled: it was the duetie of Zopirus, to take vpon hym that greate and famous enterprise. It was also comelie, the kyngdome standyng in perill, a sage and descrite persone to preuente and putte of, soche a daunger at

The facte of

Zopyrus. hande: The faicte altogether sheweth all vertue and greate

singularitie, and a rare moderacion of minde, to cast of all re-

spectes and excuses, forsakyng presentlie honour, quietnesse and obiecting himself to perill, he sawe if he onelie died, or by

ieopardie saued his countrie, many thereby liued, the kyngdome & people florished, where otherwise, he with his Prince

and kyngdome might haue perished.

¶ Proffitable.

The fact of



Zopyrus. L the power of the Babilonians, was by his pol-
icie throwen doune, the Citee taken, the enemye brought to confusion: on the other side, the Persians rose mightie, soche a mightie enemye put vnderfoote. The fame of Zopyrus and glorie of the facte, will neuer be obliterated, or put out of memorie, if this were not profitable to the kyngdome of Persia: if this were not a re-
Zopyrus de-
formed, a
beautie of his
countrie. noume to the prince and people, and immortall glory to [Zo-](#)
[pryus](#) iudge ye. Zopyrus therfore, beautified his countrée, by the deformitie of his bodie. Better it wer to haue many soche deformed bodies, then the whole state of the realme destroyed
or brought to naught: if we weigh the magnanimitie of that man, and his enterprise, there is so moche honour in the fact, that his fame shall neuer cease.

¶ A common place.

Why it is cal-

led a common



place. Common place is a Oracion, dilatyng and ampli-
fiyng good or euill, whiche is incidente or lodged in any man. This Oracion is called a common place, because the matter contained in it, doeth agree vniuersally to all menne, whiche are partakers of it, and giltye of thesame[.]

A Oracion framed againste a certaine Thefe, Extorcio-
ner, Murderer, or Traitor, is for the matter contained in it,
metelie and aptlie compiled, against all soche as are giltye of
theft, murder, treason, or spotted with any other wickednes.

This oracion of a common place, is like to the laste argu-
ment or *Epilogus* of any oracion, whiche the Grekes doe call
Deuterologian, whiche is as moche to saie, as a rehearsall of
that whiche is spoken of before.

Wherefore, a common place hath no *exhordium*, or be-
ginnyng, yet neuerthesse, for the profite and exercise of
the
learner, you maie place soche a *proemium*, or beginnyng of
the oracion, as maie be easie to induce the learner.

This parte of *Rhetorike* is large to intreate vpon, for the
aboundaunce of matter.

[This part of *Rhetorike* is large to intreate vpon, for the
aboundaunce of matter.](#)

The common place, whiche Aphthonius intreateth of, is
to be aplyed against any man, for the declaimor to inuade, ei-
ther against vices, or to extoll and amplifie his vertues.

This oracion of a common place, serueth bothe for the ac-
cuser and the defender.

For the accuser, to exasperate and moue the Iudges or
hearers, against the offender, or accused.

For the defendour to replie, and with all force & strength
of matter, to mollifie and appease the perturbacions of the
Iudges and hearers, to pulle doune and deface the contrarie
alledged.

There is greate force in this oracion, on bothe the sides.

Properlie this kinde of *Rhetorike*, is called a common place, though it semeth to be made againste this man, or that man: because the matter of thesame shall properly pertain to all, giltye of thesame matter.

Pristianus. Pristianus sheweth, that this parte of *Rhetorike*, is as it were a certaine exaggeracion of reason, to induce a manifest probacion of any thyng committed.

As for example, a Theife taken in a robberie, in whom neither shamefastnesse, nor sparcke of grace appereth against soche a one: this oracion maie be made, to exasperate the Iudges from all fauour or affeccion of pitie, to be shewed.

¶ The order of the Oracion followeth with these notes to be made by.

¶ The firste Proheme.



Emosthenes the famous Orator of Athenes in his oraciō made against Aristogitō doeth saie,

What are

Lawes. that Lawes wherewith a common wealthe, ci-

tie or Region is gouerned, are the gifte of God, a profitable Discipline among men, a restraint to with holde and kepe backe, the wilfull, rashe, and beastilie

Aristotle.

Plato. life of man, and therupō Aristotle and Plato doe shewe, that

through the wicked behauour of men, good lawes were first ordained, for, of ill maners, saie thei, rose good lawes, where **Order.** lawes doe cease, and good order faileth, there the life of man

will growe, rude, wild and beestlie: Man beyng a chiefe crea-

Man borne

by nature to

societee. ture [or](#) God, indued with manie singuler vertues, is framed

of nature to a mutuall and Godlie societie of life, without the whiche moste horrible wolde the life bee, for not onlie by

concorde and agremente, the life of man dothe consiste but al

things on the earth haue therin their being: the heauens and lightes conteined in the same, haue a perpetuall harmonie & concete in finishyng their appointed race. The elementes

All thinges

beyng on the

yearth, dooe

consiste by a

harmonie or

concorde. of the worlde, where with the nature and substaunce of all

thinges, doe consiste onlie by a harmonie and temperature of eche parte, haue their abidyng increase & prosperous beyng, otherwise their substaunce, perisheth and nature in all partes decaieth: Kyngdomes and common wealthes doe consiste in a harmonie, so long as vertue and all singularitie tempereth their state and gouernemente, and eche member thereof obe-ieth his function, office and callynge, and as partes of the-same bodie, euerie one as nature hath ordained them occu-piying, their rouse and place, the vse of euerie parte, all to the

vse and preseruacion of the hole bodie, and as in the bodie so

in the common wealthe, the like concorde of life oughte to be

in euery part, the moste principall parte accordyng to his di-

gnitie of office, as moste principall to gouerne thother inferi-
or partes: and it thei as partes moste principal of thesame bo-
die with all moderacion and equabilitie tēperyng their state,

Order con-

serueth com-

mon wealth. office and calling. The meanest parte accordyng to
his lowe

state, applyng hym selfe to obeie and serue the moste prin-
cipall: wherein the perfecte and absolute, frame of common
wealthe or kyngdome is erected. And seyng that as the Phi-
losophers doe saie, of ill maners came good lawes, that is to
saie, the wicked and beastlie life of man, their iniurius beha-
uiour, sekyng to frame themselues from men to beastes mo-

Euil maners

was the occa-

sion of good

Lawes. ued the wise and Godlie, elders to ordaine certaine
meanes,

to rote discipline, whereby the wickedlie disposed persone
should bee compelled to liue in order, to obeie Godlie lawes,
to the vpholdyng of societie. Therefore, all suche as dissolve
lawes, caste doune good order, and state of common wealth,
out as putride and vnprofitable weedes, to be extirpated and
plucked vp from Citie and Common wealthe, from societie,
who by mischeuous attemptes seke, to extinguishe societie,
amitie, and concord in life. Princes & gouernors with al
other

magistrates ought in their gouernment to imitate the prac-
tise of the Phisician, the nature of man, [wekedned](#) and made
feble with to moche abundaunce of yll humors, or ouermoch
with ill bloode replenished, to purge and euacuate that, and
all to the preseruacion and healthe of the whole bodie: for so
was the manyng of the Philosopher, intreatyng of the po-
litike, gouernment of kingdome and commonwealth, when

Theiues not

mete to be in

any societie. thei compared a kingdome to the bodie of man:
the thefe and
robber as a euill and vnprofitable member, and all other as
without all right, order, lawe, equitie and iustice, doe breake
societie of life, bothe against lawe and nature: possessing the
goodes of a other man, are to bee cutte of, as no partes,
méete
to remaine in any societie.

¶ The seconde Proheme.

Why theiues
and wicked
men, are cut



of by lawe. He chifest cause that moued gouernours
and ma-
gistrates, to cutte of the race of theues, and
violēte
robbers, and of all other mischeuous persons, was
that by them a confusion would ensue in al states.
What Citee could stande in prosperous state, yea, or what
house priuatlie inhabited, where lawes and auctoritee were
exiled: where violence, will, luste, and appetite of
pestiferous
men, might without terrour bee practised. If the labour and
industrie of the godlie, should be alwaie a praie to ye
wicked,
and eche mannes violence and iniurious dealyng, his owne
lawe, the beaste in his state, would bee lesse brutishe and in-
iurious. Who so seketh to caste doune this sociétée, he is not
méete to be of any sociétée, whiche he dissolueth. Who so
rob-
beth or stealeth, to liue by the gooddes of an other manne, as
his possession, is by violence and againste Nature: so by vio-

A due rewar[-]

des for thie-

ues and mur-

therers. lence and against nature, their pestiferous doinges do frame

their confusion: their execrable & [destetable](#) purpose, do make

them a outcaste from all good people, and as no members thereof, cut of from all societée, their euill life rooteth perpetu-

al ignomie and shame. And thus is the tragicall ende of their enterprise.

¶ The contrarie.



Democratia. Erein the lose and dissolute state of gouernmente called of the Grekes Democratia, haue contented the wilfull heddes of pestiferous men: wherein euery man must bee a ruler. Their owne will is their Lawe: there luste setteth order, no Magistrate, but euery one to hymself a Magistrate. All thynges in common, as long as that state doeth remain among the wicked, a most happie state coumpted, a wished state to idell persones, but it

The thiefe.

The mur-

therer. continueth not. Herein the murtherer, the thiefe were meete

to be placed. The greater thiefe, the better manne: the moste execrable murtherer, a moste mete persone, for soche state of

gouernemente. There is no nacion vnder the Sunne, but that one tyme or other, this troublous state hath molested them: and many haue sought to sette vp soche a monstrous

state of regiment, a plagued common wealthe, and to be detested. Soche was the order of men, when thei liued without lawes. When the whole multitude were scattered, no citee, Toune, or house builded or inhabited, but through beastlie maners, beastlie dispersed, liued wilde and beastlie. But the wise, sage, and politike heddes reduced by wisdom, into

Houses.

Families.

Tounes.

Citees. a societie of life, nature leadyng thereto: Houses and habitations,

were then for necessitie made, families multiplied, villages and Tounes populouslie increased, and Citees raised

among so infinite people. Nature by God inuented and stablished Lawe, and the sage and wise persones, pronounced and gaue sentence vpon Lawes. Whereupon, by the obedience of lawes, and preeminente authoritie of Magistrates: The state of mightie Kyngdomes and Common wealthes, haue growen to soche a roialnesse and loftie state, many famous kingdomes haue been on the face of the yearth: many noble Princes from tyme to tyme succedyng, whiche with-

Obedience of

Lawes did

stabilishe the

mightie mo-

narchies. out a order of godlie lawes, could not haue continued. What

was the cause that the mightie Monarchies, continued many hundred yeres: did the losse of dissolute life of subiectes and Princes, cause thesame but good lawes, and obedience to orders. Therefore, where Magistrates, bothe in life and office,

The life of

the Magi-

strate, a lawe[.] liue in the obedience of Lawes: the multitude

inferiour, by
example of the Magistrates singularitie, incensed dooe place
before them, their example of life, as a strong lawe.

The Epistle
of [Theodosi-](#)

[uus](#) Empe-

ror of Rome[.] Theodosius Emperor of Rome, writyng to
Uolusianus

his chief Pretor, as concernyng his office, in these woordes,
saith: *Digna vox est maiestate regnantis legibus alligatum*
se

principem profiteri. Adeo de autoritate Iuris nostra pendet
autoritas et reuera maius imperio est submittere legibus
prin[-]

cipatum & oraculo presentis edicti quod nobis licere non pa-
timur alijs indicamus. It is a worthie sayyng, and meete for
the Maiestie of a Prince, to acknowledge hymself vnder his
lawe. For, our auctoritie, power, and sworde, doeth
depende

vpon the force, might, and auctoritie of Lawes, and it pas-
seth all power and auctoritie, his gouernemente and kyng-
dome to be tempered by lawe, as a moste inuiolable Oracle
and decree, so to doe as we [prouulgate](#) to other. Whereupon
it is manifeste, what force godlie lawes gaue to the Prince,
what auctoritie. Take lawes awaie, all order of states fai-

Princes

Lawe. leth, the Prince by Lawe, is a terrour to the
malefactour: his

Maiestie is with all humblenesse serued, feared, and obeied.
By lawes, his state maketh hym as a God, emong menne, at
whose handes the preseruacion of eche one, of house, citee
and

countrie is sought. Seing bothe lawes and the Prince, [hane](#)
that honour and strength, that without them, a *Chaos* a con-
fusion would followe, in the bodie of all common wealthes

and kyngdomes. Let them by auctoritie and lawe bee confounded, that practise to subuerte auctoritie, to neclecte the Prince, and his godlie lawes.

¶ The exposition.

**Theiues and
all iniurious**



persones. He theife, or any other iniurious persone, doeth seke to bee aboute all lawes, exempted from all order,

vn-

der no obedience, their pestiferous dealyng, dooe vt-

Demosthe-

nes in Ari-

stogiton. ter thesame: For, as Demosthenes the famous Orator of A-

thenes doeth saie. If that wicked men cease not their violēce if that good men in all quietnes and securitie, can not enioye their owne [goddess](#), while lawe and auctoritie of the magistrate, seuerelie and sharply vseth his auctoritie and sword. If dailie the heddes of wicked men, cease not to subuerte lawes, orders, and decrees godlie appoincted. Whiles that in all Citees and common wealthes, the Princes and gouer-

The force of

lawes. nours, are by lawes a terror to them. Lawes then ceasyng,

the dreadfull sentēce of the Iudge and Magistrate wanting.

The sworde vndrawen, all order confounded, what a confusion would followe: yea, what an open passage would bee lefte open to all wickednesse. The terrour of Lawes, the sworde and auctoritie of the Magestrate, depresseth and put[-]

teth doune, the bloodie cogitacions of the wicked, and so hin-

dereth and cutteth of, many horrible and bloodie enterprises.
Els there would bee neither Prince, Lawe, nor subiecte, no
hedde or Magistrate: but euery manne his owne hedde, his
owne lawe and Magistrate, oppression and violence should
bee lawe, and reason, and wilfull luste would bee in place of
reason, might, force, and power, should ende the case.
Where-

fore, soche as no lawe, no order, nor reason, will driue [lo](#)
liue

as members in a common wealthe, to serue in their functiō.

Wicked men

burdeins of

the yearth. Thei are as Homere calleth [the:m](#), burdeins to the
yearth,

for thei are of no societie linked with Nature, who through
wickednesse are disseuered, abhorryng concorde of life,
socie-

tie and felowship. Whom sinister and bitter stormes of for-
tune, doe daiely vexe and moleste, who in the defence of
their

Maimed sol-

diours muste

be prouided

for. countrie are maimed, and thereby their arte and science,
for,

imbecilitie not practised, all art otherwise wantyng, extreme
pouertee fallyng on them, reason muste moue, and induce all
hartes, to pitée chieflie their state: who in defence and main-
teinaunce of our Countrie, Prince, and to the vpholdyng of
our priuate wealthe at home, are become debilitated, defor-
med and maimed, els their miseries will driue them to soche
hedlesse aduentures, that it maie bee saied, as it was saied to

The saiyng

of a souldiour

to Alexander

the greate. Alexander the Greate. Thy warres, O Prince,

maketh many theues, and peace will one daie hang them vp. Wherein the Grecians, as Thusidides noteth, had a carefull prouidence, for all soche as in the defence of their Countrey were maimed, yea, euen for their wiues, and children of all soche, as died in warre, to be maintained of the commō charge and threasure of Grece. Reade his Oracion in the seconde booke, made vpon the funerall of the dedde soldiours.

¶ A comparison of vices.

The drūkarde[.]

**The proude
persone.**

The prodigall[.]

**The couei-
teous.**



The robber. He dronkarde in his state is beastlie, the proude and arrogante persone odious, the riotous and prodigall persone to be contempned, the coueitous and nigardlie manne to bee reiected. But who so by violence, taketh awaie the goodes of an other man, or by any subtile meanes, iniustlie possesseth thesame, is detestable, with all seueritée to be punished. The

**The adul-
terer.**

The harlot. adulterer and the harlotte, who by brutishe behauour, leude affection, not godlines leadyng thereto: who by their vnchast behauior, and wanton life doe pollute, and cōtamine their bodie, in whom a pure minde ought to be reposed. Who thorowe beastly affeccion, are by euill maners transformed to beastes: and as moche as in them lieth, multiplieng a bru-

The homi-

cide. tishe societie. The homicide in his state more horrible,
accor-
dyng to his outrageous and bloodie life, is to bee tormented,
in like sort all other vices, accordyng to their mischiues, rea-
son, Lawe and Iustice, must temper and aggrauate due re-
ward, and sentence to them.

¶ The sentence.

Thefte horri-
ble amōg the



Scitheans. O vice was more greuouse, and horrible
emong
the Scythians then thefte, for this was their sai-
yng: *Quid saluum esse poterit si licet furari,*
what
can be safe, if thefte bee lefull or tolerated. Herein

A sentence a-

genst thefte. the vniuersalle societée of life is caste doune,
hereby a confu-
sion groweth, and a subuersion in all states immediatlie fol-
loweth, equitee, iustice, and all sincere dealyng is abaundo-
ned, violence extirpateth vertue, and auctoritie is cutte of.

¶ The digression.



HE facte in other maie be with more facilitée to-
lerated, in that to theim selues, the facte and con-
uersacion of life is moste pernicious, and hurtfull,
but by soche kinde of menne, whole kyngdomes
and common wealthes would bee ouerthrowen. And for a
prosperous state and common wealthe, a common woe and
Horrible vi-
ces. calamitée would fall on them, tumultes and vprores
main-

tained, right and lawe exiled: neither in field quietnes, welth or riches, houses spoiled, families extinguished, in all places sedicion, warre for peace, violence for right, will and lust for Userers. lawe, a hedlesse order in all states. And as concernyng Usurers, though their gaines be neuer so ample, and plentiful, to enriche them, whereby thei growe to be lordes, ouer many thousandes of poundes: yet the wealthe gotten by it, is so iniurious, that thei are a greate plague, to all partes of the cōmon wealthe: so many daungers and mischiues, riseth of thē[.]

Cato the noble and wise Senator of Rome, being demaunded diuers questions, what was firste to bee sought, in a familie or housholde, the aunsweres not likyng the demaun-

The sentence

of Cato against vsurers.

Usure is murder[-]

ther. der: this question was asked, O Cato, what sentēce giue you

of Usurie, that is a goodlie matter to bee enriched by. Then Cato aunswered in fewe woordes. *Quid hominem occidere.* What saie you to be a murderer? Soche a thyng saieth he, is Usurie. A brief sentence againste Usurers, but wittely pronounced from the mouth of a godlie, sage, noble, and descrite

persone, whiche sentence let the Usurer, ioigne to his Usury retourned, and repeate at the retourne thereof, this sentence

The sentence

of Cato against vsurers.

of Cato, I haue murdered. This one sentence will discour-

age any Usurer, knowyng hymself a murderer. Though moche more maie be spoken against it, this shalbe sufficient.

The Hebrues calleth Usurie, by the name of *Shecke*, that is a bityng gaine, of the whiche many haue been so bitten, that whole families haue been deuoured, & beggerie haue been their gaine. And as Palingenius noteth.

Debitor aufugiens portat cum fænore sortem.

The debtour often tymes saieth he, runneth awaie, and carieth with hym, the debte and gaines of the Usurie. The Grekes calleth Usurie *Tokos*, that is properlie the trauaile of women of their childe: soche is their Usurie, a daungerous gettyng. Demosthenes likeneth their state as thus, as if terrestriall thynges should be aboue the starres: and the heauē Usure a dangerous [gaue](#). and celestialle bodies, gouerned by the base and lowe terrestriall matters, whiche by no meanes, can conserue the excellencie of them, for, of them onely, is their matter, substaūce and nature conserued.

¶ Exclusion of mercie.



Herefore, to whom regimente and gouernement is committed, on whose administracion, the frame of the cōmon wealth doe staie it self: thei ought with al wisdom and moderacion, to procede in soche causes, whose office in

WOR-

Princes and

magistrates

be as Gods

on the earth. thinesse of state, and dignitée, maketh thē as Goddes on the

yearth, at whose mouthes for wisdom, counsaill, and fortunate state, infinite people doe depende. It is no smal thing

in that their sword & auctorité, doeth sette or determine all thinges, that tendereth a prosperous state, whereupon with all intégrité and équité, thei ought to temper the affecciions of their mynde: and accordyng to the horrible facte, and mischiues of the wicked, to exasperate & agrauate their terrible iudgemente, and to extirpate from the yearth, soche as be of

The homicide.

The Theue.

The Adulterer.

no societie in life. The bloodie homicide, the thief, the adul-

terer, for by these all vertue is rooted out, all godlie societie extinguished, citees, realmes, and countrées, prostrate & plagued for the toleracion of their factes, against soch frendship in iudgemente muste cease, and accordyng to the state of the cause, equitee to retaine frendship, money muste not blinde, nor rewardes to force and temper Iudgementes: but accordyng to the veritee of the cause, to adde a conclusion. Wor-

Whey the pi-

ctures of ma-

gistrates bee

picturid with-

oute handes. thelie the pictures of Princes, Gouvernours and Magistrates

in auncient tymes doe shewe this, where the antiquité maketh them without handes, therein it sheweth their office, and iudgemente to proceade with équité, rewardes not to blind, or suppress the sincerité of the cause. Magistrates not

to bee bounde to giftes, nor rewardes to rule their sentence.

Alciatus in his booke called *Emblemata, in senatū sancti principis*.

Princes and

magistrates

graue & con-
stante.

*Effigies manibus trunc[ae] ante altaria diuum
Hic resident, quarum lumine capta prior
Signa potestatis summ[ae], sanctiq[ue] senatus,
Thebanis fuerant ista reperta viris.
Cur resident? Quia mente graues decet esse quieta
Iuridicos, animo nec variare leui.
Cur sine sunt manibus? Capiant ne xenia, nec se
Pollicitis flecti muneribus ve sinant.
Cecus est princeps quod solis auribus, absq[ue]
Affectu constans iussa senatus agit.*

Where vertue and integritée sheweth it self, in the persone
and cause, to vpholde and maintein thesame. Roote out hor-
rible vices from common wealthe, that the more surer and
stronge foundation of vertue maie be laied: for, that onelie
cause, the scepter of kinges, the office of magistrates was
left
to the posteritée of all ages.

¶ Lawfull and iuste.

[¶ Lawfull and iust.](#)

Lawes giue
equitie to all



states. Eyng that lawes bee godlie, and vniuersally
thei
temper equitée to all states, and giue according to
iustice, euery man his owne: he violateth vertue,
that dispossesseth an other manne of his own, and

What driueth
y^e magistrate
to horrible

sentence a-

gainst wicked

persons. wholie extinguisheth Iustice. And thereupon his beastly life

by merite forceth and driueth, lawe and Magistrate, to terrible iudgement. For, who so against right, without order, or lawe, violateth an other man, soche a one, lawes of iustice, muste punishe violentlie, and extirpate from societée, beyng a dissoluer of societee.

¶ Profitable.



F soche wicked persones be restrained, and seuerelie punished, horrible vices will be rooted out: all artes[,]

sciences, and godlie occupacions maintained, vpholled and kept. Then there must bée a securitée in all states, to Magistrate.

Subiect. practise godlines, a mutuall concorde. The Magistrate with

equitée, the subiecte with faithful and humble obedience, accomplishyng his state, office, and callyng. Whereupon by good Magistrates, and good subiectes, the common wealthe and kyngdom is in happie state stablished. For, in these twoo **Plato.** poinctes, as Plato doeth saie, there is vertuous rule, and like

obedience.

¶ Easie and possible.

The begyn-

nyng of vice



is to be cut [af](#). L this maie easely be doen, when wickednes is cutte

of, in his firste groweth, when the magistrate driueth

continually, by sworde and auctorité, all menne to obedience, bothe of lawes and [gouvernuurs](#). Then in al good common wealthes, vices are neuer tolerated to take roote: be-
cause the beginnyng and increase of vices, is sone pulled vp, his monsterous kyngdome thereby ouerthrowen.

¶ The conclusion.

SO doyng, happie shall the kyng be, happie kyngdome, and moste fortunate people.

¶ The parte of Rhetorike, called praise.

[His](#) Oracion, which is titeled praise, is a declamaciō
of the vertuous or good qualités, propertees
belon-
gyng to any thyng, whiche doeth procede by
certaine
notes of arte.

All thynges that maie be seen, with the iye of man, touched, or with any other sence apprehended: that maie be prai-
sed, or dispraised.

{ Manne.	Citees.	}
{ Fisshe.	Floodes.	}
{ Foule.	Castles.	}
{ Beaste.	Toures.	}
As { Orchardes.	Gardeins.	}
{ Stones.	Stones.	}
{ Trees.	Artes.	}
{ Plantes.	Sciences.	}
{ Mettals.		}

Any vertue maie be praised, as wisdom, rightuousnes[,]
fortitude, magnanimitée, temperaunce, liberalité, with all
other.

These are to be celebrated with praise.

The persone, as Iulius Cesar, Octavius Augustus,
Hieremie, Tullie, Cato, Demosthenes.

Thynges, as rightuousnes, temperaunce.

Tymes, as the Spryng tyme of the yere, Sommer, Har-
uest, Winter.

Places, as Hauens, Orchardes, Gardeins, Toures,
Castles, Temples, Islandes.

Beastes wantyng reason, as Horse, Shepe, Oxen[,] Plā-
ntes, as Uines, Oliues.

In the praise of vertue, this maie be saied.

THe excellencies of it, the antiquitee and originall be-
ginnyng thereof, the profite that riseth to any region
by it, as no kyngdome can consist without vertue,
and to extoll the same, in makyng a comparison, with other
giftes of nature, or with other giftes of fortune, more infe-
riour or base.

Wherein the
praise of a ci-
tie consisteth[.] Upon a citée, praise maie be recited,
consideryng the good-
lie situacion of it, as of Paris, Uenice, London, Yorke: con-
sideryng the fertilitie of the lande, the wealthe and aboun-
daunce, the noble and famous [goueruours](#), whiche haue go-
uerned thesame. The first aucthors and builders of thesame,
the politike lawes, and godlie statutes therein mainteined:
The felicitée of the people, their maners, their valeaunt pro-
wes and hardines. The buildyng and ornatures of thesame,
with Castles, Toures, Hauens, Floodes, Temples: as if a
manne would celebrate with praise. The olde, famous, and
The praise of
London.
Brutus buil[-]
ded Londō in
the .x. yeare of
his raine. aunciente Citée of London, shewyng the auncient
buildyng
of thesame: the commyng of Brutus, who was the firste au-
thor and erector of thesame. As Romulus was of the migh-
tie Citée Rome, what kyngs haue frō tyme to tyme, lineal-
ly descended, and succeded, bearing croune and scepter there-
in: the valiauntnes of the people, what terror thei haue been
to all forraine nacions. What victories thei haue in battaile
obteined, how diuers nacions haue sought their amitée and
Fraunce and
Scotlande
vpholded by
y^e gouernors
of this lande. league. The false Scottes, and Frenche menne
truce brea-
kers: many and sonderie tymes, losyng their honour in the
field, and yet thei, through the puissaunt harte of the kynges

of this lande, vpholdyd and saued, from the mighte and force
Cambridge.

Oxforde. of other enemies inuadyng theim. The twoo famous
Uni-
uersités of this lande, from the whiche, no small number of
greate learned men and famous, haue in the cōmon wealthe
sprong, with all other thynges to it.

The praise of a Kyng, Prince, Duke, Erle, Lorde, Ba-
ron, Squire, or of any other man be maie declaimed of
obser[-]
uing the order of this parte of *Rhetorike*.

This parte of *Rhetorike* called praise, is either a particu-
ler praise of one, as of kyng Henry the fifte, Plato, Tullie,
Demosthenes, Cyrus, Darius, Alexander the greate.

Or a generalle and vniuersalle praise, as the praise of all
the Britaines: or of all the citezeins of London.

¶ The order to make this Oracion, is thus declared.

Firste, for the enterying of the matter, you shall place a
exordium, or beginnyng.

The seconde place, you shall bryng to his praise, *Genus
eius*, that is to saie: Of what kinde he came of, whiche
dooeth
consiste in fower poinctes.

- { Of what nacion. }
- { Of what countrée. }
- { Of what auncetours. }
- { Of what parentes. }

After that you shall declare, his educacion: the educacion
is contained in thrée poinctes.

{ Institucion. }
In { Arte. }
{ Lawes. }

Then put there to that, whiche is the chief grounde of al praise: his actes doen, whiche doe procede out of the giftes, and excellencies of the minde, as the fortitude of the mynde, wisdom, and magnanimité.

Of the bodie, as a beautifull face, amiable countenance[,] swiftnesse, the might and strength of thesame.

The excellencies of fortune, as his dignité, power, authoritee, riches, substaunce, frendes.

In the fift place vse a comparison, wherein that whiche you praise, maie be aduanced to the vttermoste.

Last of all, vse the *Epilogus*, or conclusion.

- ¶ The example of the Oracion.
- ¶ The praise of Epaminundas.



IN whom nature hath powred singuler giftes, in whom vertue, & singularité, in famous enterprises aboundeth: whose glorie & renoume, rooteth to the posterité, immortall commendacion. In the graue, their vertues and godlie
Obluion. life, tasteth not of Obluion, whiche at the length ouerthroweth all creatures, Citées, and regions. Thei liue onelie in all ages, whose vertues spreadeth fame and noble enterpri-
Who liue in
all ages. ses, by vertue rooteth immortalité. Who so liueth, as that his good fame after death ceaseth not, nor death with the bodie cutteth of their memorie of life: Soche not onely in life,

but also in death are moste fortunate. In death all honor, di-

Good fame

chiefly rou-

teth after

death. gnitée, glorie, wealthe, riches, are taken from vs: The fame

and glorie of singulare life is then, chiefly takyng his holde and roote, wise men and godlie, in life, knowen famous, after death, remain moste worthie & glorious. Who knoweth

Tullie.

Demosthe-

nes.

Iulius Ce-

sar.

Octavius

Augustus.

Uespasianus[.]

Theodosius.

Traianus.

Adrianus. not of Tullie, the famous Oratour of Rome. Doeth De-

mosthenes lieth hidden, that noble Oratour of Athenes. Is not y^e fame of Iulius Cesar, Octavius Augustus remainyng of Uespasianus: of Theodosius, of Traianus, of Adrianus, who by praise minded, be left to the ende of al ages. Soche a one was this Epaminundas, the famous Duke of Thebe, whose vertues gaue hym honour in life, and famous enterprises, immortalitée of fame after death. What can bee saied more, in the praise and commendacion, of any peere of estate,

then was saied in the praise of Epaminundas, for his vertues were so singulare, that it was doubted, he beyng so good

a manne, and so good a Magistrate, whether he were better manne, or better Magistrate: whose vertues were so vnited, that vertue alwaies tempered his enterprises, his loftie state

as fortune oftentimes blindeth, did not make hym vnmind-
full of his state. No doubt, but that in all common wealthes,
famous gouernours haue been, but in all those, the moste
parte haue not been soche, that all so good men, and so good
magistrates: that it is doubted, whether thei were better mē,

Good man,

good magi-

strate, boothe

a good man

and a good

magistrate. or better magistrates. It is a rare thyng to be a good
manne,

but a more difficult matter, to bee a good Magistrate: and
moste of all, to be bothe a good man, and a good Magistrate.
Honour and preeminent state, doeth sometyme induce obli-
uion, whereupon thei ought the more vigilantlie to wade:
in all causes, and with all moderacion, to temper their pree-

The saiynge

of the Philo-

sophers. minent state. The Philosophers pondering the brickle
and

slippere state of fortune, did pronounce this sentence:
Diffici-

lius est res aduersas pati, quam fortunam eflantem ferre, it is
more easie to beare sharpe and extreme pouertie, then to rule
and moderate fortune, because that the wisest menne of all
Obliuion. haue as Chronicles doe shewe, felte this obliuion,
that their

maners haue been so chaunged, as that natures molde in thē
had ben altered or nuelie framed, in the life of Epaminūdas
moderacion and vertue, so gouerned his state, that he was a
honor and renowne to his state, nothing can be more ample
in his praise, then that which is lefte Chronicled of him.

[¶] Of his countrie.



Paminundas was borne in Thebe a famous citie in
Cadmus.

Amphion.

Hercules. Beotia, the which Cadmus the sone of Agenor build-
ded, whiche Amphion did close & enuiron with wal-
les, in the whiche the mightie and valiaunt Hercules was
borne, & manie noble Princes helde therin scepter, the which
Citie is tituled famous to the posterity by the noble govern-
ment of Epaminundas.

¶ Of his auncetours.



Paminundas came not of anie highe nobilitie or
blood, but his parentes were honeste and verteous
who as it semed were verie well affected to vertue,
instructyng their soonne in all singulare and good
qualities, for by good and vertuous life and famous enter-
prises from a meane state, manie haue bene extolled to beare
scepter, or to attaine greate honour, for as there is a begyn-

Nobility rose

by vertue. nyng of nobilitie, so there is an ende, by vertue and
famous

actes towarde the common wealthe, nobilite first rose. The
Cesar.

Scipio. stock of Cesar and Cesars was exalted from a meaner
state,

by vertue onelie to nobilitie. Scipios stocke was not alwais
noble, but his vertues graffed nobilitie to the posteritie of
his line and ofspryng followynge. And euen so as their fa-
mous enterprises excelled, nobilite in theim also increased.

Catilina. Catilina wicked, was of a noble house, but he
degenerated

from the nobilitie of his auncestours, the vertues that graf-
fed nobilitie in his auncestors, were first extinguished in Ca-

Marcus

Antonius. iline. Marcus Antonius was a noble Emperour, a Prince

indued with all wisdom and Godlie governmēt, who was of a noble parētage, it what a wicked sonne succeeded him, the

Commodus. father was not so godlie, wise, and vertuous, as Commo-

dus was wickedlie disposed and pestiferous. There was no vertue or excellence, méete for suche a personage, but that Marcus attained to. Who for wisdom was called Marcus Philosophus, in his sonne what vice was thē that he practised not, belie chier, druncknes and harlottes, was his delite, his crueltie and bluddie life was suche that he murdered all the godlie and wise Senatours, had in price with Marcus **Seuerus.** his father. Seuerus in like maner, was a noble and famous

Emperor, in the Senate moste graue, politike, and in his

Marcus

Antonius

Caracalla. warres moste fortunate, but in his sonne Marcus Antoni-

nus Caracalla, what wickednes wanted, whose beastlie life is rather to be put in silence, then spoken of. In the assemble of the Grecians, gathered to consulte vpon the contencion of **Ajax.**

Ulysses. Achilles armour, Ajax gloriouslie aduanceth hymself of his

auncetrie, from many kinges descended, whom Ulysses his aduersarie aunswered: makynge a long and eloquente Oracion, before the noble péeres of Grece, concernyng Ajax his auncetours. These are his woordes.

*Nam genus et proauos et que non fecimus ipsi,
Vix ea nostra voco, sed enim quia retulit Ajax,
esse Iouis pronepos.*

As for our parentage, and line of auncetours, long before vs, and noble actes of theirs: as we our selues haue not doen the like, how can we call, and title their actes to be ours. Let them therefore, whiche haue descended from noble blood, and

famous auncetours: bee like affected to all nobilitéé of their auncetours, what can thei glory in the nobilitéé of their auncetours. Well, their auncetours haue laied the foundation, **Nobilitée.** and renoume of nobilitee to their ofspr yng. What nobilitee

is founde in them, when thei builde nothyng, to their auncetours woorke of nobilitéé. Euen as their auncetours, noblie endeouored them selues, to purchase and obtain, by famous actes their [nobilitéé\) for](#), nobilitéé and vertue, descendeth alwaies to the like) so thei contrary retire and giue backe, frō all the nobiliée of their auncetours, where as thei ought,

A beginnyng

of nobilitee. with like nobilitéé to imitate them. Many haue been, whiche

through their wisdom, and famous enterprises, in the affaires of their Prince, worthelie to honour haue been extolled and aduanced: who also were the firste auctours and founders of nobiliée, to their name and ofspring. Whose ofspring indued with like nobilitéé of vertues, and noble actes haue increased their auncetours glorie: the childrē or ofspring

lineally descendyng, hauyng no part of the auncetours glorie, how can thei vaunte them selues of nobiliée, whiche thei lacke, and dooe nothyng possesse thereof, Euen from lowe

Galerius a

Shepherds

sonne Empe-

ror of Rome.

Probus a

Gardeiners

sonne, Em-

perour. birthe and degré. Galerius Armentarius was
 aduanced,
 euen from a Shepherdes sonne, to sit in the Imperiall seat of
 Roome. Galerius Maximinus whom all the Easte obaied,
 his vertues and noble acts huffed hym to beare scepter in the
 Empire of Roome. Probus a Gardiners soonne, to the like
 throne and glorie ascēded, so God disposeth the state of
 euery
 man, placynge and bestowing dignité, where it pleaseth him
 as he setteth vp, so he pulleth doune, his prouidence & might
 is bounde to no state, stocke, or kindred.

¶ Of his educacion.



Paminūdas beyng borne of soche parentes, was
 brought vp in all excellent learnyng, for, vnder
 hym Philippe the kyng of the Macedonians, the
 soonne of Amintas, was brought vp. This Epa-
 minundas, the Histories note hym to be a chief Philosopher,
 and a capitaine moste valiaunte. In Musike, in plaiyng, and
 singyng finelie to his Instrumente, notable and famous, no
 kinde of learnyng, arte, or science, wanted in his breaste: So
 greate and abondante were his vertues, that aboue all go-
 uernours, whiche haue been in Thebe, his name and fame
 is chieflie aduanced.

¶ The praise of his actes.

The dutie of
 good gouer-



nors. Paminundas beyng moste valiaunte and
 no-
 ble, leauing all priuate commodité, glory, and
 riches a side: sought the renoume of his coun-
 tree, as all rulers and gouernours ought to do.

Howe a king[-]

dome riseth to

all felicitie. For, a kyngdome or common wealth, can not rise to any high nobilitéée or Roialnesse, where gouernours, rulers, and magistrates, neclecting the vniuersall, and whole body of the common wealthe, doe cogitate and vigilantly endeouour them selues, to stablish to them and theirs, a priuate, peculiar, and domesticall profite, glorie, or renoume. Couetousnes, whiche is in all ambitious Magistrates the poison, plague, destruccion, and ruine of the beste and flourishing cōmon wealthes, of al wickednes and mischief the roote: a vice,

Couetousnes

a great euill. whereupon all vice is grounded, from whom all mischief

floweth, all execrable purposes issueth. That wanted in Epaminundas, for in the ende of his life, his coffers were so thin and poore, that euen to his Funerall, money wanted to solempnise thesame. Priuate glorie nor excesse, was hunted after of hym, yet his vertues were of soche excellencie, that honour, dignitée, and preeminent state, was offered and giuen to hym vnwillinglie. This Epaminundas was in gouernement so famous, and so vertuouslie and politikelie ruled thesame, that he was a glorie, renoume, honour, and felicitée to his kingdome, by his state. Before the time of Epabeotia.

Thebes. minundas, the countree of Beotia was nothyng so famous

in their enterprises: neither the citee of Thebe so roiall, puis-saunt or noble, the antiquitee of that tyme sheweth, that Epaminundas wantyng the power of Thebes, their glorie, strength, and felicitée fell and decaied. The learning of Epaminundas and knowlege, was so abundant and profounde bothe in Philosophie, and in all other artes and sciences, that it was wounderfull. In chiuallrie and in feates of warre, no péere was more couragious and bolde, or hardie, neither in

that, whiche he enterprised, any could be of greater counsaile

in hedde more pollitike, of minde more sage and wittie: his gouuernement so good, that beyng so good a Magistrate, it is doubted, whether he be better man, or better Magistrate, Epaminundas died in the defence of his countrée. The Athenians were enemies to the Thebanes, and many greate batailles were assaied of them and foughten: and often tymes the Athenians felt many bitter stormes, and fortune loured of them, he beyng so valiaunt a capitain. Epaminundas beyng dedde, the Athenians ceased to practise, any one parte of chiuallrie, their prowesse and dexteritée decaied: thei hauyng no aliaunte, and forraineemie to moleste them, or whom

A valiant ca-

pitain, to his

countrie a pil[-]

lar[,] to his ene[-]

mie, a occasiō

to dexteritie. thei feared. So that a famous, wise, pollitike, and valiaunte

capitaine, is not onely a staie, a pillar and strong bulwarke to his countrée. But also forraine nacions, hauyng one, whō for his valiauntnes thei dreade, doe practise and inure them selues, to all dexteritee, counsaile, wisdomes, and pollicie: soche a one was Epaminundas, to his enemies and coutrée.

¶ The comparison.

Hector.

Achilles.

Numa Pom[-]

peius.



Adrianus. Either Hector of Troie, nor Achilles of Grece, might

bee compared with Epaminundas, Numa Pompili-

us was not more godlie, Adriane the Emperour of Roome, no better learned, nor Galba the Emperour more valiaunte, Nerua no more temperate, nor Traianus more noble, neither Cocles nor Decius, Scipio nor Marcus Regulus, did more [valiantly](#) in the defence of their countrie, soche a one was this Epaminundas.

¶ The conclusion.



F many thynges, these fewe are recited, but if his whole life and vertues, wer worthely handeled: fewe would beleue, soche a rare gouernour, so vertuous a Prince, so hardie and valiaunte a capitaine, to haue remained in no age.

¶ The parte of Rhetorike, called dispraise.

THis parte of *Rhetorike*, which is called dispraise, is a inuectiue Oracion, made againste the life of any man.

This part of *Rhetorike*, is contrary to that, whiche is before set, called *laus*, that is to saie, praise: and by contrary notes procedeth, for the Oratour or declaimer to entreate vpō.

This parte of *Rhetorike*, is called of the Grekes *Psogos*.

In praise, we extoll the persone: First by his countrée.

Then by his auncestours and parentes.

In the third place, by his educacion and institucion.

Then in the fowerth place, of his actes in life.

In the fifte place vse a comparison, comparyng the persone with other, whiche are more inferiour.

Then the conclusion.

Now in dispraise, contrarily we doe procede.

Firste, in the dispraise of his countrée.

Of his auncetours and parentes.

His educacion is dispraised.

Then his actes and deedes of life.

Also in your comparison with other, dispraise hym.

Then in the laste place, adde the conclusion.

All thynges that maie be praised, maie be dispraised.

¶ The dispraise of Nero.



Uertue. S vertue meriteth commendacion and immor-
tall renoume, for the nobilité and excellencie
reposed in it: so ougle vices for the deformité
of

them, are in mynd to be abhorred and detested,
and with all diligence, counsaile, and wisdom

Vice. auoided. As pestiferous poison extinguisheth with his
cor-

ruption and nautinesse, the good and absolute nature of all
thinges: so vice for his pestiferous nature putteth out vertue
and rooteth out with his force all singularité. For, vice and
vertue are so of nature contrary, as fire and water, the vio-
lence of the one expelleth the other: for, in the mansion of
ver-

tue, vice at one tyme harboreth not, neither vertue with vice

What is ver-

tue. can be consociate or vnited, for, vertue is a singuler

meane,
or Mediocrity in any good enterprise or facte, with order and reason finished. Whose acte in life, doeth repugne order and reason, disseuered from all Mediocrity, soche do leaue iustice,
equitée, wisdom, temperance, fortitude, magnanimitée, and al other vertues, bothe of minde and body: onely by vertues life men shewe them selues, as chief creatures of God, with reason, as a moste principall gifte, beautified and decorated: In other giftes, man is farre inferiour to beastes, both in strength of bodie, in celeritée and swiftnesse of foote, in labour, in industrie, in sense, nothyng to bee compared to beastes, with beastes as a peculier and proper thyng, wee haue our bodie of the yearth: but our minde, whiche for his diuinitée, passeth all thynges immortall, maketh vs as gods emōg other creatures. The bodie therefore, as a aliaunt and forain enemye, beyng made of a moste base, moste vile and corruptible nature, repugneth the mynde. This is the cause, that wickednesse taketh soche a hedde, and that the horrible facte and enterprise of the wicked burste out, in that, reason exiled and remoued from the minde, the ougle perturbacions of the minde, haue their regiment, power, and dominiō: and where soche state of gouernement is in any one bodie, in priuate and domesticall causes, in forraine and publike affaires, in kyngdome and cōmon wealthe. Uertue fadeth and decaieth, and vice onely beareth the swaie. Lawe is ordered by luste, and their order is will, soche was the tyme and gouernment of this wicked Nero.

¶ Of his countree.



Ero was a Romaine borne, though in gouernment he was wicked, yet his couñtree was famous,

and noble: for, the Romaines wer lordes and heddes ouer all the worlde. The vttermoste Indians, the Ethiopes, the Persians, feared the maiestie and aucthoritee of the Romaines. From Romulus, who was the firste

founder, and builder of that Citee: the Romaines bothe had their name of hym, and grew afterward to marueilous puissant roialnes. There was no nacion vnder the Sunne, but it dreaded their Maiestie, or felte their inuincible handes: there hath been many mightie kyngdomes, on the face of the yearth, but no kyngdome was able, with like successe and fe-

licitée in their enterprise, or for like famous gouernors, and continuance of their state, to compare with them. This was, and is, the laste mightée Monarchie in the worlde. Roome a olde aunciente citée, inhabited firste of the Aborigines, which

Carthage. came from Troie. The prouidence of God, so disposeth the

tymes and ages of the world, the state of kyngdomes, by the fall of mightier kyngdomes, meaner grewe to power and glorie. The Carthagineans, contended by prowes, and magnanimitee, to be lordes ouer the Romaines. Carthage was a greate, mightie, olde, auncient & famous citée, in the whiche

valiaunte, wise, and pollitike gouernours, helde therein regiment, long warres was susteined betwene the Romaines and Carthagineans, emong whom infinite people, and many noble péeres fell in the duste. Fortune and happie successe

fell to the Romaines: the people of Carthage vāquished, and prostrate to the ground. Scipio the noble Consull, beyng at the destruccion of it, seeyng with his iye, Carthage by fire brunte to ashes, saied: *Talis exitus aliquando erit Rome:* euē

**Destruction
of Rome to**

ashes in time. as of Carthage, like shall the destruccion of Rome bee, as for continuaunce of the Romaine state, of their glorie, power, and worthie successe, no nacion vnder the Sunne, can compare with them: soche was the state of Rome, wherein wicked Nero raigned.

¶ Of his [anncestours](#).



Agrippina Nero, the sonne of Domitius Enobarbus, Agrippina was his mothers name: this Agrippina, was Emprise of Rome, wife to Claudius Tiberius, the daughter of his brother Germanicus. This Agrippina, the Chronicle noteth her, to be indued with al mischief and crueltée: For, Tiberius her housbande, hauyng by his firste wife children, thei were murdered by her, because she might, thei beyng murdered, with more facilitée, further the Empire, to her soonnes handes, many treasons conspired against them oftentimes, Agrippina poisoned her housbande, then Nero succeded.

¶ Of his educacion.

Seneca scholar
maister to



Seneca the famous Poete & Philosopher, was scholar-
maister to Nero, who brought hym vp in all nobilitie of learnyng, mete for his state: though that Nero was wickedlie of nature disposed, as his beastlie gouernement sheweth, yet wickednes in him, was by the seueritie of Seneca, and his castigation depressed: for Traianus Emperour of Rome, would saie, as concernyng Nero, for the space

of fiue yeres, no Prince was like to hym, for good gouernement, after fiue yeres, losely and dissolutly he gouerned.

¶ Of his actes.

**The dreame
of Agrippina
mother to
Nero, in his**



concepcion. His Nero, at what tyme as his mother was conceiued of him, she dreamed that she was conceiued

of a Uiper: for, the young Uiper alwaies killeth his dame. He was not onely a Uiper to his mother whom he killed, but also to his kyngdome and common wealthe a destroyer, whiche afterward shalbe shewed, what **Nero a viper[.]** a tyraunte and bloodie gouernour he was. This Nero made in the Citee of Rome, the rounde seates and scaffoldes, to beholde spectacles and sightes, and also the bathes. He subdued

Pontus.

Colchis.

Cappadocia.

Armenia. Pontus a greate countrée, whiche ioineth to the sea Pontus:

whiche countrée containeth these realmes, Colchis, Cappadocia, Armenia, and many other countrées, and made it as a Prouince, by the suffraunce of Polemon Regulus, by whose name it was called Pontus Polemoniacus. He ouer came the Alpes, of the king Cotteius, Cottius the king being dedde[.]

Nero vnwor[-]

thie to be chron[-]

icled.

Seneca. The life followyng of Nero was so abhominable, that the

shame of his life, will make any man a fraied, to leaue any memorie of hym. This Domitius Nero, caused his Scholemaister Seneca to be put to death, Seneca chosing his owne death, his veines beyng cutte in a hotte bathe died, bicause he

corrected wicked Nero, to traine hym to vertue. He was outrageous wicked, that he had cōsideracion, neither to his own honestie, nor to other, but in continuaunce, he tired himself as virgines doe when thei marie, callyng a Senate, the dou-rie assigned, and as the maner of that solemnité is, many resortyng and frequentlyng, in maidens tire and apparell. He

The shamful

life of Nero. went beyng a man, to be married as a woman: beside this, at

other tymes he cladde hymself with the skin of a wilde beast,

and beastlie did handle that, whiche Nature remoueth from the sight. He defiled hymself with his owne mother, whom he killed immediatlíe. He married twoo wiues, Octauia, and Sabina, otherwise called Poppea, firste murtheryng their

Galba.

Caius Iu-

lius. housbandes. In that tyme Galba vsurped the Empire, and Caius Iulius: as sone as Nero heard that Galba came nere towards Rome, euen then the Senate of Rome had determined, that Nero should bee whipped to death with rodde, accordyng to the old vsage of their auncestours, his necke yo-

ked with a forke. This wicked Nero, seyng himself forsaken of all his friendes, at midnight he departed out of the Citée, Ephraon, and Epaphroditus waityng on hym, Neophitus and Sporus his Eunuche: whiche Sporus before tyme, had

The death of

Nero. Nero assaied to frame and fashion out of kinde. In the ende,

Nero thruste himself through, with the point of his sworde, his wicked man Sporus, thrustyng foreward his trembling hande: this wicked Nero before that, hauyng none to murder hym, he made a exclamacion, in these woordes. Is there neither friende nor enemie to kill me, shamefullie haue I liued, and with more shame shall I die, in the .xxxij. yere of his

age he died. The Persians so entirely loued hym, that after his death thei sente Ambassadors, desiryng licence to erecte to hym a monumente, all countrées and Prouinces, and the whole Citée of Rome, did so moche reioyce of his death, that

thei all wearyng the Toppintant hattes, whiche bonde men doe vse to ware, when thei bée sette at libertie, and so thei tri-

umphed of his death, deliuered from so cruell a tyraunte.

¶ A comparison.

Nero.

Caligula.

Domitianus[.]



Antoninus. S for wicked gouvernement, Nero doeth make Ca-

ligula like to Comodus, Domitianus, Antoninus

Caracalla, thei were all so wicked, that the Senate of Rome thought it méete, to obliterate their name, from all memorie and Chronicle, because of their wickednesse.

¶ The conclusion.



Oche more the life and gouernement of wicked Nero, might be intreated of, but this shall be sufficient: to shewe how tyrannically and beastly, he gouerned vnmete of that throne.

¶ A comparison.



Comparison, is a certain Oracion, shewyng by a collacion the worthines, or excellēcie of any thing:
or the naughtines of thesame, compared with any other thyng or thynges, either equalle, or more inferiour.

In a comparison good thynges, are compared with good as one vertue with an other: as wisdom & strength, whiche of them moste auailleth in peace and warre.

Euill thynges maie bee compared with good, as Iustice, with iniustice, wisdom with foolishnes.

Euill thynges maie be compared, with euill thynges, as wicked Nero, compared to Domitianus, or Caligula to Commodus, theft to homicide, drunkenes with adulterie.

Small thynges maie be compared with greate: the king with his subiect, the Elephant or Camell to the Flie, a Crocodile to the Scarabe.

In a comparison, where argumente is supputated on bothe the sides, worthelie to praise, or dispraise.

Where a comparison is made, betwene a thyng excellent, and a thyng more inferiour: the comparison shall procede with like facilitie.

All thynges that maie bee celebrated with praise, or that meriteth dispraise: al soche thynges maie be in a

comparison.

The persone, as Cato being a wise man, maie be compared with Nestor, the sage péere of Grece: Pompei with Cesar, as Lucane compareth them, and so of all other men.

Thynges maie bee compared, as golde with siluer: one mettall with an other.

Tymes maie be compared, as the Spryng with Sommer: Harueste with Winter.

Places maie be compared, as London with Yorke, Oxforde with Cambridge.

Beastes without reason, as the Bée with the Ante, the Oxe with the Shepe.

Plantes, as the Uine, and the Oliue.

First, make a *proemium* or beginnyng to your cōparison[.]

Then compare them of their countrée.

Of their parentes.

Of their auncestours.

Of their educacion.

Of their actes.

Of their death.

Then adde the conclusion.

¶ A comparison betwene Demosthenes and Tullie.

O speake moche in the praise of famous men,
no argument can wante, nor plentie of matter



to make of them, a copious and excellent Oracion. Their actes in life through nobilitée, will craue worthelie more, then the witte and penne of the learned, can by Eloquence expresse. Who can

worthelie expresse and sette foorth, the noble Philosopher **Plato.**

Aristotle. Plato, or Aristotle, as matter worthelie forceth to commend,

when as of them, all learnyng, and singularitée of artes hath flowen. All ages hath by their monuments of learning, participated of their wisdom. Grece hath fostered many noble wittes, from whom all light of knowlege, hath been deriued by whose excellencie Rome in tyme florishyng, did seeke by nobilitée of learnyng, to mate the noble Grecians. So moche Italie was adorned, and beautified with the cunnyng of the Grecians. Emong the Romaines many famous Oratours and other noble men hath spronge vp, who for their worthinesse, might haue contended with any nacion: either for their

Tullie. glorie of learnyng, or noble regiment. Emong whom **Tul-**

lie by learning, aboue the rest, rose to high fame, that he was a renoume to his countree: to learnyng a light, of all singular Eloquence a fountaine. Whom Demosthenes the famous Oratour of Athenes, as a worthie mate is compared with, whom not onely the nobilitée, and renoume of their Countrée shall decorate, but thē selues their owne worthines & no-

bilitée of fame. No age hath had twoo more famous for learnyng, no common wealthe hath tasted, twoo more profitable to their countrée, and common wealthe: for grauitée and cō-

saile, nor the posteritée of ages, twoo more worthie celebra-

Thusidides. cion. Thusidides speakyng, in the commendacion of famous

men sheweth: as concernyng the fame of noble men, whose
The enuious
manne. vertue farre surmounteth thē, and passeth al other.
 Thenui-
 ous man seketh to deprauē, the worthinesse of fame in other,
The igno-
raunte. his bragging nature with fame of praise, not
 decorated. The
 ignoraunte and simple nature, accordyng to his knowlege,
 iudgeth all singularitée, and tempereth by his owne actes the
 praise of other. But the fame of these twoo Oratours, nei-
 ther the enuious nature can diminishe their praise, nor the
 ignoraunt be of them a arbitrator or iudge, so worthely hath
 all ages raised fame, and commendacion of their vertues.

¶ Of their countree.



IN Grece Demosthenes, the famous Oratour of A-
 thenes was borne, whose Countrée or Citee, lacketh
 no cōmendacion: either for the nobilitée of the
 lande,
 or glorie of the people. What nacion vnder the Sunne, hath
 not heard of that mightie Monarchie of Grece: of their might-
 tie citees, and pollitike gouernaunce. What famous Poetes
 how many noble Philosophers and Oratours, hath Grece
 brede. What science and arte, hath not flowne from Grece,
 so that for the worthinesse of it, it maie bee called the
 mother
 of all learnyng. Roome also, in whom Tullie was brought
 vp, maie contende in all nobilitée, whose power and puisant
 glorie, by nobilitée of actes, rose to that mightie hed. In
 bothe
 soche excellencie is founde, as that no nacion might better
 contende, of their singularitée and honour of countrée, then
 Grece and Rome: yet first from the Grekes, the light of Phi-

losophie, and the abundant knowledge of all artes, sprange to the Romaines, from the Grecians. The Godlie Lawes, wherewith the Romaine Empire was decorated and gouerned, was brought from the Grecians. If the citee maie bee a honour and glorie, to these twoo Oratours, or their Citees a singuler commendacion, there wanteth in bothe, neither honour, or nobilitéé.

¶ Of their auncestours, and parentes.



Othe Demosthenes and Tullie were borne, of verie meane parentes and auncestours: yet thei thorowe their learnyng and vertues, became famous, ascendyng to all nobilitéé. Of their vertues and learnyng, not of their auncestours, nobilitéé rose to them.

¶ Of the educacion.



HE singuler vertues of them bothe, appered euen in their tender youth: wherupon thei being brought vp, in all godlie learnyng and noble Sciences, thei became moste noble Oratours, and by their copious Eloquence, counsaile, and wisdom, aspired to nobilitéé & honor.

¶ Of their scholyng.



Othe were taught of the mouthe of the best learned, Demosthenes of Iseus, a man moste Eloquent: Cicero of Philo and Milo, famous in wisdom and Eloquence.

¶ Of their exercise.



Icero did exercise hymself verie moche, to declaime,
bothe in Greke and Latine, with Marcus Piso, and with Quintus Pampeius. Demosthenes wanted not industrie and labour, to attain to that singularitée, whiche he had, bothe in Eloquence, and pronounciacion.

¶ Of the giftes of their minde.



N bothe, integritee, humanitee, magnanimitee, and all vertue flowed: at what time as Demosthenes was commaunded of the Athenians, to frame a accusacion, againste a certaine man, Demosthenes refused the acte. But when the people, and the whole multitude, were wrothe with hym, and made a exclamacion against hym, as their maner was. Then Demosthenes rose, and saied: O ye men of Athenes, againste my will, you haue me a counsailer, or pleater of causes before you: but as for a accuser, & calumniator, no, not although ye would. Of this sorte Tullie was affected, excepte it were onely in the sauegard of his [conutrée](#): as against Catiline, bothe were of godlie, and of vpright conuersacion, altogether in Mediocrite, and a newe leadyng their life.

¶ Of their actes.



Demosthenes and Tullie bothe, gaue them selues to trauail, in the causes and affaires of their common wealthe, to the preseruacion of it. How vehemently did Demosthenes pleate, and ingeniouslie handle the cause of all his countrée, against Philip, for the defence of their libertee: whereupon he gatte fame, and greate glory. Whereby not onely, he was coumpted a great wise counsailour: but one of a valiaunte stomacke, at whose **Darius.**

Philip.

Demosthe-

nes. wisdom, all Grece stode in admiracion. The kyng of Per-

sia, laboured to enter fauour with him. Philip the king of the Macedonians, would saie often tymes, he had to doe against a famous man, notyng Demosthenes. Tullie also by his Eloquence and wisdom, saued Roome and all partes of that dominion, from greate daungers.

¶ Of their authoritee.



Heir authoritee and dignitee was equalle, in the common wealthe: For, at their twoo mouthes, Roome and Athenes was vpholed. Demosthenes was chief in fauour with Caretes, Diophetes, Leostines, Cicero with Pompei: Iulius Cesar, ascending to the chief seate and dignitée of the Consulship.

¶ Of a like fall that happened to them, before their death.



Ou can not finde soche twoo Orators, who borne of meane & poore parentes, that attained so greate honour, who also did obiecte themselues to tyran-tes a like, thei had losse of their children a like, bothe were out of their countree banished men, their returne was with honour, bothe also fliying, happened into the handes of their enemies.

¶ Of their death.

Antipater.

**Demosthe-
nes.**

Archias.

Marcus

Antonius.



Tullie. Othe a like, Demosthenes and Tully wer put to death, Demosthenes died, Antipater gouernynge by the handes of Archias. Cicero died by the com-
maundement of Marcus Antonius: by Herenius his hedde was cutte of, and sette in Marcus Antonius halle. His handes also were cutte of, with the whiche he wrote the vehement Oracions against Marcus Antonius.

¶ The conclusion.



O speake as moche as maie bee saied, in the praise of them: their praise would rise to a mightie volume, but this is sufficiente.

¶ *Ethopæia.*

Ethopæia is a certaine Oracion made by voice, and lamentable imitation, vpon the state of any one.

This imitation is in { *Eidolopæia.* }
iij. sortes, either it is. { *Prosopopæia.* }
{ *Ethopæia.* }

That parte, whiche is called *Ethopæia* is that, whiche hath the persone knowne: but onely it doeth faigne the manners of thesame, and imitate in a Oracion thesame.

Ethopæia is called of Priscianus, a certaine talkyng to of any one, or a imitaciō of talke referred to the maners, aptly of any certaine knowen persone.

Quintilianus saieth, that *Ethopæia* is a imitation of o-ther meane maners: whom the Grekes dooe calle, not onelie *Ethopæia*, but *mimesis*, & this is in the maners, and the fact.

This parte is as it were, a liuely expression of the maner and affeccion of any thyng, whereupon it hath his name.

The *Ethopæia* is in three sortes.

The firste, a imitation passiue, whiche expresseth the affection, to whom it parteineth: whiche altogether expresseth the mocion of the mynde, as what patheticall and dolefull oracion, Hecuba the quene made, the citee of Troie destroyed, her housbande, her children slaine.

The second is called a morall imitaciō, the whiche doeth set forthe onely, the maners of any one.

The thirde is a mixt, the whiche setteth forthe, bothe the maners and the affection, as how, and after what sorte, Achilles spake vpon Patroclus, he beyng dedde, when for his sake, he determined to fight: the determinacion of hym sheweth the maner. The frende slaine, the affection.

In the makyng of *Ethopæia*, lette it be plaine, and without any large circumstaunce.

In the makyng of it, ye shall diuide it thus, to make the Oracion more plaine, into three tymes.

{ A presente tyme. }

{ A tyme paste. }

{ A tyme to come. }

Eidolopæia is that part of this Oracion, whiche maketh a persone knowne though dedde, and not able to speake.

Eidolopæia[.] *Eidolopæia* is called of Priscianus, a imitation of talke of any one, vpon a dedde manne, it is then called *Eidolopæia*, when a dedde man talketh, or comunicacion made vpon a dedde manne.

Eidolopæia, when a dedde manne talketh, is set forthe of Euripides, vpon the persone of Polidorus dedde, whose spirite entereth at the Prologue of the tragedie.

Hector slain, speaketh to Eneas in *Eidolopæia*. O Eneas thou goddes sonne, flie and saue thy self, from this ruine and fire: the enemies hath taken the walles, and loftie Troie is prostrate to the ground. I would haue thought, I had died valiantlie inough to my countrée, and my father Priamus, if with this my right hande, Troie had bee defended.

Polidorus beyng dedde, in *Eidolopæia* talketh to Eneas whiche Uirgil sheweth in his thirde booke of Eneados.

Iulia the wife of Pompei beyng dedde, spake to Pompe, preparyng his arme against Cesar, *Eidolopæia*. Reade Lucane, in the beginnyng of his thirde booke.

Tullie vseth *Eidolopæia*, when he maketh talke vpon Hiero beyng dedde.

If that kyng Hiero were reduced frō his death, who was a aduauncer of the Romaine Empire, with what countenance, either Siracusa or Rome, might be shewed to hym, whom he maie beholde with his iyes. His countree brought to ruin, & spoiled, if that kyng Hiero should but enter Rome, euen in the firste entryng, he should beholde the spoile of his countree.

Tullie also vseth the like *Eidolopæia*, as thus, vpon Lucius Brutus dedde.

Lucius

Brutus. If it so wer, that Lucius Brutus, that noble and famous manne were on liue, and before your presence: would he not vse this oracion: I Brutus, somtyme did banishe and cast out for crueltee, the state and office of kinges, by the horrible fact

of Tarquinius, againste Lucretia, and all that name banished, but you haue brought in tyrauntes. I Brutus did reduce the Romain Empire, to a fredome and libertée: but you foolishly can not vphold and maintein, thesame giuen to you.

I Brutus, with the daunger of my life, haue saued my coun[-]tree of Roome, but you without all daunger, lose it.

¶ *Prosopopæia.*



S cōcerning *Prosopopæia*, it is as Pristianus saith, when to any one againste nature, speache is feigned to bee giuen.

Tullie vseth for a like example this, when he maketh Roome to talke againste Cateline.

¶ *Prosopopæia* of Roome.



Catiline. O mischief hath been perpetrated, this many yeres,
but by thee Catiline, no pestiferous acte enterprised, without thee: thou a lone, for thy horrible murther perpetrated vpon the citee of Rome, for the spoile and robberies of their gooddes art vnpunished. Thou onelie haste been of that force and power, to caste doune all lawes and aucthori-

tee. Although these thinges were not to be borne, yet I haue borne them: but now thy horrible factes are come to soche an issue, that I feare thy mischiues. Wherefore leaue of Cateline and deminishe this feare from me, that I maie be in securité[.]

Lucane the Poete, intreating of mightie and fearce warres, againste Pompei and Cesar, maketh Roome to vse this *Prosopopæia* againste Cesar.

*Quo tenditis vltra quo fertis mea signa viri,
Si iure venitis si aues hucusq[ue] licet.*

Prosopopæia is properlie, when all thinges are faigned bothe the maners, the persone, as of Roome in this place.

¶ What lamentable Oracion Hecuba Quene of Troie might make, Troie being destroyed.



Kyngdomes. Hat kyngdome can alwaies assure his state, or glory? What strength can alwaies last? What Okes.

Cedars. power maie alwaies stande? The mightie

O-

kes are somtyme caste from roote, the Ceadars high by tempestes falle, so bitter stormes dooe force their strength. Soft waters pearseth Rockes, and ruste the massie Iron doeth bryng to naught. So nothyng can by strēgth so stande, but strength maie ones decaie: yea, mightie

kingdoms in time decaie haue felt. Kingdomes weake haue rose to might, and mightie kyngdomes fallen, no counsaile can preuaile, no power, no strength, or might in lande. God disposeth Princes seates, their kyngdome there with standes. I knewe before the brickell state, how kyngdomes ruine

caught, my iye the chaunge of fortune sawe, as Priamus did
aduaunce his throne, by fauour Fortune gat, on other For-
tune then did froune, whose kingdom did decaie. Well, now

Fortune

hath no staie. I knowe the brickle state, that fortune hath no
staie, all rashe

her giftes, Fortune blind doeth kepe no state, her stone doth
roule, as floodes now flowe, floodes also ebbe. So glory
doth

remaine, sometyme my state on high, was sette in Princelie
throne, my porte and traine ful roiall was, a kyng my father
also was, my housband scepter held. Troie and Phrigia ser-
ued his becke, many kynges his power did dreade, his wille
their power did serue. The fame of Troie and Brute, his
glorie and renoume, what landes knoweth not? But now
his falle, all tounge can speake, so greate as glorie was,
though kyngdomes stronge was sette, loftie Troie in duste
prostrate doeth lye, in blood their glorie, people, kyng are fal-

len, no Quene more dolefull cause hath felte. The sorowes
depe doe passe my ioyes, as Phebus light with stormes caste
Hector. doune. Hectors death did wounde my hart, by Hectors
might

Troie stiffe did stande, my comforte Hector was, Priamus
ioye, of Troie all thē life, the strength, and power, his death
did wound me for to die, but alas my dolefull and cruell fate
to greater woe reserueth my life, loftie Troie before me
felle, sworde, and fire hath seate and throne doune caste.
The

dedde on heapes doeth lye, the tender babes as Lions praies
Priamus. are caught in bloode, before my sight, Priamus deare
mur-

dered was, my children also slain, who roiall were, and prin-
ces mates. No Queene more ioye hath tasted, yet woe my io-
yes hath quite defaced. My state alwaie in bondage thrall, to
serue my enemies wille, as enemie wille, I liue or dye. No

cruell force will ridde my life, onely in graue the yearth shal
close my woes, the wormes shall gnawe my dolefull hart in
graue. My hedde shall ponder nought, when death hath
sence

doune caste, in life I sought no ioye, as death I craue, no
glorie was so wished as death I seeke, with death no sence.
In prison depe who dolefull lieth, whom Fetters sore dooeth
greue. Their dolefull state moste wisheth death, in dongion
deepe of care my harte moste pensiue is, vnhappie state that
wisheth death, with ioye long life, eche wight doeth craue, in
life who wanteth smart? Who doeth not féele, or beare som-
time, a bitter storme, to doleful tune, mirth full oft chaunged
is, the meaner state, more quiet rest, on high, who climes
more

deper care, more dolefull harte doeth presse, moste
tempestes

hie trees, hilles, & moutaines beare, valleis lowe rough stor-
mes doeth passe, the bendyng trees doeth giue place to
might

by force of might, Okes mightie fall, and Ceders high ar rēt
from the roote. The state full meane in hauen hath Ancre
caste, in surgyng seas, full ofte in vaine to saue the maste,
the
shippe Ancre casteth.

¶ The descripcion.



His exercise profitable to *Rhetorike*, is an Ora-
ciō that collecteth and representeth to the iye, that
which he sheweth, so Priscianus defineth it: some
are of that opinion, that descripcion is not to bee
placed emōg these exercises, profitable to *Rhetorike*.
Because
that bothe in euery Oracion, made vpon a Fable, all thyn-
ges therein conteined, are liuely described. And also in euery

Narracion, the cause, the place, the persone, the time, the fact,
the maner how, ar therin liuely described. But most famous
and Eloquente men, doe place descripcion, in the number of
these exercises. Descripciō serueth to these things, the
person,
as the Poete Lucane describeth Pompei & Cesar: the person
is described, thynges or actes, tymes, places, brute beastes.

*Nec coiere pares, alter vergentibus annis
In senium longo que toge, tranquilior vsu.
Dedidicit. &c.*

Homer describeth the persone of Thersites, in the second
booke of his Ilias.

Homer setteth out Helena, describing the persone of Me-
nalaus and Ulisses, in the fowerth booke of Ilias.

Thynges are described, as the warres attempted by sea
and lande, of Xerxes.

Lucan describeth the war of the Massiliās against Cesar[.]

Thusedides setteth forthe in a descripcion, the warres on
the sea, betwene the Corcurians, and the Corinthians.

Tymes are described, as the Spryng tyme, Sommer,
Winter, Harueste, Daie, Night.

Places are described, as Citees, Mountaines, Regions,
Floodes, Hauens, Gardeines, Temples: whiche thynges
are sette out by their commoditees, for Thusedides often ty-
mes setteth forthe Hauens and Citees.

Lucane also describeth at large, the places, by the whiche
the armie of Cesar and Pompei passed. The descripcion of a-
ny man, in all partes is to bee described, in mynde and

bodie,
what he was.

The acttes are to bee described, farre passed, by the presente state thereof, and also by the tyme to come.

As if the warre of Troie, should be set forthe in a description, it must bée described, what happened before the Grecians arriued at Troie, and how, and after what sorte it was ouerthrowne, & what thing chaunced, Troie being destroid.

So likewise of Carthage, destroyed by the Romaines. Of Hierusalem, destroyed by Titus Uespasianus, what admonicion thei had before: of what monstrous thynges happened also in that ceason: Of a Comete or blasyng Starre, and after that what followed.

Lucane also setteth forthe the warres of Pompe and Cesar, what straunge and marueilous thynges fell of it.

¶ A descripcion vpon Xerxes.



Hen Darius was dedde, Xerxes his soonne did succede hym, who also tooke vpon him to finishe the warres, begō by his father Darius, against Grece. For the whiche warres, preperacion was made, for the space of fiue yeres, after that

The armie

of Xerxes. Xerxes entered Grece, with seuen hundred thousande Persi-

ans, and thrée hundred thousande of forrain power aided him that not without cause, Chronicles of aunciente tyme dooe shewe, mightie floodes to be dried vp of his armie. The migh[-]

tie dominions of Grece, was not hable to receiue his hounge, and mightie power, bothe by sea and lande: he was no small

Prince, whom so many nacions, so mightie people followed hym, his Nauie of Shippes was in nomber tenne hundred

Xerxes a

cowarde. thousande, Xerxes had a mightie power, but Xerxes was a

cowarde, in harte a childe, all in feare the stroke of battaile moued. In so mightie an armie it was marueile, the chiefe Prince and Capitaine to be a cowarde, there wanted neither men, nor treasure, if ye haue respecte to the kyng hymself, for

cowardlinesse ye will dispraise the kyng, but his threasures beeyng so infinite, ye will maruaile at the plentie thereof, whose armie and infinite hoste, though mightie floodes and streames, were not able to suffice for drinke, yet his richesse

Xerxes laste

in battaile,

and first to

runne awaie. semed not spent nor tasted of. Xerxes hymself would be laste

in battaile to fight, and the firste to retire, and runne awaie.

In daungers he was fearfull, and when daunger was paste, he was stoute, mightie, glorious, and wonderfull crakyng,

The pride

of Xerxes. before this hassarde of battaile attempted. He thought hym

self a God ouer nature, all landes and Seas to giue place to hym, and puffed with pride, he forgatte hymself: his power was terrible, his harte fainte, whereupon his enterying into Grece was not so dreaded, as his flight frō thence was sham[-]

full, mocked and scorned at, for all his power he was driuen backe from the lande, by Leonides king of the Lacedemonians, he hauing but a small number of men, before his second battaile fought on the Sea: he sente fower thousande armed men, to spoile the riche and sumptuous temple of Apollo, at Delphos, from the whiche place, not one man escaped. After

that Xerxes entered Thespia, Platea, and Athenes, in the
whiche not one man remained, those he burned, woorkyng
his anger vpon the houses: for these citees were admonished
to proue the maisterie in wodden walles, whiche was ment
to bee Shippes, the power of Grece, brought into one place

Themi-

stocles. Themistocles, fauoryng their part, although Xerxes
thought

otherwise of Themistocles, then Themistocles perswaded
Xerxes to assaie the Grecians. Artemisia the Quene of Hali-
carnasis aided Xerxes in his battaile: Artemisia fought
man[-]

fullie, Xerxes cowardly shronke, so that vnnaturally there
was in the one a manlie stomacke, in the other a cowardlie
harte. The men of Ionia, that fought vnder Xerxes banner,
by the treason of Themistocles, shrāke from Xerxes, he was
not so greate a terroure or dreade, by his maine hoste, as now
smallly regarded & least feared. What is power, men, or mo-
ney, when God chaungeth and pulleth doune, bothe the suc-
cesse, and kyngdome of a Prince. He was in all his glorie, a
vnmanlie, and a cowardly prince, yet for a time happie state
fell on his side, now his might and power is not feared. He
flieth awaie in a Fisher boate, whom all the worlde dreaded
and obaied, whom all Grece was not able to receiue, a small
boate lodgeth and harboureth. His owne people contemned
hym at home, his glorie fell, and life ingloriously ended,
whō

whom God setteth vp, neither treason nor malice, power nor
money can pull doune. Worthelie it is to be pondered of all
Princes, the saiyng of Uespasianus Emperour of Rome, at
a certain time a treason wrought and conspired against him,
the conspiratours taken, Uespasianus satte doune betwene

The saiyng

of Uespasi-

anus. theim, commaunded a sworde to be giuen to either of
theim,

and saied to them: *Nonne videtis fato potestatem dari.* Dooe you not see? Power, auctoritée, and regimente, by the ordi-

A sentence

comfortable

to al princes. naunce of God, is lefte and giuen to princes: A singuler sen-

tence, to comferte all good Princes in their gouernement, not to feare the poisoned hartes of men, or the traiterous hartes of pestiferous men. No man can pull doune, where God exalteth, neither power can set vp and extoll, where God displaseth or putteth doune: Soche is the state of Princes, and their kyngdomes.

¶ *Thesis.*



Hesis, is a certain question in consultacion had, to bée declaimed vpon vncertaine, notyng no certaine persone or thyng.

As for example.

Whether are riches chieflie to be sought for, in this life, as of all good thynges, the chief good.

Whether is vertue the moste excellente good thyng in this life.

Whether dooe the giftes of the mynde, passe and excelle the giftes and vertues of Fortune, and the bodie.

Whether doeth pollicie more auaile in war, then strēgth of menne.

Who so will reason of any question of these, he hath nede with reason, and wittie consultacion to discourse, and to declaime vpon thesame.

The Greke Oratours doe call this exercise *Thesis*, that is to saie, a proposicion in question, a question vncertain, included with no certaintée, to any perticuler thyng.

The Latine men doeth call it a question infinite, or vniuersall: Tullie in his booke of places called Topickes, doeth call *Thesis*, *Propositum*, that is to saie, a question, in determination. Priscianus calleth it *positionem*, a proposicion in question on ether parte to be disputed vpon.

As for example.

Whether is it best to marie a wife?

Whether is frendship aboue all thynges to be regarded.

Is warre to be moued vpon a iuste cause?

Is the Greke tongue mete, and necessarie to be learned?

There is an other kinde of question called *hypothesis*, *hy[-]pothesis* is called *questio finita*, that is to saie, a question certaine notyng a certaine persone, or thyng, a certaine place, tyme, and so forthe.

As for example.

Is it mete for Cesar to moue warre against Pompei?

Is not there a certain persone?

Is the Greke tongue to be learned of a Diuine?

Is the Greke tongue meete for a Phisicion?

In this kinde of exercises, famous men of auncient time did exercise youth, to attain bothe wisdom and Eloquence

therby, to make a discourse vpō any matter, by art of lerning[.]

Aristotle the famous Philosopher, did traine vp youthe, to be perfite in the arte of eloquence, that thei might with all copiousnes and ingenious inuencion handle any cause.

Nothing doeth so moche sharpe and acuate the witte and capacitée of any one, as this kinde of exercise.

It is a goodly vertue in any one man, at a sodain, to vtter wittely and ingeniouslie, the secrete and hid wisdom of his mynde: it is a greate maime to a profounde learned man, to wante abilitée, to vtter his exquisite and profounde knowledge of his mynde.

¶ *Thesis.*

THis question *Thesis*, which is a question, noting no certaine persone or thyng: is moche like to that Oracion, intreated of before, called a Common place.

¶ A Common place.



Ut a Common place, is a certaine exaggeracion of matter, induced against any persone, conuicted of any crime, or worthie defence.

¶ *Thesis.*

Thesis is a reasonyng by question, vpon a matter vncertaine.

Thesis, that is to saie, a questiō generall is in two sortes.

{ Ciuill.

A question {

{ Contemplatiue.



Questions Ciuill are those, that dooe pertaine to the state of a common wealth: and are daily practised in the common wealthe.

As for example.

Is it good to marie a wife.

Is Usurie lefull in a citee, or common wealthe.

Is a Monarchie the beste state of gouernement.

Is good educacion the grounde and roote, of a florishyng common wealthe.

¶ A contemplatiue question.



He other *Thesis* is a question contemplatiue, which the Grekes dooe call *Theoricas*, because the matter of them is comprehended in the minde, and in the in[-]telligence of man.

The example.

Is the soule immortall?

Had the worlde a beginnyng?

Is the heauen greater then the yearth?

A question is either { Simple.
 { Compounde.

Is it good for a man to exercise hymself in wrastlyng, or

Is it profitable to declaime.

[¶] A compounde.

Is vertue of more value then gold, to the coueitous man[?]

Doeth wisdom more auaile, then strength in battaile?

Doe olde men or young men, better gouerne a common wealthe?

Is Phisicke more honourable then the Lawe?

A Oracion made vpon *Thesis*, is after this sorte made.

Use a *exordium*, or beginnyng.

Unto the whiche you maie adde a Narracion, whiche is a exposition of the thyng doen.

Then shewe it lawfull.

Iuste.

Profitable.

And possible.

Then the conclucion.

To this in some parte of the Oracion, you maie putte in certaine obieccions, as thus.

Upon this question: Is it good to marie a wife?

In Mariage is greates care, and pensiuenesse of minde, by losse of children, or wife, whom thou loueste. There is also trouble of dissolute seruantes. There is also greates sorowe if thy children proue wicked and dissolute.

The aunswere to this obiection, will minister matter to declaime vpon.

¶ Is it good to Marie.



Ince the tyme of all ages, and the creaciō of the worlde, GOD hath so blessed his creacion, and meruailous workemanship in manne: as in all his other creatures, that not onelie his [omnipotentie](#), is therby set forthe. But also from tyme to tyme, the posteritee of men, in their ofspring and procrea-

Kyngdomes

continue by

mariage and

cōmon welth[.] cion, doe abundantlie commonstrate thesame.

The state of

all kyngdomes and common wealthes: by procreacion deriued, haue onelie continued on the face of the yearth, thereby many hundred yeres. How sone would the whole worlde be dissolued, and in perpetuall ruine, if that God from tymes and ages, had not by godlie procreacion, blessed this infinite

The dignitee

of man, she-

weth the

worthines of

mariage. issue of mankinde. The dignité of man in his creacion, she-

weth the worthie succession, maintained by procreation. In

vaine were the creacion of the worlde, if there were not as manne so excellente a creature, to beholde the creatour, and his meruailous creacion.

To what vse were the Elementes and Heauens, the Starres and Planettes, all Beastes and

Foules, Fisshe, Plantes, Herbes and trees, if men wer not,

for mannes vse and necessitée, all thinges in the yearth were made and procreated. Wherein the Stoike Philosophers do

note the excellencie of man to be greate: for saie thei, *Que in terris gignuntur omnia ad vsum hominum creari.* To what

vse then were all thynges, if man were not, for whose cause,

vse, & necessitée these thynges were made. If a
 continuaunce
 of Gods procreacion were not, immediatlie a ruine and ende
 would ensue of thinges. What age remaineth aboue a hun-
 dred yeres? If after a hūdred yeres, no issue wer to be, on the
Godlie pro-
creacion. face of the yearth, how sone wer kyngdoms
 dissolued, where
 as procreacion rooteth, a newe generacion, issue and
 ofspring,
 and as it were a newe soule and bodie. A continuaunce of la-
 wes, a permanente state of common wealthe dooeth ensue.
 Though the life of manne be fraile, and sone cutte of, yet by
 Mariage, man by his ofspryng, is as it were newe framed,
 his bodie by death dissolued, yet by issue reuiued. Euen as
 Plantes, by the bitter season of Winter, from their flowers
 fadyng and witheryng: yet the seede of them and roote, vegi-
 table and liuyng, dooe roote yerelie a newe ofspryng or flo-
A similitude. wer in them. So Mariage by godlie procreacion
 blessed, doth
 perpetually increase a newe bodie, and therby a vaste world,
 and infinite nacions or people. Xerxes the mightie kyng of
 Persia, vewing and beholding his maine and infinite hoste,
 wéepe: who beyng demaunded, why he so did. *Doleo*
inquit
post centum annos, neminem ex hijs superesse. It is a pitée-
 fulle and dolefull case, that after a hundred yeres, not one of
 these noble capitaines, and valiant soldiers to be left.

¶ The obieccion.

But you will saie parauenture, mariage is a greate bon-
 dage, alwaies to liue with one.

¶ The solucion.

To followe pleasure, and the beastlie mocions of the
mynde: what libertée call you that, to liue in a godly, meane,
The libertie
in mariage. and Mediocritée of life, with thy spoused wife.
There is no
greater ioye, libertée, or felicitée, who so practiseth a
dissolute
life: whose loue and luste is kindeled, and sette on fire with
a

A brutishe

societie with

harlottes. harlotte, he followeth a brutishe sociétée. What
difference is
there, betwene them and beastes? The beaste as nature lea-
deth, he obaieth nature. Reason wanteth in beastes, manne
then indued with reason, whiche is a guide to all excellencie
how is it that he is not ruled by reason. Whom GOD hath
clothed and beautified, with all vertue and all singularité:
If a godly conuersacion of life, moueth thee to passe thy
daies

without mariage, then must the mocions of thy minde, be ta-

Chastitee

in mariage. med and kepte vnder. Other wise, execrable is thy
purpose,

and determinaciō of the life. If thou hopest of loue of a
harlot

though thou enioye her otherwise, thou art deceiued. Bac-
chis the harlot, whom Terence maketh mencion of, in the
persone of her self, sheweth the maners of all harlots to An-
tiphila, saiyng.

Quippe forma impulsī nostra nos amatores colunt:

Hec vbi immutata est, illi suum animum alio conferunt.

Nisi prospectū est interea aliquid nobis, deserte viuimus.

For saith she, the louer anamoured with our loue, and sette on fire therewith, it is for our beautie and fauour: but when beautie is ones faded, he conuerteth his loue to an other, whom he better liketh. But that we prouide for our selues in the meane season, wée should in the ende liue vtterlie forsaked. But your loue incensed with one, whose maners and life contenteth you: so you bothe are linked together,

The loue of a

harlotte. that no calamitée can separate you: who so hopeth loue of a

harlotte, or profite, he maie hope as for the fructe of a withered tree, gaine is all their loue, vice their ioye and delite. In vertue is libertée, in vertue is felicitee, the state of mariage is vertuous, there can be no greater bōdage, then to obaie many beastly affections, to the whiche whoredome forceth hym vnto, Loue is fained, cloked amitée, a harte dissembled, many a mightie person and wise, hath been ouerthrowen by the deceptes of harlottes: many a Citee plagued, many a region ouerthrowen for that mischief, to obaie many affections is a greate bondage. Who so serueth the beastlie affections of his **Hercules.**

Omphala. mynde to that purpose, he must also as Hercules to Ompha-

la bee slaue, not onely to his owne will and affection: but to the maners, will, and exspectacion of the harlotte. So serued Thraso, and Phedria Thais, that Gorgious harlot, Antony and Iulius Cesar, Cleopatra, this is a bondage, to liue slaue from reason and all [all](#) integritee, to a monstrous rablemēt

The harlot-

tes lesson, to

her louers. of vices, who so serueth a harlot, thei must learne this lesson.

Da mihi & affer, giue and bryng.

The women of Scithia, abhorryng the godly conuersacion of mariage, with their housbandes, left them, who in

tyme ware so mightie, that thei repelled them by force: thei called mariage not Matrimonie, but bondage. For, the chronicles doe testifie, thei became conquerours ouer many kyn- ges, all Asia obaied them: thei did builde many a great citee, and for theire successe, thei might compare with many prin-

The life of

the Amazo-

nes. ces. These women were called Amazones afterwarde, the order of their life was this, ones in the yere thei would en- ioye the compainie of a man: if it so were that thei had a man

childe, the father to haue it, if a daughter, then thei possessed her, and foorthwith burned her right pappe: for thei were all Archers, and wonderfully excelled therein, but in the ende, **Thalestris.** thei came all to ruine. One of them, Thalestris their Quene

in the tyme of Alexander the Greate, came to Alexander, thinkyng that he had been, some monstrous man of stature:

The offer of

a woman to

Alexander. whom, when she did beholde (for Alexander was of no migh- tie stature) did contemne hym, and offered him hand to hande

The answer

of Alexander

to the offer. to fight with hym. But Alexander like a wise Prince, saied

to his men, if I should ouercome her, that were no victorie, nor manhoode againste a woman: and being ouercome, that were greater shame, then commendacion in all my victories and conquestes, but afterwarde, there was a greate familia- ritée betwene them. The adulterer and the adulteris, neuer prospereth, for many mischiues are reserued, to that wicked and beastly loue. Sincere loue is not rooted, frendship colour- ed: the sober and demure countenaunce, is moche to be

com-

mended in a chaste woman, whose breaste pondereth a chaste

The facte of

the matrones

of Rome. life. The facte of the matrones of Rome, semeth straunge to

be tolde, of Papirius a Senators soonne, beyng taken to the Senate house, of his father: the childe beyng indued with a singuler wit, harde many causes in the assemble, talked and consulted vpō, at his retourne home, his mother was inquisitiue of their consultacion, to heare somewhat. The childe was commaunded by his father, to vtter no secrete that he heard, wherevpon of a long tyme, he refused his mothers demaunde: but at the laste subtelie, he satisfied his mothers request. Truth it is, my father willed me, to vtter no secret, you

keping my counsaill, I will shewe you, it is concluded by the Senate house, that euery man shall haue twoo wiues, that is a straunge matter, saieth the mother: foorthwith she had comunicacion with all the matrones of Roome, that could doe somewhat in this matter, thei also full willyngly assembled themselues, to let this purpose, to the Senate house, thei went to vtter, their swollen griues. The Senators were amazed at their commyng, but in this matter bolde thei were,

The Oraciō

of a matrone,

to the Sena-

tours. to enterprise that, whiche thei wer greued at. A Dame more

eloquente then all the reste, and of stomacke more hardie, began in these woordes. Otherwise then right, we are iniuri-

ously handled, and that in this assemble, that now we should be caste of and neclected: that whereas it is concluded in this counsaile, that euery manne should haue twoo wiues, more

meter it were, that one woman should haue twoo housbandes. Straunge it was in the Senators eares soche a request, whereupon a prooffe made how that rumour rose, Papirius was found the auctor, who tolde before the Senate, his mother alwaies inquisitiue to knowe that, whiche he should not tell, and thereupon he faigned that, whiche he might better tell. It is to be supposed the Senators mused thereat, and the matrones of Rome went home ashamed: but their secrete cogitacion of minde was manifest, what willingly in hart they wished. What greater felicitie can there bee, then in a vnitée of life, the housebande to liue with his wife. The beastes in their kinde, doe condemne mannes brutishe affections herein: there is no facte that sheweth a man or woman, more like to beastes, then whoredome.

¶ The obieccion.

But you will saie, many calamitées happeneth in mariage?

¶ The solucion.

Fortunne herein is to bee blamed, and not mariage, if any misfortune happeneth to manne therein, the felicitie and Eleccion in

Mariage. quiet state that any man enioieth thereby. The discrete elec-

cion is therein approued, in the state it self, nothyng can bee founde worthie reprehension, if a man will impute the bitter stormes of life to mariage: [whatseouer](#) happeneth, our owne reason maie iudge contrary. Place before thy eyes all the affaires, and occupacions of this life, bee all tymes pleasaunte to the housebande man, many a colde storme perceth his bodie, and many a mightie tempeste, dooeth molest hym and greue hym. Sommer is not the tyme, to caste his seede in

the ground, or implowynge to occupie hymself: shall he ther-

fore leaue his housebandrie, or doeth he rather neglecte it, his

diligence therein is the more, and labour more industrious.

From whence cometh the tempeste, the stormes and bitter seasons? From his house, from his wife, from his art and occupation, all those thynges by violence are expelled from the

aire. No state of life is able to giue riches, healthe, or securité

Emperours. to his state. There hath been princes and Emperours, nedie,

full of infirmités and sickenes, in daungerous state, oppressed with many calamités: was their dignitie and office, the cause of their calamités? No, God tempreth the state of euerie one, how, and after what sorte to possesse thesame. Some **Mariage.** are fulle fortunate in Mariage, if Mariage were of nécessité

the cause, then all should be onely fortunate, or onely vnfortunate: then in mariage is not the cause, if in mariage the manners doe disagree, and loue is extinguished, blame thyn own

The Mari-

ners. maners, thy choise, and thy eleccion. The Mariner that pass-

eth the daungerous Seas, and by dreadfull tempestes, and huffynge waues is alwaies in perille, and many often tymes

The Mar-

chautes. drowned. The Marchaunt lesynge his marchaundise by ship-

wrack, shall thei impute the daunger and losse, to their wife at home? Or doe the Mariners leaue for all these tempestes, their arte of Nauigation? Or the owner breake his shippe?

Or the Marchaunt proue no aduentures, because of his losse, and many haue been of this sort drowned. No. But more ear-

Warre. nestlie thei dooe assaie them selues thereto. Because

warre

spoileth many a man of his life, doe Princes therefore, leaue to moue armour againste the enemie, but because, who so in the defence of his countrée, dieth manfullie, is worthelie aduanced, and in perpetuall memorie, no daunger is refused, because euill thynges happeneth in life, is the state of good thynges to be auoided and eschued. Were it not vnsemelie, if housebande men, for no storme or tempeste, doe leaue their

state, their laborious and rough cōdicion of life, nor the shipman his arte of Nauigacion, because he seeth many drowned venteryng thesame, and he hymself often tymes in daunger, nor the soldiour or capitain, their perilous condicion of life, doe leaue for daunger. Should Mariage bée lesse sette by, because alwaies riches and quietnes happeneth not.

¶ The obieccion.

The losse of a good wife and children, is a greate grefe to any man, and a cause to blame mariage.

¶ The aunswere.

The lawe of

Nature. You your self are borne to dye, thei also by death obaye

likewise Nature, this is the Lawe of Nature ones to dye, whiche you séeme to blame. Then the death of thy wife and childrē, is not the blame in Mariage. What is the cause that you dye? Natures imbecillité and weakenes, then in them[.]

Mariage is not the cause: Nature in her firste molde hath so framed all, wherefore doe you ascribe that to mariage, that is founde faultée in Nature. Thei die that marie not, what infirmitie, daunger or peril happeneth to any in mariage, as

sharpe and perilous, doe molest and torment the other. If any manne by death, leaseth a right honeste wife, clothed with all

chastitée, demurenesse, sobrietée, and also with all singulari-

tée of vertue adorned: he hath loste a rare treasure, a iewell of

A chaste wo-

man. price, not in all to bee founde. Did you loue your wife, that

was so goodlie, so honeste and vertuous: there was greate cause saie you, for her vertuous sake, God hath chosen her frō

a mortall creature, to immortalitée, with her it can not bée better. There is no cause why you should blame mariage, for the losse of her, or of thy children, or for the losse of thee,

she to blame mariage. If for thy owne sake, this sorowe bee, *Est seipsum amantis non amici*, it is then of a self loue, to thy

self, not for her cause: for I muste aunswere as Lelius did to Affricanus, *Cum ea optime esse actū quis neget, quid est quod*

nō assecuta est immortalitatem. Who can deny saith he, but that with her it can not bee better? What is it that she hath not attained. Immortalitée. She was vertuous, chaiste, sober, discrete, of behaiour womanlie: for her vertues beloved. Well, now she hath immortalitee and blesse, are you sorie thereat, that were enuious. Did you loue her liuyng, loue her also departed, her vertuous shewed vnto vs, her immortalitée.

¶ The obieccion.

There is a care for the wife and children, if the housband
dye before them.

¶ The aunswere.

A wretched

executour. If thou leaue them riches, hope not that thy riches
shalbe

a staie to them, though thei bee innumerable: a wretched, a
miserable executour, wasteth and destroieth oftentimes, the
fructes of thy trauaile, who reioyseth more of thy death,
then

of thy life. Or thy childrens father in Lawe, shall spoile and

Gods pro-

uidence. spende with a merie harte, that whiche thou haste
long [tera-](#)

[uailed](#) for. Staie thy self and thine vpon Gods prouidence,
for it hath been seen, many a riche widowe, with infinite
treasure lefte, to her children also like porcions descendyng:
afterwarde bothe wife and children, haue been brought to
miserie and beggerlie state. Otherwise, poore children com-
mitted to the prouidence of God, and vertuouslie brought vp,
and the wife in like state, yet thei haue so passed their daies,
that thei haue rose to a goodlie state. See that thy richesse
bee

not iniuriouslie gotten by falshode, by liyng, by Usurie, if it
so be, then *Male parta male* [dilabuntur](#). That is this,
gooddes

euill gotte, euill spente, soche riches neuer giue deepe roote
to their ofspryng. That is an euill care, by a iniurious care,
to purchase thynges and gooddes wickedlie.

Also mariage taketh awaie widowhed, and doeth repare
with a newe freshe mariage, the lacke and priuacion of the
Death.

Mariage. other. She that was by death left a widowe, mariage

again

hath coupled her to a newe housbande: and doeth restore
that

whiche death tooke awaie. That that death dissolueth and
destroiethe, mariage increaseth, augmēteth, and multiplieth.
Bee it so, but mariage is a painfull life, it forceth euery one
to trauaile, to vpholde and maintaine his state, I commende
not the idell life, neither a life occupied to no vertuous ende.
Nature moueth euery manne to loue hymself and his, so thy
care and paine be to a godlie purpose. It is commendable. It
is the duetie of euery man, as his power, witte, and industrie
is able, to emploie thereto his cogitacion. To laboure for thy
wife, whom thou louest, and deare children, thy laboure is
pleasure, the ioye easeth thy labour. To behold thy self in thy
children, thei beyng vertuouslie broughte vp, it is a goodlie

The mariage

of a chaste

woman. comfort, to liue with a chaste woman, sober and
continente,

her vertues be a continuall pleasure, a passyng ioye. In ma-
riage ought to be greate deliberacion, whom thou chocest to
thy continuall compainie or felowshippe, her life paste well
knownen, her parentes and kindrede how honeste and vertu-
ous, her maners, her fame, how commendable, her counti-

The choise

of a wife. naunce sober, a constaunt iye, and with shamefastnes
beau-

tified, a mouthe vttering fewe woordes discretlie. She is not
to be liked, whō no vertuous qualitées in her educaciō, beu-
tifieth and adorneth, the goodlie qualitees sheweth, the well
framed and nurtured mynde. These thynges maie be suffi-
ciente, to shewe what excellencie is in mariage and how ne-
cessarie it is, to the procreacion and preseruaciō of mankind.

¶ *Legislacio.*

¶ A Oracion either in the defence of
a Lawe, or againste a Lawe.



Any learned menne are in this opinion, that vpon
a Lawe alledged, a Oracion maie bee made in the
defence of it: or matter maie be suppeditated, to
in-
uaigh by force of argument againste it.

Although the lawe alleged be in maner the whole cause,
bicause it doeth cōtain al the matter included in the oracion.

In this Oracion, the persone is induced to be spoken vp-
pon, vnknowne, vncertaine: wherefore it is to be placed, ra-
ther in the state and forme of consultacion, and to bée
exami-
ned with iudgement.

The induccion of a Lawe, is in twoo sortes.

A confirmacion of any olde Lawe, or a confutacion.

As for example.

The Ciuill Lawe doeth well commende, bondmen to be
manumised, that is, to be made free.

The lawe is herein to be praised, that willeth the coūsail
of the parentes & frendes, to be knowne before the
contracte.

Upon a Lawe alledged, worthelie matter maie rise, waigh-
yng the godlie ende, whereunto the Lawe was firste inuen-
ted, decreed and stablished, what profite thereof ensueth and
foloweth. What it is to vertue a maintainer, otherwise if it
be not profitable? What moued any one to frame and ordain
soche a Lawe, as was to a common wealthe vnprofitable, to
vertue no aider, if it were a profitable Lawe and godlie, it is

as Demosthenes saieth, of God inuented, though by famous Lawe. wise, and godlie menne, stablished and decreéd. Good Lawes tempereth to all states equitee and iustice, without fauour or frendship, no more to the one then the other.

The order to make an Oracion by a lawe, is in this sort. First, make a prohemiu or beginning to enter your matter.

In the seconde place, adde a contrary to that, whiche you will entreate vpon.

Then shewe it lawful.

Iuste.

Profitable.

Possible.

You maie as in *Thesis*, whiche was the Oracion before, vse a contradiction or obiection: and to that make an answer or solucion.

¶ A confutation of that Lawe, whiche suffered adultrie to bee punished with death, no iudgement giuen thereupon.

The moste
rigorous and
moste cruell



lawe of Solō[.] Olon, who was a famous Philosopher, in the time of Cresus king of Lidia, and a lawe giuer to the Athenians: by whose Lawes and godlie meanes, the Athenians were long and prosperouslie gouerned. Emong many of his lawes,

this Solon set forthe againste adulterers. *Fas esse deprehen-*
denti mæchum in ipso adulterio interficere: it shalbee
lawfull

saieth he, who so taketh an adulterer in his beastlie facte, to
kill hym. Solon beyng a wise man, was more rigorous and
cruell, in this one Lawe, then he ought to be. A meruailous
matter, and almoste vncredible, so wise, so noble and worthy
a Lawe giuer, to bruste out with soche a cruell and bloodie
lawe, that without iudgement or sentence giuen, the matter
neither proued nor examined, adulterie to be death. Where-
fore, reason forceth euery manne, to Iudge and ponder with

Adulterie a

horrible vice. hymself, that either adulterie is a moste horrible
vice, moste

beastlie & pestiferous, and not mete to tary vpon the
censure,

and sentence of a Iudge: or Solon was not so wise, discrete,
and a politike persone, but a rashe and fonde lawe giuer, that
in soche a terrible voice, he should burste out, as adulterie so
horrible, as not worthie to be pondered, examined and boul-
ted of in Iudgemente. The Athenians receiued that Lawe,
thei did also obaie his other lawes. Their dominions there-
by in felicitée was gouerned: there was no populous nom-
ber of adulterers, to let that Lawe, thei liued moste godlie, a
straunge worlde, a rare moderacion of that age and people.

Plato aga-

inste adultrie

made a lawe. Plato the godlie Philosopher, who left in his
woorkes, and

monumentes of learnyng, greate wisdomes and also godlie
Lawes in his bookes: intituled vpon Lawes, and gouerne-
ment of a common wealth, did not passe by in silence, to
giue

and ordain a Lawe against adulterie. Who also as it semed
Iudged adulterie as moste horrible and detestable, in his .ix.
booke *de Legibus*. This is the Lawe. *Adulteram deprehen-*

sam impune occidi a viro posse. The adultrous woman saith he, taken in the crime, her housbande maie without daunger of death, or feare of punishment slea her. A straunge matter twoo so noble, so famous for wisdom, to make adulterie present death, no Iudgement or sentence of Magistrate, procedyng to examine and iudge, vpon the state of the cause. A man maie saie, O goodlie age, and tyme in vertue tempered, eche state as seemeth brideled and kepte vnder, and farre frō voluptuousnes remoued. There was no stewes or Baudes houses, where soche Lawes and Lawmakers were. Sobrietée was in maides, and chastitée harboured in matrones and wedded wiues, a harte inuiolable to honeste conuersacion. Where adulterie is cutte of, there many detestable vices,

Catos sen-

tence vpon

adulterie. and execrable purposes are remoued. Cato the sage Peere of

Rome, indued with like seuerité, did fauour that lawe and highlie extolled it. Although adulterie bee a detestable vice horrible, yea, although it be worthie death, better it were by iudgemente, and the sentence of the Magistrate, the faute to Lawe. bee determined: then at the will of euery manne, as a Lawe

by death to bee ended, the common wealthe shalbee in more quiet state, when the horrible factes of wicked menne, by the **The Iudge,**

a liuely lawe. Lawe made worthie of deathe: are neuerthelesse by a liuelie

Lawe, whiche is the Iudge, pronounced and condemned, accordyng to the Lawe. Els many mischiues might rise in all kyngdomes and common wealthes, vnder a colour of lawe, many a honeste persone murdered: and many a murtherer, by cloke of a Lawe, from daunger saued. In Rome sometime a Lawe there was ordained againste adulterie, whiche was called *Lex Iulia*, this Lawe Octavius Augustus set foorth. The Lawe was thus, *Gladio iussit animaduerti in*

adulteros[.]

The lawe commaunded adulterers to be hedded. The chronicles of aunciente tymes herein doe shew, and the décrées of

auncient elders also, how horrible a thing adulterie is, when thei punishe it with death. Who knoweth not emōg the Israelites, and in the olde lawe thei wer stoned to death. Well as Magistrates are in common wealthes remoued, or as times chaunge, lawes also are chaunged and dissolued: and as the Prouerbe is, *Lex vt Regio*, the Lawes are accordyng to the Region. Afterwarde Ualerius Publicola, a man ascendyng to high nobilitée of honour, and fame emong, the Romaines gaue this Lawe. *Qua neminem licebat indicta causa necare*. By this lawe it was not lefull, any manne to be put **A godly law.** to death, their cause not examined in Iudgemente, this was

a goodlie Lawe. Then afterwarde, Lawe giuers rose in the common wealth, that with more facilitée tolerated that vice, then wickednesse flowed, adulterie not punished by death. And sence that, the Romaine Empire, wrapped and snared with soche mischiues hath decaied, in fame, nobilitée and ver-

tue. Many a parte of their dominion plagued, deuoured, and

The good

manne. destroyed. The good and godlie menne, nede not to feare any

Lawe godlie, their life beyng in vertue and godlines nurtured. The terrible sentence of a lawe, forceth the good and god-

lie, to perseuere and continue in godlines. The terrible sen-

Lawe. tence of a Lawe, cutteth of the wicked enterprises of pestife-

rous menne. Uice where lawe is not to correcte, will inure it

Uice as a

lawe by cu-

stome.

Adulterie. self by custome as a Lawe, or borne and tolerated againste a Lawe. Therefore as adulterie without Iudgemente, to bee punished worthie of death is vngodlie: so it ought not to bee passed ouer, or tolerated in any Region or common wealth, as no lawe seuerely to punishe thesame.

¶ The contrarie.



L other lawes doe differ, from that rigorous lawe of Solon and Plato herein, yea, and though thei be vices horrible, yet thei ar not determined, without the sentēce of the Magistrate and Iudge. But this cruell Lawe of Solon, doeth repugne all lawes, stabli-

The lawe v-

niuersall and

equall to all

menne. shed in all Citees and common wealthes. And sithe the lawe

is of hymself vniuersall, with equitée, giuing and tempering to all states. Fonde muste that Lawe bee of Solon, whiche rashely, without consideracion of iudgement doeth procede, no man ought in his own cause, to be his own iudge or Magistrate. This is argument sufficient to confounde the lawe of Solon. All Lawes are repugnaunte to that, because with Iudgement thei procede against vices moste pestiferous. In **Thefte.** common wealthes Theft is by lawe, pronounced worthie of

death, whereupon also the Magistrate and Iudge, determineth the matter, and heareth of bothe the action of the case, before he condempneth, so in all other mischiues.

But you maie saie, many mischiues riseth of adulterie.

Although it so be, the Iudge determineth vpon Murder, whiche is in like sort horrible, soche also as dooe séeke to

caste

into perill their countrée, and by treason to destroie thesame, Iudgemente proceedeth by determinacion of the Lawe and Iudge. And so in all other wicked factes, and mischiuous enterprises, the Iudgement in euery cause procedeth, as Lawe

The Iudge

a liuely lawe. and right willeth, from the mouthe of the Iudge, he beyng a

liuelie Lawe, to the Lawe written. The cruell Lawe of Solon, is like to the phantasie and wille of a tyraunte, who, as phantasie and will leadeth, murdereth at his pleasure, whose will is alwaies a sufficient Lawe to hymself, as who should

The will of a

tyraunte his

owne lawe. saie, so I wille, so I commaunde, my wille shall stande for a

Lawe: but godlie lawes doe iustlie, accordyng to reason and vertue, tempereth the cause of euery man. No godlie Lawe, maketh the accuser his owne Iudge.

¶ Lawfull.

Lawes were

made for two



causes. Ho so by Lawe is iudged, and the offence proued, there is no excuse in the malefactour, nor suspicion

seing that, accordyng to lawe, the fact is punished, and as Demosthenes saieth, twoo thynges moued the wise Elders to make Lawes, that the wicked should bee hindered, and cutte of from their purpose, and that good men seyng by a lawe, the actes of pestiferous men kepte vnder, by

the terrour of them, are afraied to commit the like facte. This

was euen accordyng to lawe. The terrible sentence of a law executed, vpon moste wicked persones, doe kepe vnder many
a mischiuous enterprise, whiche through the dolefull and lamentable ende of the wicked, doe driue and force all other to all godlines.

¶ Iuste.



He accuser by Lawe and Iudge, is able to defende hymself, whē his cause is ended accordyng to law.

Uertue thereby vpholded, when by order of lawe, vice is condempned. The malifactour hath no excuse, all staie and colour remoued, the accuser by iuste Lawe
pleateth, when the law is thereby supported and saued. And herein a greate parte of Iustice is placed, when the fauour of the Iudge or frendship, is onely on the cause, the persone neglected, that is Iustice, to giue to euery one his owne.

¶ Profitable.



It must be profitable to the whole bodie of the common wealthe, when by the Iustice of godlie lawes, vertue is in high price aduaunced, vice by the open
sentence, and manifeste profe conuicted, the malefactor shall be knowen, the sincere and godlie deliuered, and from tyme to tyme maintained. Lawes as thei be vniuersall so thei openlie ought to giue sentence.

¶ Possible.



Then without lawe to procede, and iudgemente of the Magistrate, as Solon did in this lawe, it were not possible, any common wealthe to florishether-

by. Therefore in Iudgemente ought the cause of euery one to be pleated and examined, that thereby all suspicion, & greuous enormités, maie be put of. Uice is not there-

fore tolerated, because for a tyme, Iudgemente ceaseth, but hereupon vices are more depely rooted out, all people knowing the determinacion of the lawe, and the manifest sentēce of the Iudge heard. A terrour ensueth to al malefactours and pestiferous men, good men are incensed to all godlines, whē vice by Lawe is condempned, cutte of, and destroyed. Good menne by Lawe and auctoritée, vpholded and maintained.

The state of
good lawes. This is the state of good lawes, by order to procede, the cause in Iudgemente examined, the facte proued, vertue in any persone vpholded, vice in all caste doune and defaced, so there is good Lawe, as Demosthenes saith, sincere Iudge, and sentence inuiolable.

Printer Errors

Transcriber's Note: The following is a list of printer errors in the original.

Page	Original	Correct
Fol. j.r	faith he	faith be
Fol. ij.r	Poloponesians	Peloponesians
Fol. ij.r	oracions, when	oracion, when
Fol. v.r	Perthesius	Parthesius
Fol. vj.v	Romai-	Romains [or Romaines]
Fol. vij.r	valianntes	valiauntes
Fol. vij.r	commo wealth	commō wealth
Fol. ix.r	uot	not
Fol. ix.r	state or	state of
Fol. ix.v	comparson	comparison
Fol. x.r	aboundauute	aboundaunte
Fol. x.v	oneie	oneliē
Fol. xj.r	fanour	fauour
Fol. xiiij.r	vengauce	vengauēce
Fol. xiiij.v	Fenche	Frenche
Fol. xv.r	Bristaines	Britaines
Fol. xvj.r	porfite	profite
Fol. xvj.v	learnng	learning [or learnyng]
Fol. xvij.r	is was	was
Fol. xvij.r	Pholosopher	Philosopher
Fol. xvij.v	faundacion	foundacion
Fol. xvij.v	aud	and
Fol. xvij.v	Catona	Crotona
Fol. xix.r	celebraied	celebrated
Fol. xx.v	intteled	intiteled
Fol. xxj.r	gouermēt	gouernmēt
Fol. xxij.v	Politcia	Politia
Fol. xxiiij.v	Rhetotike	Rhetorike
Fol. xxiiij.v	exposion	exposicion
Fol. xxiiij.v	Incrediblie	Incredible
Fol. xxv.r	The feigne	Thei feigne
Fol. xxvij.r	the the	the

Fol. xxvij.r	moderaciou	moderacion
Fol. xxvij.v	Prossible	Possible
Fol. xxvij.v	Rhetotike	Rhetorike
Fol. xxix.r	Fol. xxxj.	Fol. xxix.
Fol. xxix.v	Historiogriphers	Historiographers
Fol. xxxj.r	Fol. xxxiij.	Fol. xxxj.
Fol. xxxj.r	lineth	liueth
Fol. xxxj.v	ouerthowe	ouerthrowe
Fol. xxxj.v	Epamniundas	Epaminundas
Fol. xxxij.r	Epameunndas	Epaminundas
Fol. xxxiij.r	Zopryus	Zopyrus
Fol. xxxiij.r	or God	of God
Fol. xxxiij.r	wekedned	wekened
Fol. xxxv.r	destetable	detestable
Fol. xxxv.v	Theodosius	Theodosius
Fol. xxxv.v	prouulgate	promulgate
Fol. xxxv.v	hane	haue
Fol. xxxvj.r	goddes	goodes [or gooddes]
Fol. xxxvj.r	lo liue	to liue
Fol. xxxvj.r	the:m	theim
Fol. xxxvij.r	Fol. xxxix.	Fol. xxxvij.
Fol. xxxvij.v	dangerous gaue	dangerous game
Fol. xxxvij.v	cut af	cut of
Fol. xxxvij.v	gouernuurs	gouernours
Fol. xxxix.r	Fol. xxxvij.	Fol. xxxix.
Fol. xxxix.r	His Oracion	THis Oracion
Fol. xxxix.v	goueruours	gouernours
Fol. xl.v	Traianns	Traianus
Fol. xlij.r	nobilitée) for	nobilitée (for
Fol. xlij.r	valianntly	valiauntly
Fol. xliij.v	anncestours	auncestours
Fol. xlvij.r	conutrée	countrée
Fol. liij.v	omnipoteucie	omnipotencie
Fol. lvj.r	all all	all
Fol. lvij.r	whatseouer	whatsoeuer
Fol. lvij.v	terauailed	trauailed
Fol. lvij.v	dilabuntnr	dilabuntur

The original contains the following additional printer errors:

Fol. j.r	Decorative capital “N” reversed
Fol. xxxiij.r	Last sentence repeated

[Fol. xxxviiij.v](#) Section heading repeated

[Fol. liij.r](#) First word repeats last word on previous page

[Fol. liiiij.r](#) Remainder of last sentence missing?

The following do not appear to be printer errors, as they are consistently used in the original: “thesame” for “the same”; “shalbe” for “shall be”; the use of “a” instead of “an” before a noun beginning with a vowel; the combination of “the” and a word beginning with “e” into a single word, as in “theight” for “the eight.”

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